



# Hindustan Times

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| <b>NORTHERN RAILWAY</b><br><b>NOTICE INVITING TENDER</b> |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
|----------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Name of work and its location</b>                     | <b>03-SRDEE-G-DU-2028-27</b><br>Electrical work in connection with (i) Provision of 2 Family suits and 8 Individual suits at OPI+ GZB in lieu of Old OPI, (ii) Construction of underground tank & pump house, electric sub-station, improvement to water supply system under ADEN/GZB (iii) Augmentation of homing capacity of EL&GZB from 200 to 225, (iv) Reorganization of facilities available in Shed and shop at |



Srinagar: Same Tender Fee shall be considered in case of those bidders who have already paid/ furnished in the tender (e-NIT 34 of 2025-26) which has been cancelled.

2. Earnest money/ Bid Security in shape of CDR/DR/IG/ Insurance Surety Bond pledged to the Chief Engineer, I&C Kashmir Payable at Srinagar. The Bank Guarantee should be valid for 45 days beyond bid validity. Same EMD shall be considered in case of those bidders who have already paid/ furnished in the tender (e-NIT 34 of 2025-26) which has been cancelled.

3. Furnishing of hard copies of bids immediately after submission of e-tenders is dispensed with. The same should be obtained only from the bidder who is declared as L1 after opening of financial bids as per Finance Department O.M. No. AQ/2017/451 Dt. 07.08.2018.

4. The Contractor shall have to arrange all the key construction material for successful completion of the work. No Departmental store shall be issued.

5. Key construction material to be used and arranged by the contractor for execution of work is given below:

a) CEMENT: 43 Grade OPC conforming to IS: 8112-2013 (Latest Version) as required in the work, from Reputed manufacturers of cement approved as currently displayed on cement information system online portal of the Ministry of Industry, Government of India, and holding license to use ISI certification mark for their product. However final selection shall be based on design mix and approval of the Department.

b) STEEL OF ALL SORTS: Fe-500 Conforming to IS: 1786-2008 (Latest Version) from primary producers such as SAIL, TATA TISCO, JINDAL PANTHER or RINL, only as approved by the Ministry of Steel, Govt. of India.

c) STRUCTURAL STEEL OF: Grade E250 Conforming to IS: 2002-2011 (Latest Version) from primary producers such as SAIL, TATA, JINDAL or RINL, only as approved by the Ministry of Steel, Govt. of India.

6. The bidder should have valid dealership or authorization issued by original pump manufacturer (DEM). The same is to be updated in Technical Bid (cover 1st) necessarily without which the bid shall be outrightly rejected.

7. Further details can be seen in bidding document available on website [www.ktdrains.gov.in](http://www.ktdrains.gov.in)

8. Conditional bids and the bids not meeting the qualifying criteria shall be summarily rejected.

9. The authority reserves the right to cancel any or all bids without assigning any reason.

10. Subsequent Corrigendum/Addendum if any shall be published on above website.

11. All the bidders shall mandatorily upload the Bank Account details which is linked with GSTIN as per the J&K Finance Department Circular No. 01 (Adm) FD of 2025, dated: 08-07-2025. No payments shall be released to any other Bank Account except the one linked with GST registered No. of the successful bidder.

No: 181-202  
Dated: 08.04.2026  
Sd/-  
Executive Engineer,  
M.I.D. Srinagar  
DIPK-248-26

General, MH & FW Uttarakhand, Dehradun.

5. Details of subsequent addendum/corrigendum/cancellation etc. may be obtained from the website <https://uk.tenders.gov.in>

6. Portal Registration : The contractor/bidder intending to participate in the bid is required to register in the portal using his/her active personal/official email id as his/her Login id and attach his/her valid digital signature certificate (DSC) to his/her unique login id.

For any other queries the bidders are asked to contact through e-mail : [cmsd.uk@gmail.com](mailto:cmsd.uk@gmail.com)

Director General  
Medical Health & F.W. Uttarakhand, Dehradun

**NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY**  
E-Tender No.-PRYJ-Sig-002-2026-27

**E-Tender Notice**

Senior Divisional Signal & Telecommunication Engineer/Coordinator/ North Central Railway/Prayagraj, for and on behalf of the President of India, invite E-TENDER on prescribed form for the following works up to 12.58 hrs. on the opening date of E-Tender mentioned therein. The details of the Tender are as under:-

Tender No.: 002/Approx. Cost of work : 24741851.30/Earnest Money : 484000/-

Cost of Tender Form : 0.00 Completion Period : 12 Months

Date of opening of tender : 05.05.2026

Name of work : Strengthening and Augmentation of Earthing and Bonding Arrangement as per revised RDSO/TAN3008 in section of Sr. DISTE/CoPRVJ.

Availability of tender form : Tender forms are available on [www.iraps.gov.in](http://www.iraps.gov.in)

Earnest Money to be deposited : The prescribed amount of Bid Security as mentioned above must be deposited along with the tender form Online through Internet Banking on Online Payment gateway only. The tenderer(s) should note that, in any case, the Bid Security in any other form than specified in GCC shall be acceptable. If the Bid Security deposited by the bidder is in shape of Bank Guarantee, it should be supported by proper stamp duty, rate prescribed as per section 13 & 24 of the UP Stamp Act, 2008 and amended from time to time at the time of submission of Bank Guarantee. Tenders without Bid Security shall be summarily rejected.

Time & place of opening of tender : Tender will be opened through E-Tender at office of Divisional Railway Manager, Prayagraj at or after 12:30 hours. In case tender opening date happens to be holiday, Tenders will be opened on the next working day.

Validity of Offer : 60 days from the date of opening.

Right of Railway to deal with tender : Railway administration reserves the rights to postpone/modify or to cancel the tender without assigning any reasons. 770/26 (D)

North central railways CPMRCH [www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in](http://www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in)

1. Uploading of Tender document: 13.04.2026

2. Website: <http://eproc.punjab.gov.in>

3. Pre-bid meeting: 16.04.2026 at 11.30 AM in the office of MD, PUNBUS

4. Last date of Bid Submission: 01.05.2026 at 04.00 PM

5. Date of Technical Bid opening: 04.05.2026 at 11.00 AM

6. Last date and time of queries: 16.04.2026 at 05.00 PM IST (email id: [landpunbus@gmail.com](mailto:landpunbus@gmail.com))

For participating in the above e-tender, the Bidder shall have to get themselves registered with <http://eproc.punjab.gov.in> and get ID & password. Digital Signature Certificate (DSC) is mandatory to participate in the e-tendering process.

RO NO: 1740/12/2026/27/10321 Managing Director, PUNBUS

| Approx. cost of the work in Rs. 11909661.90/- |                                                                                                      |
|-----------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Address of the office                         | Sr. Div. Elect. Engineer/General, New Delhi.                                                         |
| Earnest Money                                 | Rs. 238200.00/-                                                                                      |
| Last Date & time of submission of tender      | 30.04.2026, 16.00 Hrs.                                                                               |
| Opening of tender                             | 30.04.2026, 16.00 Hrs.                                                                               |
| Website & notice board                        | <a href="http://www.iraps.gov.in">www.iraps.gov.in</a> & Sr. Div. Elect. Engineer/General, New Delhi |
| SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE 1178/2026      |                                                                                                      |

**KARJAT MUNICIPAL COUNCIL**  
Tal. Karjat Dist. Raigad -410201  
Office: 02148-222033 Fax: 221312  
E-mail : [karjatcouncil@gmail.com](mailto:karjatcouncil@gmail.com)

Dispatch/Outward No. 0063/25-26 Date: 09/04/2026

**NOTICE**

Declaration of Intention to prepare Geographical Information System (GIS) 1<sup>st</sup> Revision Development Plan of Karjat Municipal Council as per Section 23(1) read with Section 38 of the Maharashtra Regional and Town Planning Act, 1966.

Resolution No: 16 Date: 27/03/2016

Whereas, Karjat Municipal Council by its Resolution No. 16 Dated 27/03/2016 has given consent to declared its intention to prepare Geographical Information System (GIS) 1<sup>st</sup> Revision Development Plan as per provision of Section 23 (1) read with Section 38 of the Maharashtra Regional and Town Planning Act, 1966. Accordingly, this notice is being published.

The plan showing boundary of the area included in Development Plan of Karjat Municipal Council is kept open for inspection by the public on office working days, during office hours at the office of the Municipal Council, as required under section 23(2) of the Maharashtra Regional & Town Planning Act, 1966.

Any suggestion / objection of the public in this regard, may be forwarded in writing to me within a period of 60(Sixty) days from the date of publication of this notice in Maharashtra. Government Gazette. The suggestion/ objection shall be duly considered while preparing the Development Plan.

Sd/-  
(Tanaji Chevan)  
Chief officer  
Karjat Municipal Council

Place : - Karjat Municipal Council

**उत्तराखण्ड शासन गृह (अभियन्ता) अनुभाग-3**  
संख्या: 385839/वीस-3/2026-01(20)2024 E-41203

वेबसाइट [www.uk.gov.in](http://www.uk.gov.in) दिनांक 09 अप्रैल, 2026

निदेशक, विधि विज्ञान प्रयोगशाला, उत्तराखण्ड, देहरादून के पद पर मर्ती हेतु "उत्तराखण्ड राज्य विधि विज्ञान प्रयोगशाला तकनीकी अधिकारी सेवा (संशोधन) नियमावली, 2024" के अन्तर्गत विहित अर्हताओं को ध्यान रखते हुए उम्मीदवारों को सूचित किया जाता है कि वे 01 जुलाई, 2025 को अधिकतम 57 वर्ष से अधिक आयु प्राप्त न करने वाले प्रतिनिधिक (सेवा स्थानान्तरण या बीडी होपिंग) के माध्यम से 01 जुलाई, 2025 को अधिकतम 57 वर्ष से अधिक आयु प्राप्त न करने वाले उम्मीदवारों से परस्परान हेतु आवेदन आमंत्रित किये जाते हैं।

2- आवेदन पत्र प्राप्त करने की अंतिम तिथि 08.05.2026 सायं 5.00 बजे तक है। इसके पत्र अर्थात् निर्धारित प्रारूप पर उक्त पद हेतु अपने शैक्षिक प्रमाण-पत्रों, अनुभव का सारांश विवरण, ई-मेल एवं पत्राचार पता तथा अन्य विवरण सहित अपना आवेदन पत्र स्कैन पोस्ट/ कोरियर/ स्वयं के माध्यम से सावित्र, गृह विभाग, उत्तराखण्ड शासन, 4-सुमाथ रोड, देहरादून-248001 के पते पर दिनांक 08.05.2026 सायं 5.00 बजे तक भेज सकते हैं। दिनांक 08.05.2026 सायं 5.00 बजे के उपरान्त प्राप्त तथा निर्धारित विधि/ प्रारूप के अनुरूप न पाये गये आवेदन पर किसी भी दशा में विचार नहीं किया जायेगा।

3- उत्तराखण्ड राज्य विधि विज्ञान प्रयोगशाला तकनीकी अधिकारी सेवा (संशोधन) नियमावली, 2024 में निर्दिष्ट प्राधिकारों के अनुरूप निदेशक के पद हेतु अनिवार्य शैक्षिक अर्हता, आयु एवं अनुभव के सम्बन्ध में विस्तृत दिशा-निर्देश एवं विस्तृत विधि तथा आवेदन पत्र का प्रारूप उत्तराखण्ड सरकार की वेबसाइट <https://uk.gov.in/Announcements> पर प्रदर्शित है।

हौसेल बगौसी सावित्र

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NEW DELHI/METRO  
Friday, April 10, 2026



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श्री नरेन्द्र मोदी  
माननीय प्रधानमंत्री



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NEW DELHI/METRO Friday, April 10, 2026



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## Crucial election cycle kicks off with high voter turnout

Utpal Parashar, Vishnu Varma and Harsh Yadav



MODI: BJP TO RECREATE  
2021 NANDIGRAM FEAT  
AT BOCC WEST BENGAL

## Israel pushes for Lebanon talks as Iran truce teeters



**GUWAHATI/THIRUVANTHAPURAM/ NEW DELHI:** Assembly elections in Assam and Puducherry produced record voter turnouts on Thursday while Kerala recorded its highest participation in nearly four decades, as all three went to the polls in a single phase — and a sharp reduction in electoral rolls may have amplified the headline percentages across all three.

Election Commission data till 11pm showed Assam turnout at 85.83% of its 25 million electors, Kerala at 78.27% of its 27.1 million and Puducherry at 89.87% of 950,311. All three improved substantially on their 2021 figures of 82.05%, 74.06% and 81.7% respectively. The previous bests were 84.64% in Assam in 2016, 79.5% in Kerala in 1987, and 85.7% in Puducherry in 2006 — meaning Assam and Puducherry set new records while Kerala fell just short of its 1987 peak — although the poll body is expected to release final turnout numbers only later.

continued on >7



People wait to cast their vote amid rainfall on an island in the middle of river Brahmaputra, in Assam's Darrang on Thursday. AP

## Murshidabad, Malda seats top adjudication deletions

Abhishek Jha and Jaydeep Thakur

letters@hindustantimes.com

**NEW DELHI/KOLKATA:** All five assembly constituencies with the highest percentage of deletion from the pre-adjudication stage to post-adjudication in West Bengal were in the Muslim-majority districts of Murshidabad and Malda, an analysis of the removals in the controversial "logical discrepancy" category in the poll-bound state showed on Thursday.

Nearly 2.71 million of the six million people flagged under the "logical discrepancy" category were removed from the rolls, the Election Commission of India announced earlier this week. >90

## CONG WITHDRAWS ITS CANDIDATE FOR BARAMATI BYPOLL

The Congress Thursday withdrew its candidate, Akash More, for the bypoll to Baramati assembly seat in Maharashtra, paving the way for a virtual uncontested win for deputy chief minister Sanjay Pawar, with the decision coming in the wake of calls from its ally the NCPSP as well as the ruling NCP and the BJP. "We are taking two steps back since the bypoll is taking place after the tragic demise of Ajit Pawar," state party chief Harshwardhan Sapkal said. >93

Reuters

letters@hindustantimes.com

**JERUSALEM/BEIRUT/ISLAMABAD:** Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu said on Thursday he is seeking direct talks with Beirut, a day after the worst bombardment of the war killed more than 300 people in Lebanon and placed Donald Trump's US-Iran ceasefire in jeopardy. Trump announced a ceasefire in the six-week-old Iran conflict late on Tuesday, just hours before a deadline after which he threatened to destroy Iran's entire civilisation.

In Pakistan, authorities were preparing for the first round of US-Iran talks, locking down parts of the capital Islamabad. But there was no sign Iran was lifting its near-total blockade of the Strait of Hormuz, which has caused the worst disruption to global energy supplies in history, with Israel's ongoing attacks on Lebanon cited as a key sticking point.

In the first 24 hours of the ceasefire, just a single oil product tanker and five dry bulk cargo ships were allowed to pass. >94



## Alternative routes through Hormuz

Iran announced alternative routes on Thursday for ships travelling through the Strait of Hormuz, citing the risk of sea mines in the main zone of the vital waterway. The statement shared instructions for an alternative entry and exit route through the strait. Vessels are to enter the strait north of Larak Island and exit just south of it until further notice.

## India strengthens Gulf energy push amid truce

Rajeev Jayaswal and Rezaul H Laskar

letters@hindustantimes.com

**NEW DELHI:** The two-week ceasefire in West Asia has allowed New Delhi to step up its energy security outreach in the Gulf, with petroleum minister Hard-

deep Singh Puri visiting Qatar from Thursday and external affairs minister S Jaishankar heading to the UAE on Saturday. EAM spokesperson Randhir Jaiswal confirmed the visits at a briefing on Thursday. >96

## WILL MOVE HORMUZ MANAGEMENT TO NEW PHASE, SAYS MOJTABA

Iran will move the management of Hormuz strait into a new phase, its supreme leader Ayatollah Mojtaba Khamenei said on Thursday in a statement. "Iran is not seeking war but will not forfeit its rights and considers all resistance fronts as a unified entity," he said. He added that Iran is resolute in avenging the killings of its late supreme leader and martyrs. AGENCIES

## CBI REGISTERS CASE OVER MISUSE OF HRY GOVT FUNDS WORTH ₹550 CR

Hitender Rao

letters@hindustantimes.com

**CHANDIGARH:** The Central Bureau of Investigation has taken over the probe into the alleged misappropriation of around ₹550 crore of Haryana government funds from IDFC First Bank and AU Small Finance Bank, and lodged a regular case in this connection. >99

## NITISH LIKELY TO GET TYPE-8 BUNGALOW IN LUTYENS' DELHI

Sanjeev K Jha & Arun Kumar

letters@hindustantimes.com

**NEW DELHI/PATNA:** Bihar chief minister Nitish Kumar, who is set to take oath as a Rajya Sabha MP on Friday, is likely to be allotted a high-security Type-8 government bungalow in Lutyens' Delhi, according to senior Janata Dal (United) leaders. >99

## AI FLIGHT RETURNS TO MUMBAI AFTER ENGINE FAILURE

Neha LM Tripathi

letters@hindustantimes.com

**NEW DELHI:** A Mumbai-Bengaluru Air India flight returned shortly after take-off on Thursday after one of its engines stalled, officials said. The flight returned "as a precaution due to a suspected technical issue," an airline spokesperson said. >99

## CLASHES, ARSON MARK WORKERS' STIR IN MANESAR

Debashish Karmakar

letters@hindustantimes.com

**GURUGRAM:** A wage protest at Gurugram's IMT Manesar industrial hub turned violent on Thursday, leaving at least 22 people injured — including eight police officers — and four factories ransacked after clashes broke out between workers and police. >99

## Govt seeks X Community Notes oversight with IT Rules tweaks

Sejal Sharma

letters@hindustantimes.com

**NEW DELHI:** The proposed amendments to India's Information Technology Rules, 2021, would formally bring Community Notes — the user-generated fact-checking tool on X — under the ministry of information and broadcasting's regulatory remit when they touch news and current affairs, enabling the government to seek removal of content that corrects official claims, an official aware of the matter said. Speaking on condition of anonymity, a ministry of electronics

text to a policy issue would fall into this category, the official said. "Depends on facts in each case. But it potentially could."

On March 30, MeitY published amendments to IT Rules to bring more online content under Part III of the rules, overseen by MIB. A key part of this is bringing content posted by users on social media — including influencers and even ordinary users resharing content — within MIB's ambit. Currently, MIB's purview is limited to publishers of news and online curated content. The proposed expansion would for-

text to a policy issue would fall into this category, the official said. "Depends on facts in each case. But it potentially could."

continued on >7

## Indian team may visit US, interim trade deal in focus

Rajeev Jayaswal

letters@hindustantimes.com

**NEW DELHI:** An Indian delegation is expected to visit Washington later this month to advance talks on an interim bilateral trade agreement, with New Delhi seeking preferential market access for Indian merchandise over competing countries under the new US tariff architecture, people familiar with the matter said. The original framework, announced on February 7, was thrown into uncertainty when the US Supreme Court on February 20 struck down President Donald Trump's sweeping global

tariffs. India and US have since been working to rebuild the agreement on former legal ground — even as US launched fresh Section 301 probe against 16 nations, including India, as part of its effort to reconstruct tariff pressure through alternative legal mechanisms.

US ambassador to India and special envoy to south and central Asia Sergio Gor on Thursday alluded to the forthcoming visit after a meeting with US Trade Representative Jamieson Greer in Washington. "...We look forward to welcoming an Indian delegation to Washington later this month," Gor said on X. >98

## JANAKPURI PIT DEATH: DELHI POLICE NAMES 3 IN CHARGE SHEET

Jignasa Sinha

letters@hindustantimes.com

**NEW DELHI:** Delhi Police has charged three people with negligence and violation of safety norms in connection with the death of a man who fell into a pit dug by the Delhi Jal Board (DJB) in Janakpuri in February. In its 877-page charge sheet filed on Tuesday, the police have named Himanshu Gupta, the suspended director of a firm contracted by DJB, subcontractor Rajesh Kumar Prajapati, and labourer Yogesh Kishor, as accused. >93

## 42-yr-old man beheaded in Bihar market, suspect lynched by mob

Aditya Nath Jha

letters@hindustantimes.com

**ARARIA:** A 42-year-old pickup van driver was beheaded allegedly by a roadside vendor, who was later beaten to death by local residents in Bihar's Araria district on Thursday, prompting additional deployment of police force as the two belong to different faiths, senior officers said. According to Jitendra Kumar, superintendent of police (SP), Araria district, the incident took place in the

market where he picked up a quarrel with Hussain and attacked him with a dagger," the SP said. Chauhan left Hussain's beheaded body on the road and fled, police said.

"Onlookers caught hold of Chauhan and thrashed... He was taken to a hospital where he succumbed to injuries," the SP said. Sub-divisional police officer (SDPO) Mukesh Kumar Saha said police have launched an investigation into the incident from "multiple angles, including a parking dispute." >99

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[ MY INDIA ] RESCUE TEAMS DEPLOYED

**2-year-old boy falls into borewell in MP**



[ SPORT ] CD GOPINATH

**India's oldest Test cricketer dies at 96**







**Austria's Federal Chancellor Christian Stocker** will undertake a four-day visit to India beginning April 14 to shore up bilateral cooperation in a range of areas including trade, investment and critical technologies. The top Austrian leader will hold extensive talks with Prime Minister Narendra Modi on bilateral ties and exchange views on regional and global issues, the Ministry of External Affairs (MEA) said on Thursday. Stocker's trip will mark both his inaugural official visit to Asia and his first trip to India. "They will also exchange views on regional and global issues of mutual interest, including cooperation in multilateral fora. Prime Minister will host a lunch in honour of the visiting dignitary," the MEA said. Stocker will also call on President Droupadi Murmu. "India and Austria share warm, friendly and multi-faceted ties, rooted in shared democratic values," the MEA said.



**Four astronauts travelling back to Earth** from the far side of the moon on NASA's Artemis II mission spoke of their emotions as they wrapped up the unprecedented flight and prepared to re-enter the atmosphere in a "fireball," during their first press conference from space on Wednesday. The Artemis II crew, flying in Orion capsule since launching last week, are due to splash down off the Southern California coast on Friday after reaching the moon earlier this week. They cruised along a path that took them past the shadowed, lunar far side to become the farthest-flying humans in history. On the return trip, they will reach speeds of up to 23,839 mph as they enter the Earth's atmosphere, a high-risk phase that will put Orion's heatshield to the test as it gets battered by intense atmospheric friction.



**Hindustan Times** Number Theory  
**The T20 World Cup takes the IPL template forward**



**A two-and-a-half-year-old boy fell into an open borewell** while playing in a field in Madhya Pradesh's Ujjain district on Thursday evening and a rescue operation is underway, police said. The incident took place at around 8pm in Jhalaria village under Badnagar tehsil. The child, identified as Bhagirath, is the son of Praveen Dewasi, a shepherd who had arrived in the area with his family three days ago from Rajasthan's Pali. The family was grazing sheep in the area when the incident took place. On receiving information, Badnagar Station House Officer Ashok Patidar reached the spot with a team. Oxygen is being pumped into the borewell shaft through a pipe, the official said, adding that a team of the State Disaster Response Force reached the spot with necessary equipment for rescue.



**India's oldest living Test cricketer, CD Gopinath**, died at the age of 96 on Thursday, marking the end of the last living link to the country's first-ever Test-winning team. Gopinath was the world's second-oldest living Test cricketer after Australian great Neil Harvey (97) and is survived by his wife, children and grandchildren. In the statistician's book, Gopinath's numbers will always remain modest - 8 Tests, that yielded 242 runs with one fifty. But, typically of him, Gopinath never felt bitter about a short career that started on a promising note with a 50 and 42 against England at the Brabourne in 1951. But Gopinath remained a significant figure in domestic cricket, scoring heavily and capturing in domestic cricket, 4,259 runs in 83 matches at an average of 42. He also tallied nine hundreds. Following his demise, Mumbai's 95-year-old Chandrakant Potankar has become the country's oldest cricketer.

## SC: Temple entry curbs will end up dividing society

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**NEW DELHI:** The Supreme Court on Thursday cautioned that excluding people from temples on grounds of caste, belief or denominational identity could have a damaging effect on Hinduism itself, observing that the constitutional endeavour must be to "unify and not create further divisions" within society. "Keep aside the Sabarimala controversy...everybody must have access to every temple and mutt. But if you say it is a practice...that only my section must attend my temple and no one else, that is not good for Hinduism," the nine-judge bench led by Chief Justice of India Surya Kant remarked, adding that such an approach would end up "dividing the society further."

Everybody must have access to every temple...if you say...that only my section must attend my temple and no one else, that is not good for Hinduism

### SUPREME COURT

daya do not restrict themselves to one institution," observed the court, questioning the feasibility of rigid denominational barriers in a religion marked by internal plurality. Justice Nagarathna, on her part, emphasised that any interpretation permitting exclusion of entire sections from places of worship could foster division rather than cohesion. "We have to unify...we do not have to divide further," she remarked. In another significant exchange, the court highlighted a potential inconsistency in arguments that seek judicial deference in matters relating to religious denominations and temple entry while endorsing intervention in practices such as triple talaq as measures of social reform—as argued by Vaidyanathan.

"There is an inherent contradiction in your submissions. You cannot take a stand here and say triple talaq is okay because that is also a part of the religion. You may not subscribe to the way it is done and how someone misuses or misinterprets it, (but) it does not give rights to the court to interfere. You cannot have this contradictory stand," pressed Justice Anurag Kishore, noting that both sets of issues engage questions of faith, practice and constitutional rights.

The hearing also revisited the scope of judicial review, with the court reiterating its position from Wednesday that religious freedoms are not absolute and remain subject to constitutional limitations. The bench had then pushed back against the Centre's argument for judicial restraint, emphasising that courts cannot be "completely demoralised" of jurisdiction in cases involving manifest constitutional violations.

On Thursday, this theme was extended to the question of access to places of worship, with the court suggesting that an overly expansive interpretation of denominational rights could risk fragmenting religious communities and undermining the broader constitutional goal of social unity.

The proceedings also saw a brief debate on the scope of denominational questions arising from the 2019 reference, including the contours of essential religious practices, the balance between individual rights and denominational autonomy, and the limits of judicial review in matters of faith.

## Hungary at crossroads, key vote nears

A long-dominant leader confronts a fast-rising challenger in Sunday's crucial elections that could reshape the country's politics and reverberate across Europe



### Right-wing strongman at helm

**Viktor Orbán, 62, leader of ruling Fidesz**, has governed Hungary since 2010, centralising power and repeatedly clashing with the EU. He has framed the polls as a choice between peace and war, maintaining close ties with Vladimir Putin and resisting EU support for Ukraine. Donald Trump and Georgia Meloni are among his backers. US vice president JD Vance visited Budapest this week to boost his campaign.



### A new political challenger rises

**Peter Magyar, 45, a former Orbán ally**, joined the Centre-Right Tiszta party in 2024. His campaign targets rising living costs, struggling public services and corruption, while pledging to restore democratic institutions and repair EU ties. Younger and urban voters have energised his bid, making the race highly competitive.

135 Fidesz-KDNP coalition

Opinion poll trends

| Agency      | Fidesz | Tiszta |
|-------------|--------|--------|
| Ideia       | 30     | 39     |
| Iranys      | 34     | 41     |
| Publicis    | 30     | 36     |
| 21 Research | 28     | 40     |
| Zavecz      | 31     | 39     |
| Republikon  | 31     | 37     |
| Median      | 30     | 46     |

Figures in %

15 10 9 7 23

DK MSZP Jobbik Others

### A close race with high stakes

Independent surveys show Tiszta ahead, while pro-government forecasts favour the ruling Fidesz. Prediction market data indicate shifting momentum bets on Magyar becoming Prime Minister have exceeded 70%, while Orbán's chances have dropped below 30%.

### Security tensions before the vote

Reports of explosives near a pipeline supplying gas to Hungary surfaced ahead of polling. Orbán called an emergency meeting, highlighting national vulnerability and the need for strong leadership. Magyar questioned the timing, accusing the government of using fear to influence voters.

### Why poll matters beyond Hungary

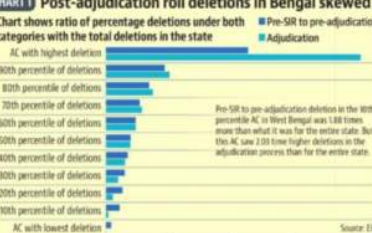
The result could shape Hungary's direction and influence Europe. Another Orbán victory may deepen EU tensions and embolden nationalist movements. A Magyar win could signal a democratic reset, though entrenched institutions may limit change. Analysts warn uncertainty remains due to undecided voters, electoral map changes favouring Fidesz, and strong support from ethnic Hungarians abroad.

### How the country votes

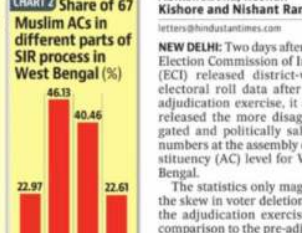
It uses a mixed system. Voters cast two ballots, one for a local candidate and one for a party list. Of the 199 seats, 106 are constituency-based and 93 allocated proportionally. Hungarians abroad can also mail-in votes.

## Seat-wise data reveals skew in adjudication cuts

### CHART 1 Post-adjudication roll deletions in Bengal skewed



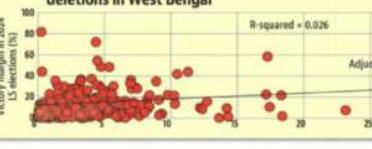
### CHART 2 Share of 67 Muslim ACs in different parts of SIR process in West Bengal (%)



### CHART 3A Victory margin in 2024 Lok Sabha elections versus pre-adjudication deletions in West Bengal



### CHART 3B Victory margin in 2024 Lok Sabha elections versus overall SIR deletions in West Bengal



### ASSEMBLY-LEVEL DATA SHOWS ADJUDICATION DELETIONS TWICE AS CONCENTRATED IN MUSLIM-MAJORITY SEATS AS THEIR STATE ELECTORATE SHARE

The statistics only magnify the skew in voter deletions in the adjudication exercise in comparison to the pre-adjudication Special Intensive Revision Exercise (SIR) in the state. For context, 13 states and Union territories have undergone SIR so far (although West Bengal is awaited in Uttar Pradesh), and Assam underwent a Special Revision (SR) exercise. But West Bengal is the only state that underwent a special adjudication exercise after the SIR process. The state saw a net deletion of 6.2 million voters between pre-SIR to pre-adjudication exercise, and another 2.7 million have been deleted in the adjudication exercise, taking the total net deletions to 8.9 million. To be sure, the final elector count for the state before the election could still change because of new voters being added and the fate of 22,163 voters, who are still to be adjudicated in the data released. That said, how is the adjudication process different from the pre-adjudication SIR process in West Bengal? Here is what the data shows.

roll to the post-adjudication roll are 0.3% and 7.53%, a ratio of 25.8. (See Chart 1)

One big reason for the bigger skew in deletions during adjudication is the disproportionate deletions which have happened in ACs which are likely Muslim dominated.

HT put together a list of 67 ACs which saw at least one Muslim MLA being elected in the 2011, 2016 and 2021 assembly elections in West Bengal. This would suggest a significant number of Muslim electors in the AC. Pre-2011 ACs are not comparable with the current ones because the 2008 delimitation process led to a change in AC boundaries. These 67 ACs had a share of 23% in the state's pre-SIR elector roll. They saw a 19% state-wide share in pre-SIR to pre-adjudication removal of voters, somewhat in line with their pre-SIR share in total electors. But they had 46% share in electors being put under adjudication and now account for 40.5% of the deletions under the adjudication process. To be sure, these ACs have not seen a drastic fall in their elector-share in the state, which continues to be 22.6% as of now. (See Chart 2)

That said, the pre-adjudication deletions, or deletions post-adjudication do not seem to suggest a relation with either victory margins at the AC level in the latest (2024) election in the state or party-wise winners. (See Charts 3A, 3B).



## Janakpuri pit death: Contractor, 2 others named in charge sheet

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**NEW DELHI:** The Delhi Police has alleged negligence and non-compliance with safety norms on the part of the three accused in the Janakpuri pit death case, wherein a 25-year-old man fell into a freshly dug pit along with his motorbike on the intervening night of February 5 and 6, but was only discovered by a passerby the next morning.

In their 877-page charge sheet filed in Dwarka court on Tuesday, the police named three persons associated with a company contracted by the Delhi Jal Board (DJB) for working on the pit project. They are Himanshu Gupta, 45, the suspended director of KKS PUN Pvt India Ltd, Rajesh Kumar Prajapati, 47, the subcontractor working on the project, and Yogesh Kishor, 23, a labourer on site, who allegedly tried to cover up the incident.

Deputy commissioner of police (west) Darade Sharad Bhaskar said, "Gupta has been identified as the suspended director of the main contractor company that undertook the project. His associate, Prajapati, was the subcontractor and Kishor was deployed for the project by Prajapati. The investigation into other suspects and alleged accident is still going on, and the supplementary investigation report would be submitted before the court via a supplementary charge sheet soon."

### 'Negligence, non-compliance'

On the intervening night of February 5-6, 25-year-old Kamal Dhyani, travelling back home on his motorbike from Rohini to Palam Colony, falls into the pit. His body is discovered next morning

- | The accused                                                                         | Key allegations                                                                      |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| ● Himanshu Gupta, 45, director of company awarded the contract by DJB               | ● Pit left uncovered with no warning sign, reflectors, barricades or proper lighting |
| ● Rajesh Kumar Prajapati, 47, the subcontractor working on the project              | ● Non-compliance with safety measures                                                |
| ● Yogesh Kishor, 23, labourer on site, who allegedly tried to cover up the incident | ● Kishor misled Dhyani's family, who were looking for him                            |

"As per our investigation, it looks like a conspiracy from the side of the accused. They intentionally did not tell the police, flee and lie to the family to cover their misdeeds. They also tried to mislead investigators"

— POLICE OFFICER



mentary charge sheet soon"

A police officer, who asked not to be named, said, "The workers dug the pit a day before the incident and it was left uncovered. There were no warning signs, reflectors, barricades or proper lighting arrangements. The pit was left open in the middle of a public road without any safety measure."

Police said that the "non compliance" to safety measures were proved with the help of CCTVs.

The charge sheet states that the excavation site was left "unsecured" and this transformed a sewer project into a "death trap".

On the intervening night of February 5-6, 25-year-old Kamal Dhyani, who worked at a private bank in Rohini, was going to his home in Palam Colony when he fell into the pit. The charge sheet states that the pit was 15 feet deep.

The police official said that the incident took place around midnight and a passerby was the

"first" person who saw the victim fall into the pit, at around 12.15am. He said, "The man informed a security guard, who, in turn, approached Kishor. Kishor even walked to the pit and saw the bike and body..."

Police said several CCTV cameras and call detail records showed that Kishor called Prajapati at 12.22am and Prajapati was "spotted" at the scene at 12.45am.

Police said in the charge sheet that both men "saw" the body but

did not inform the police. They said that the men then called Gupta and others.

The charge sheet also states that Kishor "misled" Dhyani's family, who were looking for him. It also states that all of them fled after the incident. Gupta was caught a month after the incident, from Rajasthan, said the police.

While the police initially booked the accused for culpable homicide not amounting to murder, sections pertaining to giving false information to screen offenders, criminal conspiracy and using forged documents as genuine were added later.

A third senior police officer said the charge sheet includes detailed findings on the role and responsibilities of the accused persons, contractual arrangements between the company and DJB, and on-site conditions at the time of the incident.

A lawyer for Gupta, asked not to be named, said, "How could Gupta make a call when he was not here? He found out very late. Also, he had been suspended from his position on July 11, 2025. The powers were with a resolution professional who takes a decision with the committee or creditors. I can't comment on the charge sheet as I am yet to receive it. In any case, the Delhi Police's allegations are all false."

The counsels for Prajapati and Kishor did not respond to requests for comment.

## Delhi reshuffles 33 bureaucrats across departments, key posts

HT Correspondent  
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**NEW DELHI:** Prashant Goyal, a 1993-batch IAS officer of the AGMUT cadre, was given charge as the additional chief secretary of power and administrative reforms, in a series of 33 transfers of IAS and DANICS officers, according to an order issued by the services department on Wednesday.

As part of the exercise, 1989-batch IAS officer G Narendra Kumar—who was awaiting promotion—replaced Goyal as the financial commissioner, the order stated.

Among other significant changes, Soumya Saurabh was given the additional charge of special secretary (industries), alongside her current role as the district magistrate of North West Delhi. Sonika Singh, who was serving as special secretary-cum-private secretary to the Delhi lieutenant governor, has been posted as the Delhi Development Authority (DDA) commissioner.

Under the Delhi, Andaman and Nicobar Islands, Lakshadweep, Daman and Diu and Dadra and Nagar Haveli Civil Service (DANICS) cadre, Navendra Kumar Singh, a 2006-

batch officer serving as the additional director (social welfare) has been transferred to the role of additional commissioner (GST).

Harshit Jain, was transferred from the post of joint director (education) to joint secretary of the Legislative Assembly Secretariat.

The reshuffle also includes a broader administrative overhaul, with transfers and postings of subdivisional magistrates (SDMs), additional district magistrates (ADMs), and district magistrates (DMs) across multiple districts in the Capital.

## 3 HELD FOR ATTACK ON CAR OF CHILD SPIRITUAL CONTENT CREATOR IN W DELHI

HT Correspondent  
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**NEW DELHI:** Three men were arrested for allegedly attacking the family of spiritual content creator Abhinav Arora in a road rage incident in west Delhi's Tilak Nagar, police said on Thursday. The accused allegedly broke the car's window and threatened Arora's family, police added.

According to the video of the incident, posted by Arora on his Instagram handle, a group of men were seen damaging the car's window with their "kadas" and threatening the family.

DCP (west) Darade Sharad Bhaskar said the incident took place around 10pm on Tuesday when Arora's father was driving the car and it brushed against a motorbike. "The biker and his associates alleged rash driving and injuries. The accused then hit the bonnet and windows with their kadas," the DCP said. Arora, who is around 10-12 years old, was not inside the car during the incident. The accused were sent to judicial custody for two days.

## CM DIRECTS CIVIC BODIES TO FINISH DESILTING BY JUNE

**NEW DELHI:** Chief minister Rekha Gupta on Thursday chaired a high-level review meeting and directed departments concerned to complete desilting before June 30, officials said. The meeting was held to chart out a more effective response to the chronic waterlogging problem, they said.

CM Gupta cited the example of Minto Road and said the area did not witness waterlogging last monsoon despite a long history of flooding and directed all departments to ensure special arrangements at hot spots.

She flagged the recurring issue of garbage clogging drain inlets, which often leads to water accumulation at site stretches.

She said that lack of coordination among departments often worsened the situation, and warned agencies against passing the buck.

## DJB limits access to KNO portal to curb cybercrimes

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**NEW DELHI:** More than a year after the Delhi Jal Board (DJB) website's Know Your KNO portal allowed scammers to steal data of residents and misuse it for targeted cybercrimes, the Delhi Jal Board has restricted access to information only to registered users, officials aware of the matter said.

Previously, officials said, unrestricted access allowed scammers to call customers posing as DJB officials and threaten disconnection to steal money. A check by HT found that at present, the portal now asks for a mobile number and a one-time password for users to log in.

A Delhi Jal Board spokesperson said, "Yes, we have made permanent changes now. Earlier, we removed the portal but we know the customers do need the portal to access KNO. So, we are now only allowing registered users. Only they can log in. Earlier, anyone could see details of any resident. Now, even after log in, you can access only your connection details. We have stopped giving out all personal details to

protect the citizens." In June 2025, Delhi Police had flagged the mass cyber scam. The accused would contact victims with disconnection threats, use their personal and bill details to establish credibility, and steal money through malicious mobile applications or other means. The scam accounted for 20% of the cybercrimes reported in Delhi during that period.

The DJB also sought to create awareness then, as previously, anyone could input a partial address—as few as 10 characters—and access detailed results showing residents' full names, addresses, mobile numbers, and unique connection numbers (KNOs). There are 2.9 million water connections across Delhi.

On Thursday, the Delhi Police said they have now received information that the portal has been completely revised. "We received information in March about the changes. Taking our suggestion, the portal is now offering only restricted access to residents only. This has prevented the cases and we don't get DJB-related calls now," a senior police officer aware of the investigation said.

{ NO PERMISSION }

## Workers' stir over wages in Manesar turns violent

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**GURUGRAM:** A wage protest at Gurugram's IMT Manesar industrial hub turned violent on Thursday, leaving at least 22 people injured—including eight police officers—and four factories ransacked after clashes broke out between workers and police. Police said stone-pelting forced them to act; workers said they were charged without warning.

The unrest, building since Monday across multiple factories, erupted when police officials said, workers at two adjacent plants in Sector-4 attempted to block the main road in defiance of prohibitory orders issued the previous day barring gatherings of five or more people carrying weapons.

Assistant commissioner of police (Manesar) Virender Saini, who was among the injured, said police moved to clear the road when workers turned on them. "We tried to stop them from blocking the traffic when they turned violent and started stone pelting. Police retaliated, after which clashes took place," he said. Saini sustained multiple bruises and cuts; a constable suffered a



(Above) Private cars on the premises of several firms were damaged. (Right) A piece of burnt record.

grievous leg injury. One police motorcycle was set on fire and four other vehicles—including those belonging to the in-charges of two police stations—were wrecked.

Workers who fled a police lathi-charge subsequently barged into at least four factories, damaging cars, glass walls and machinery.

Police said social media posts—circulated against the backdrop of a central government-mandated minimum wage revision under new labour laws— and WhatsApp exchanges had sparked the violence.

DCP (Manesar) Prabina P

said 18 people—including women—had been detained for questioning on the basis of CCTV footage.

Police said at least 70 to 100 unidentified suspects were booked in an FIR on charges of damaging government property, rioting, unlawful assembly and obstructing public servant for discharge of duty.

Kaushal Sinha, general manager of Satyam Auto, where a protest had taken place on Saturday, said, "After their protest, we had a counselling session and detailed interaction... about increasing the wages as per new labour laws. The protest ended."

{ BETWEEN NIZAMUDDIN AND CP } 3 OF 5 HELD

## Authorickshaw driver stabbed to death for resisting robbery

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**NEW DELHI:** An incident of robbery spiralled into murder when a 22-year-old autorickshaw driver was stabbed to death as he resisted the attempts of the accused, who had boarded his vehicle near the Hazrat Nizamuddin Railway Station in the early hours of April 5 and asked him to drop them at Connaught Place, police officers aware of the incident said.

Police identified the victim as Suraj Kumar, who resided in



Victim Suraj Kumar.

the driver, the accused dumped him near the Shivaji Park bus stand, where he was found lying in a pool of blood. The PCR was

ered. Blood-stained clothes and the knife used in the murder were also seized," an officer associated with the case said.

Based on disclosures by the two and further inputs, a third accused - Suresh (25) - was arrested from near Sarai Kale Khan bus stand in Delhi. Police said that two more accused - Sonu and Vikram - are on the run, and efforts are underway to arrest them. Police said that the accused frequently travelled from Palwal to Delhi by late-night trains, targeting commuters near railway stations and bus stands.

## Ahead of house-listing, govt issues guidelines for Census

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**NEW DELHI:** The Delhi government has issued a detailed notification outlining legal provisions and public responsibilities under the Census Act, 1948, ahead of the upcoming Census 2027, highlighting the need for full cooperation from residents and adherence to due process during data collection.

The notification was issued by the revenue department on April 6 and reiterates the framework within which census operations will be carried out in the Capital. Self-enumeration, currently

### Governance exercise

April 1-15 (underway): Self enumeration in NDMC, DCB areas  
May 1-15: Self enumeration in MCD areas  
April 16-May 15: House-listing exercise

**Safeguards**  
● Individuals cannot be compelled to disclose names of female family members  
● A woman cannot be forced to reveal the name of her husband, alive or deceased, or other relatives

**Offences**  
● Refusal to answer questions  
● Providing false information  
● Obstructing officials  
● Tampering with marks on buildings

her husband, deceased husband obstructing census officials in their duties and damaging their

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### OFFICE OF THE HARYANA HUMAN RIGHTS COMMISSION

NIRMAN SADAN, PLOT NO. 1, SECTOR 33-A, CHANDIGARH

Applications are invited for filling up of one post of Deputy Registrar-cum-Deputy Secretary in Law Division on re-employment basis on formula of last pay drawn minus pension in the Office of Haryana Human Rights Commission, Chandigarh, initially for a period of one year, which can be extended from time to time or till the regular appointment is made, whichever is earlier.

**Qualification for the post of Deputy Registrar-cum-Deputy Secretary**

The person should be Law Graduate from a recognised University having Hindi subject in Matriculation. He/She should have served as a member of HCS/JCS Judicial Service for 5 years or having rendered Class-I Service for 10 years in any State/Central Government Department, preferably dealing with legal matters or having served the Punjab and Haryana High Court for 10 years as Class-I Officer and retired/releasing as Deputy Registrar or from equivalent post.

**Notes:**

- The candidate should not be more than 63 years of age as on 30.04.2026.
- The service of the person so engaged shall cease on the expiry of the term automatically.
- Applications for the post must reach to this Office on or before 30.04.2026.



...the accused are in their 20s and live in Palwal, Haryana. Investigators said that the victim remained unidentified initially and there was no eyewitness.

"Teams scanned CCTV footage and spoke to residents and vendors. Footage analysis revealed that five individuals had hired the autorickshaws near the Nizamuddin station. Their movement was tracked through multiple cameras across Delhi, Faridabad, and Palwal," Deputy Commissioner of Police (central) Rohit Rajbir Singh said.

Police said that after stabbing

...the victim, following which a team from the Kamla Market station took the victim, who had suffered multiple stab wounds to his neck and chest, to Lok Nayak Hospital. He was declared dead, they said.

A case under Section 103(1) (murder) of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita was registered.

Police said they laid a trap near the Palwal railway station and waited for the accused for nearly 12 hours, arresting two of them — Yogesh (25) and Yogesh alias Rocky (24). "At their instance, the stolen autorickshaw and the victim's mobile phone were recovered

...they would continue to be charged and assaults during the night, and return to Palwal before morning to evade detection," the officer said.

Kumar's sister Shilpi Kumari, 24, said that the victim was survived by his wife, who is pregnant, and their one-year-old son. The family had come to Delhi a few months ago.

"My husband bought an autorickshaw and used to drive it in the morning, while Kumar used to drive in the night. He was also taking care of the studies of two of our younger brothers. What will happen to his wife?" she said.

...way in Palwal, and Delhi Cantonment Board areas till April 15, precedes the start of the house-listing operation (HLO) — the first deployment of census officials. The HLO phase will begin April 16 and end on May 15.

According to the notification, while every individual must truthfully answer questions asked by census officials, based on their best knowledge or belief, the Act provides certain safeguards. Individuals, for instance, cannot be compelled to disclose the names of female family members. Similarly, a woman cannot be forced to reveal the name of

...a female, unless she chooses to do so.

The document outlined the powers of census officials, authorising them to enter any house, premises, or place for enumeration. Residents must allow such access and extend necessary cooperation. Officials may also mark or number houses and buildings as part of the census process, and occupants are expected to permit such actions.

The notification also detailed actions that constitute offences under the law. These include refusing to answer questions, providing false information,

...which includes, and delaying such entry into premises. It also prohibits tampering with or removing any marks or numbers placed on buildings for census purposes.

Penalties for violations have also been outlined. Individuals found guilty of non-compliance or obstruction may face fines or other legal consequences as prescribed under the Census Act.

The notification also assured that all information collected during the census will remain confidential. The data will be used strictly for statistical purposes and cannot be used as evidence in legal proceedings.

...Applicants are to submit their application to the office on or before 30.04.2026 by 5.00 P.M. positively.

4. Attested copies of relevant testimonials i.e. Proof of Qualification, Experience, Date of Birth, two recent attested passport-size photographs, Aadhaar Card etc. must be attached with the application. Application without copies of relevant testimonials and received after 30.04.2026 will not be entertained.

**Incomplete application will be summarily rejected.**

5. The interview date will be intimated later on.

6. No TA/DA will be paid.

Sd/-  
Registrar (Law & Legal)  
Haryana Human Rights Commission  
Chandigarh

FD NO. 1243/11/157/2027/44552/C/19/7

# SAME TESTS. TWO DIFFERENT BILLS. ONE MAKES SENSE!

## OTHERS

### XYZ Diagnostics

Patient Name: John Doe

Receipt No: XYZ420

| Test           | Charges |
|----------------|---------|
| MRI Brain      | ₹ 7500  |
| X-ray Chest    | ₹ 550   |
| Sugar, Fasting | ₹ 80    |

Total ₹ 8130



## AARTHI SCANS

### AARTHI SCANS & LABS

Patient Name: John Doe

Receipt No: ASL123

| Test           | Charges |
|----------------|---------|
| MRI Brain      | ₹ 2750  |
| X-ray Chest    | ₹ 275   |
| Sugar, Fasting | ₹ 40    |

Total ₹ 3065



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NEW DELHI  
FRIDAY  
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Hindustan Times

MY DELHI

05

# Govt plans diversion of floodwater from Yamuna

Paras Singh  
hsreporters@hindustantimes.com

**NEW DELHI:** Nearly three years after the 2023 floods, the Delhi government is exploring a plan to divert excess water in the Yamuna during the monsoon into Bhatti Mines pits and six floodplain storage sites to reduce flood risk and boost groundwater recharge, officials said.

According to an assessment carried out by the irrigation and flood control (I&FC) department, the 15 identified mine pits, which developed due to mining operations between 1960 and 1990, can cumulatively hold 5,200 MLD (million litres per day) or 5,20,000 cubic metres of water per day. Similarly, the storage volume of the six floodplain sites is around 13,70,500 cubic metres, a senior government official said.

The official said that after the 2023 floods, the department was asked to explore mitigation measures. "Japan used floodwater diversion techniques, but developing massive underground tanks is expensive and may not be suitable for a river like the Yamuna, which carries excessive silt during the monsoon. Two options studied include storing water in floodplains and Bhatti Mines areas. These can help create a buffer and improve flood management," the official said.

The Bhatti Mines, located in south Delhi near Asola and Chhatrapur, are a massive industrial quarrying area that supplied red sand, silica, and stone for Delhi's construction works from the 1960s to the 1980s. Some of the deep pits left by years of mining have turned into lakes and the area is currently undergoing ecosystem restoration as part of conservation efforts in the Asola Bhatti wildlife sanctuary.

A government official said that a preliminary study on Bhatti Mines was carried out by

## Utilising empty spaces

**OPTION 1: BHATTI MINES**  
It is a Massive industrial quarrying area that supplied red sand, silica, and stone from the 1960s to the 1980s.

**PLAN**  
15 mining pits studied for storing extra water during monsoon  
5.2 million cubic metres of water can be diverted

**OPTION 2: FLOODPLAINS**  
Storage areas identified north and south of old Bawana escape, near Sabapur, south of Wazirabad barrage, area opposite Mayur Vihar, area between railway bridge and ITO bridge

**PLAN**  
Six storage areas of 1.5m depth to be created along floodplains  
13.7 million cubic metres of water can be stored

**ADVANTAGES**  
Buffer during flooding cycles and groundwater recharge  
**CONCERNS**  
Aquifer contamination if polluted water goes in, siltation

the Central Ground Water Board (CGWB). It identified 15 major pits that can be used to recharge groundwater. "Total capacity of these pits is about 5,200 MLD (5,20,000 cubic metres) per day. These pits can be filled with 4,200 million litres of surplus monsoon runoff from the Yamuna for 60 days in a year," the study said.

Located in the Southern Ridge, the mines are underlain by Alwar quartzite of the Delhi System, dating to the Precambrian age. The pre-monsoon groundwater level is at a depth of 48.64 metres below ground level (bgl), improving to 39.17 metres bgl post-monsoon.

The CGWB had earlier undertaken artificial groundwater recharge in the Jawaharlal Nehru University and Sanjay Van areas between 1996 and 1998 by constructing four check dams in the watershed. "The recharge efficiency of pondage created through check dams is 95% to 99.7%. Due to repetitive filling, capacity utilisation of up to 300% was achieved," the report states.

An official said the pits can be filled at least three times a year, allowing up to 12,600 million litres (ML) of water to be stored, provided surplus monsoon water is available.

However, the plan cautions against using polluted water, citing the "highly fractured quartzite" terrain where the aquifer is directly exposed in the pits. "The silt and topsoil already present in the pits must be removed before implementing the recharge project. Periodic desilting will also be required. Water quality monitoring stations need to be established," it adds.

Furthermore, the I&FC department has identified six locations along the floodplain where water can be stored in pits up to 1.5 metres deep. Two sites have been marked on the right bank—north and south of the Old Bawana Escape—while four are on the left bank, including areas near Sabapur, south of the Wazirabad barrage, opposite Mayur Vihar, and between the railway bridge and the ITO bridge.

The Old Bawana Escape site,

spread over 900,000 square metres, can store 1,350,000 cubic metres of water, while the South Old Bawana Escape site, covering 1,70,000 square metres, has a capacity of 1,75,000 cubic metres. The largest site, near Mayur Vihar, spans 3.12 million square metres and can store up to 4,680,000 cubic metres.

"The sites may not be adequate to handle peak flood flows, but they can provide a buffer period and enhance groundwater recharge," an official said.

Bhim Singh Rawat, a Yamuna activist and member of the South Asia Network on Dams, Rivers and People (SANDRP), said that the proposal to divert water to the Bhatti mines has many pitfalls, and that Delhi should focus on the basics to improve its flood preparedness.

"It has the risk of contamination of the groundwater if polluted water reaches the point. Moreover, it will require pumping water, which may be energy-intensive. The water should be flowing from the ridge towards the river, not against it," the activist said.

# Capital's fourth ISBT planned in Dwarka Sec 22 at cost of ₹4,200 cr

Snehl Sinha  
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**NEW DELHI:** The Delhi government is planning to set up an inter-state bus terminal (ISBT) in Dwarka's Sector 22, spanning 12.88 hectares, based on principles of mixed land use and transit-oriented development (TOD) for an integrated mobility hub, senior government officials said on Thursday.

The project is estimated to cost around ₹4,200 crore, with income from bus operations alone estimated at ₹900 crore annually, besides non-fare commercial and retail operations, officials said.

"The location has been identified for its connectivity advantages, with proximity to the Dwarka Sector 21 Metro station, Bijwasan railway station and the Indira Gandhi International Airport, as well as access to major road corridors and Yashohoomi. This new ISBT aims to decongest the existing three ISBTs that are handling more buses than their capacity as of now. This also leads to severe congestion on the roads around them, which will also be addressed if the buses are divided across locations," transport minister Pankaj Singh said.

The plan to build an ISBT with mixed land use and TOD is a first, officials said. The proposal also aligns with the Delhi government's plans to redevelop the ISBTs at Anand Vihar and Sarai Kale Khan on mixed



**Integrated hub**  
Location: Sec 22, Dwarka  
Located near Metro Blue Line, Airport Express Lines, Bijwasan railway station, IGI Airport, UER-II and Yashohoomi

land use basis, including creation of residential and commercial spaces for maximum utilisation and upgrading infrastructure to cater to demands for the next 25 years. According to the plan shared by the government, nearly 60% of the permissible floor area ratio (FAR) will be allocated for residential development of up to six or seven floors, primarily in the form of high-density, transit-oriented housing. The residential component is expected to include affordable housing units integrated with community facilities.

As per the revised framework for TOD policy announced earlier this week, the government has mandated that at least 60% of any TOD project will include affordable housing of units spanning less than 100 square-metre area.

Around 15-20% of the FAR has been earmarked for commercial use, including retail, office and hospitality spaces of up to five floors, while public and semi-public facilities will account for roughly 10% of the total. Green spaces, landscaped areas and pedestrian pathways are also part of the plan. The ISBT will run on the remaining area.

A site area distribution chart in the proposal indicates that approximately 225,000 square metres will be used for housing, 65,000 sqm for commercial development, around 27,000 sqm for the DTC bus depot and around 50,000 sqm for public facilities. The rest of the area, around 15,000 sqm, will host passenger amenities, ticketing and bus operations. The total built-up area is proposed to be around 386,000 sqm.

Officials said the objective behind the project is to develop an ISBT that not only handles passenger traffic efficiently, but also leverages TOD principles to optimise land use and generate revenue, officials said.

"The Dwarka ISBT is being planned as a self-sustaining mobility hub. By combining transport infrastructure with residential and commercial components, we aim to reduce congestion at existing ISBTs while creating a new urban transit node in West Delhi," the minister said.

The planning vision outlined in a document submitted to the government emphasises walkability, high-density development and efficient land utilisation. The proposal also highlights the creation of active public spaces, including plazas and pedestrian-friendly zones, to enhance urban experience and accessibility.

According to the plan, the residential component is projected to generate approximately ₹3,700 crore, while commercial development could yield about ₹1,400 crore, contributing to overall project viability.

The project is currently at the planning stage, with consultants set to be appointed to prepare detailed project report and financial structuring, officials said, adding that once approvals are in place, the government will move towards tendering and phased execution of the project.

## [ REGISTRATION OF AI ARTWORK ]

# HC notice on US researcher's copyright plea

Shruti Kakkar  
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**NEW DELHI:** The Delhi high court, in a first on Thursday, directed the Copyright Office to decide within eight weeks an application filed by American AI researcher Dr Stephen Thaler seeking copyright registration for his artwork, generated by an artificial intelligence (AI) system he developed.

The artistic work titled "A Recent Entrance to Paradise", was generated by Thaler using

his AI system DABUS (Device for the Autonomous Bootstrapping of Unified Sentience).

Thaler has filed multiple applications across jurisdictions, including the United Kingdom, New Zealand and the United States, seeking recognition of his AI system as an inventor or author. In March, the US Supreme Court declined to entertain his petition challenging decisions of federal authorities and courts refusing copyright registration for the same artistic work. The present appli-

cation marks Dr Thaler's first legal action in India concerning copyright protection for AI-generated work.

A bench of Justice Tushar Rao Gedela passed the order after the lawyer for the Registrar of Copyright submitted that it had now scheduled a hearing in the copyright application for April 27.

In view of the aforesaid development, scheduling the date of hearing, it is noted that the subject application seeking copyright of the artistic work submitted in 2022 and having

regards to the fact that no hearing was issued to the petitioner, it would be appropriate to request the Registrar of Copyright to conduct the hearing and conclude the same in eight weeks from the date of hearing," the court said in its order.

In his petition, argued by advocates Ankit Sahni and Chirag Ahluwalia, Thaler contended that his application for copyright registration of the artistic work has remained pending before the Copyright Office for nearly four years without any decision.

HC

## Drowning cause of Noida student death: Autopsy

**NEW DELHI:** A day after a 23-year-old college student died after he entered a 20-foot-deep water-filled vacant plot in Noida Sector 94, police said on Thursday that his autopsy revealed that he had died of drowning. Police had identified the victim as Harshit Bhatt, a third-year student of Amity

Jasjeev Gandhiok  
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**NEW DELHI:** The Delhi transport department has taken against erring vehicles, and challans have been issued to 60 vehicles without a valid PUC.

The NCT was hearing a plea filed in 2024 by BJP MLA Jiten Mahajan, alleging that authorities tasked with enforce-

menting the Graded Response Action

periodically assessed and renewed. In a submission dated April 7, the transport department said, "Action has been taken against erring vehicles, and challans have been issued to 60 vehicles without a valid PUC."

The NCT was hearing a plea filed in 2024 by BJP MLA Jiten Mahajan, alleging that authorities tasked with enforce-

menting the Graded Response Action

periodically assessed and renewed. In a submission dated April 7, the transport department said, "Action has been taken against erring vehicles, and challans have been issued to 60 vehicles without a valid PUC."

The NCT was hearing a plea filed in 2024 by BJP MLA Jiten Mahajan, alleging that authorities tasked with enforce-



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INVITES BID THROUGH E-TENDER

Leasing of 15,800 Sqm Railway Land for Commercial Development at New Loco Colony for 60 Years & Redevelopment of 32 Nos. of Type-II Railway Quarters at Chaliswan Railway Colony, Ayodhya, U.P

ON REVENUE SHARE MODEL

(RFP No. RLDA/2026/RFP/CRD-31 of 2026 Dated : 27.03.2026)



University.

**NGT seeks Ghazipur landfill clearing plan**

**NEW DELHI:** The National Green Tribunal (NGT) directed the Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD) to disclose a time-bound action plan, within four weeks, to clear legacy waste at the Ghazipur landfill. "MCD is directed to place on record the time bound plan for clearing the waste at Ghazipur site," NGT said, listing the matter for July 7.

**Assembly sets July 31 deadline for health report**

**NEW DELHI:** The Delhi Assembly has set July 31 deadline to submit an action taken report on recommendations of Public Accounts Committee on the health infra, an official said on Thursday.

tighten compliance across its own fleet through a fresh directive – which directs all government bodies to ensure PUC is

{ 'LG LISTENING POST' APP }

## LG asks public to share grievances through app

**Karn Pratap Singh**  
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**NEW DELHI:** Lieutenant Governor (LG) Taranjit Singh Sandhu has asked Delhi residents to share their grievances directly with him and the LG secretary through the "LG Listening Post" mobile app.

The initiative was launched during the tenure of former LG Tejender Khanna in 2007 as a web portal, but was almost moribund, officials aware of the initiative said, adding that the move aims for a proactive, direct interface with people and to make governance citizen-centric. A dedicated cell under a senior official in the LG secretariat

Plan (GRAP) – a short-term pollution-mitigating measure – were themselves in violation, with a large share of government

has been set up to handle and dispose of grievances posted on the mobile application, by email to the official email [lgcd.delhi@nic.in](mailto:lgcd.delhi@nic.in), or on the official website [www.listeningpost-delhi.in](http://www.listeningpost-delhi.in), the officials said.

Residents of Delhi are encouraged to share their grievances through the LG Listening Post platform. Your voice matters, and we are committed to listening with sensitivity and responding with care. You may submit your concerns through the official website, mobile app, or via email for timely and appropriate redressal. Sandhu pushed on X on Wednesday.

The LG has also directed the upgrade of the mobile app for effective redressal.

## 2020 RIOTS: SAIFI GETS 5-DAY BAIL FOR ATTENDING FAMILY WEDDINGS

**Arnabjit Sur**  
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**NEW DELHI:** A Delhi court has granted five days' interim bail to Khalid Saifi, one of the accused booked in the northeast Delhi 2020 riots, to attend weddings of his niece and nephew.

The order, allowing Saifi relief from April 15 to 20, was passed by additional sessions judge Sameer Bajpai of Karkardooma courts on Thursday.

Saifi, alongside activists Sharjeel Imam and former JNU student Umar Khalid, are among the 20 people booked under the stringent Unlawful Activities (Prevention) Act in connection with the riots. The case is currently at the argument stage.



### PROJECT HIGHLIGHTS

- Prime location in the Faizabad-Ayodhya twin-city region, directly benefiting from ongoing infrastructure development and the growth of religious tourism.
- Proximity to key religious and tourist destinations, including Shri Ram Janmabhoomi Mandir (9.5 km), ensuring sustained pilgrimage-driven visitor inflow.
- Strong multi-modal connectivity, with Ayodhya Cantt (Faizabad) Railway Station which is within 1 km from the site and Maharishi Valmiki International Airport, Ayodhya Dham 4.5 km, enhancing accessibility for regional and national visitors.
- High development potential for hotel and commercial uses, supported by Ayodhya's expanding infrastructure and consistently increasing religious tourism activity.

**Reserve Price**  
(in terms of NPV)  
**Rs.122.87 Cr**

**LEASE PERIOD**  
**60 Years**

**AREA TO BE LEASED**  
**15,800 Sqm**

**Redevelopment Cost**  
**Rs. 8.13 Cr**  
(32 Nos. Quarters)

**Offline and Online Pre-Bid Meeting Details**

**15.04.2026 at 12:00 hrs**

**Last Date of Submission of E-Bid Online**

**14.05.2026 upto 15:00 hrs**

For further details of the project, please visit our website <https://rlda.indianrailways.gov.in> or e-procurement portal <https://www.tenderwizard.in/rlda> under the heading 'e-tender'

Note: Any corrigendum or addendum will be published only on above mentioned websites

For any clarifications, may please contact:  
Shri Sanjay Kumar Yadav, GM/Tender/RD/DA Shri Jagdish Chandra, Joint General Manager/P-3 Consultant: M/s Knight Frank M/s Rahul Ganguly For e-bid queries - M/s Mayank Singh  
E-mail: [gmtdelhi@rlda.gov.in](mailto:gmtdelhi@rlda.gov.in) E-mail: [rldg@rlda.gov.in](mailto:rldg@rlda.gov.in) E-mail: [rahul.ganguly@kfr.com](mailto:rahul.ganguly@kfr.com) E-mail: [mayank.singh@tenderwizard.com](mailto:mayank.singh@tenderwizard.com)  
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RDLA Head Office Address - Rail Land Development Authority Unit No. 702-B, 7<sup>th</sup> Floor, Connetxus Tower-II, DMRC Building, Ajmeri Gate, Delhi-110002

{ AIRLINE BOOKING SCAM | CHEAP TICKETS TO US, CANADA

## 4 arrested for duping NRIs with fake website

**Jignasa Sinha**  
jignasa.sinha@hindustantimes.com

**NEW DELHI:** Four people have been arrested for allegedly setting up a fake airline ticket booking website and Instagram page to target NRIs, offering cheap tickets to the US and Canada and duping hundreds of customers, a police officer said on Thursday.

The key accused, a 34-year-old man, was arrested from his residence in Patel Nagar. A Mercedes S Class, which he allegedly purchased with the duped money, ₹47 lakh in cash, and other valuables, was recovered from his possession.

**MERCEDES S CLASS, ₹47 LAKH IN CASH WERE RECOVERED FROM POSSESSION OF KEY ACCUSED**

Subsequently, his associates, a 24-year-old, a 20-year-old and a 52-year-old man were arrested from Mumbai.

According to the police, the matter came to light on Tuesday when a south Delhi-based businessman approached them and alleged that his brother, who lives in Canada and was planning to come to India, was cheated out of ₹3.8

lakh on a ticket-booking platform.

During the probe, a police team discovered a fake website, 'flypedia.ca', and an Instagram page with the same name, both of which have been active for a year.

The accused offered heavy discounts on flights from the US and Canada. They even had contact numbers with a US dialling code, which they used to target people. Several fake videos of people using the app and getting discounts were promoted on the page. After booking on the website, people would get calls from the US number for confirmation, the

DCP (southwest) Amit Goel said, adding that the tickets were never delivered.

"We found that the syndicate was being run from Delhi, Gurugram, Goa and Mumbai and mainly cheated NRIs," the DCP said.

"The key accused had set up a call centre in Goa and had procured mule accounts from Mumbai to siphon off funds. Raids were conducted in Maharashtra, and based on the key accused's statement, his associates were held from Mumbai," said the DCP.

The key accused associates supplied mule accounts and bank details.

06

Hindustan Times

MY DELHI

NEW DELHI  
FRIDAY  
APRIL 10, 2026

## Farmhouses, jhuggis near Sainik Farm demolished in DDA drive

**Snehl Sinha**  
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**NEW DELHI:** The Delhi Development Authority (DDA) on Thursday said it had carried out a demolition drive to remove "unauthorised construction" within the boundary of Tilpach Valley Biodiversity Park, near Sainik Farm in south Delhi, as part of efforts to reclaim government land and strengthen the park's green cover.

According to officials, the drive, carried out with the assistance from Delhi Police and in the presence of forest officials, targeted multiple land parcels in village Maidanagarhi that fall within the notified limits of the biodiversity park. Demolition activities were undertaken across several plot (khasra) numbers. "Approximately 70% of the affected area (about 83 acres) was recovered. Around 12 acres of land, comprising 23 farmhouses, were demolished



The drive targeted multiple land parcels in village Maidanagarhi, said officials.

and cleared," DDA said in a statement.

However, residents in the area claimed the DDA officials arrived around 5am and demolished only parts of two farmhouses and some jhuggis.

The DDA further said that approximately three acres of land, involving seven farmhouses, could not be cleared due

to active judicial stay orders issued by the high court.

"The action forms part of ongoing efforts to protect ecological assets, safeguard government land, and expand the green cover of Tilpach Valley Biodiversity Park," the statement said.

President of Western Avenue Residents' Welfare Association in Sainik Farm, Hardeep Singh, said, "DDA has been claiming that the land belongs to its horticulture department but there is an ongoing case. In a clandestine manner, they arrived at dawn and broke down two farmhouses. The owners got fresh stay orders on the proceedings by 10.30 am, soon after the court order, but DDA had done most of its job by then."

One of the affected home owners said he has been living there for the past 28 years. He added that the claims of the area being part of forest land started only about seven years ago and the issue has been in dispute

since then.

"Initially we got notices from the forest and revenue departments. In 2019, they demolished part of our boundary wall but we got stay orders against both departments. They now changed tactics and sent notices through the DDA's horticulture department before carrying out the drive," said Rajeev Wadhwa, one of the affected owners.

He said the action is illegal as the matter is in court.

"In this area, there are overlaps with the forested areas. We have been asking DDA to conduct a physical survey for demarcation for years but they have refrained from it. They claim that a satellite survey has been done, but there is no demarcation yet and ambiguity continues," said Wadhwa.

Tilpach Valley Biodiversity Park, located along the southern ridge, is part of a network of biodiversity parks developed to restore degraded forest land.

## MCD LAUNCHES 24 'NIGAM SHRI' SCHOOLS WITH IMPROVED INFRA

**HT Correspondent**  
hreporters@hindustantimes.com

**NEW DELHI:** The Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD) has launched 24 Nigam Shri schools this session, modelled after the PM-SHRI and CM-SHRI schools, to provide modern educational infrastructure to students, said MCD education committee chairperson Yogesh Verma.

Verma said two schools in each zone, would serve as an example for other MCD schools to emulate. "We will launch more Nigam Shri Schools and both Hindi and English will be taught in these schools," Verma said.

The announcement came during a ceremony in which 500

## DELHI SET TO ROLL OUT E-DISTRICT 2.0 PORTAL WITH AI CHATBOT FOR HELP

**Saloni Bhatia**  
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**NEW DELHI:** The Delhi government is set to roll out E-District 2.0, an upgraded, AI-powered portal aimed at improving the efficiency of citizen services, officials said on Thursday.

A consultant has been appointed to submit a redevelopment roadmap within three months. The plan includes a bilingual AI chatbot to handle queries, streamline applications and improve accessibility.

Officials said the revamped platform will expand beyond the existing 453 services across 41 departments, which currently serve over 8.78 million users. The government is also explor-

{ DELHI GOVT IDENTIFICATION DRIVE }

## Over 20K SC/ST, OBC kids await fee payback

**Saloni Bhatia**  
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**NEW DELHI:** More than 20,000 students from SC/ST and OBC communities in Delhi have not received tuition fee reimbursements for years due to their bank accounts not being linked with Aadhaar, officials said, flagging a long-standing implementation gap in a key welfare scheme.

The pending payments date back to the 2016-17 academic session. A review of financial assistance programmes initiated after the current administration took office last year found that 52,291 eligible students had not received reimbursements for nearly a decade. Following verification of docu-

is the failure to meet the mandatory requirement of Aadhaar-linked bank accounts, without which direct benefit transfers cannot be processed.

The government has launched a drive to identify and reach the remaining beneficiaries. Efforts include contacting students via SMS and email, coordinating with schools, and organising outreach programmes to help complete Aadhaar seeding and verification.

Of those pending, 13,046 are OBC students owed over ₹55.97 crore, while 7,591 SC/ST students are due more than ₹18.64 crore. Under the scheme, students from these communities with annual family incomes of up to ₹3 lakh

## Delhiwale

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Mayank  
Austen Soofi



## Double milestones

On a city landmark and its architect

{ PUBLIC INTEREST }

The building changes over the course of the day. At first, the roof of the terrace expands. The edges loosen from the concrete and extend outward.

This, of course, is impossible. A building cannot shift its shape. And yet it appears to do just that. Thanks to the way it is designed, especially in relation to daylight and shadows.

This shifting terrace feels like a suitable reason to revisit the building today. As this day Delhi marks the intersection of two milestones: the 14th birth anniversary of architect Joseph Stein with the 75th year of Triveni Art Gallery, the first major Delhi building that Stein designed.

Triveni Kala Sangam must rank among Delhi's most wondrous works of architecture. It houses a much-loved cultural institution. Yet how many visitors notice its most extraordinary feature: architecture transformed into poetry?

Surely, every artistic Delhiite has been to Triveni – if not for exhibitions or classical music classes, then for the tasty carrot cake at the atmospheric Triveni Tea Terrace. Designed by the American architect Joseph Stein in the post-independent years, the complex embodies his signature basics. Like many of Stein's garden buildings, Triveni's

the floor and adjacent walls as enlarged patterns of these same openings. Consequently, light and shadow intertwine in shifting patterns, a characteristic echoed in Stein's other Delhi landmarks, such as the India International Centre and India Habitat Centre.

Only upon stepping onto the rarely visited first landing does one fully enter the understated surreality of Stein's vision. At first glance, the terrace appears simple: an open-air expanse with a roof supported by two slender pillars. Yet this roof, composed of narrow slabs, allows the daylight to enter through its wide gaps. As the sun moves, a jugalbandi of light and shadow unfolds, which expands, contracts over the course of the day.

The interplay recalls the architecture of Fatehpuri Mosque in Chandni Chowk, where light performs a similar, meditative drama. By late afternoon, the corridor's arches at Fatehpuri begin to reproduce themselves as soft, shifting silhouettes on the floor and walls. These shadows are more fluid than the structures that cast them.

Fatehpuri's brilliant architect remains unknown, but one senses that Stein might have found inspiration in a long, attentive afternoon spent there.

Whatever, standing beneath the aforementioned roof at Triveni, the spectator feels as though one is



READ: For more stories by Mayank



the track/chain technology to enhance data security. A meeting with departments is planned to gather feedback. The portal will have a user-friendly interface, faster processing and improved back-end integration.

Officials said the primary reason for the government disbursing over ₹90 crore to 31,954 students. However, 20,637 students are still awaiting payments amounting to more than ₹74.62 crore. Officials said the primary reason

for the delay in releasing the money is the need for verification of up to ₹48,000, covering tuition, laboratory and library fees. Officials said payments will be released once the required linkage and verification processes are completed.

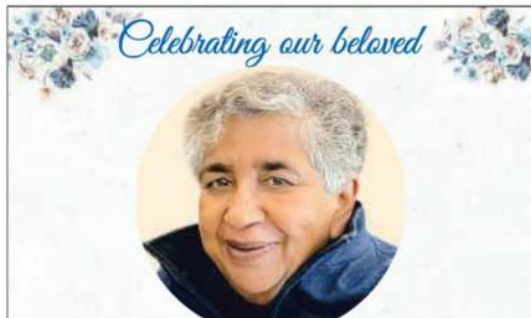
NEW SURVEYS WERE AWARDED scholarships of ₹1,000 each. Mayor Raja Iqbal Singh said, "The MCD has launched an app for 134 schools, enabling parents to track their children's progress at school."

CONCRETE STRUCTURES WITHIN NEIGHBOURHOODS WILL BE SURROUNDING trees and grass. Flowers and vines cling playfully to its walls. At times, the walls of the building corridors splinter into droplets of light, because of their jaali construction. The perforations in the jaali admit daylight, which falls onto

WASHINGHAR, AN ELEGANT PORCH, SURROUNDING NEIGHBOURHOODS WILL BE SURROUNDING trees and grass. Flowers and vines cling playfully to its walls. At times, the walls of the building corridors splinter into droplets of light, because of their jaali construction. The perforations in the jaali admit daylight, which falls onto

the 36.8°C mark as early as Sunday, the forecast stated. A similar rise is predicted in the minimum temperature as well, which is likely to reach 21°C to 23°C by April 15.

## HT Homage



April 6, 1951 – April 8, 2026

**Joe Sahgal**

(D/o Late Sh. A.P. Sahgal & Late Smt. Krishna Sahgal)  
with the blessing of her Gururji  
Left us on 8th April 2026

Join us as we honor the love and light that she brought into our lives.  
**Cremation at 5 PM on Friday the 10th of April Lodhi Crematorium**  
**Prayer meeting on 11th Saturday 4:30 – 5:30 PM at 130 Jor Bagh**  
Deeply loved & remembered by;

Late Shakti & Ravi Madan  
Bhupesh & Monica Madan  
Atul & Pooja Madan  
Kiran & Lucky Soni  
Rishabh & Nandita Soni  
Ridhi & Neeraj Khanna  
Rajesh & Deepshikha Sahgal  
Devesh Sahgal  
Gaurav & Bhargavi Sahgal  
Grandchildren: Himmat, Dhruva, Vyom, Omnyra, Yohaan, Vedaansh, Shivay & Sera  
Suman Sabharwal – Hitean, Smrita & Pratap  
Reena Khetarpal – Mansi & Kartik

## HT Unforgettable

**In Loving Memory Of**  
**ABHIJEET SRIVASTAVA**  
(03.03.1993 - 10.04.2018)

Forever Remembered Forever Missed. As we mark the 8th year of your Heavenly Abode, remembrance, our hearts overflow with cherished memories, and the profound absence of our Beloved Son. Your love & smile remain inseparable from us. Your wisdom, strength, & unwavering affection continue to inspire us every day, a testament to your pure & pious soul. Though unseen, we feel your presence in countless ways. We know you never truly left. You live in our hearts-invisible to the eye, yet forever felt in our souls. With love, reverence, & eternal remembrance, Anjali (Bhadravinda), Mumma - Papa, Akashina - Abhinav (Bhabhi - Bhai), Family, Friends & Relatives.

**18th Death Anniversary**  
**Of Our Beloved Lala Ji Malik**  
**Harbhagwan Das Batra**

who left us on this day 10th April, 2008. Years have passed that you are up with almighty leaving behind your sweet memories you are always in our thoughts & hearts. All family members of Late Ram Singh Batra, Meenu Batra. 981007740.

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## Rain break is over, mercury may touch 39°C by Apr 15: IMD

**Aaditya Khatwani**  
[aaditya.khatwani@hindustantimes.com](mailto:aaditya.khatwani@hindustantimes.com)

**NEW DELHI:** After two days of rain, the city's temperature is expected to hit 39°C by April 15, according to the India Meteorological Department (IMD)'s forecast on Thursday.

Weather experts said the lack of active western disturbances over the next seven days is likely to push up the mercury. However, winds from the western Himalayas may pick up pace, keeping temperatures from becoming stifling, they added.

Delhi recorded a maximum temperature of 30.8°C and a minimum of 16.3°C on Wednesday. According to IMD, clear skies will persist for the next seven days, with surface winds reaching 20-30km/hour during the day till Sunday. The maximum is likely to increase by 1°C to 2°C each day, and may cross the 36.8°C mark as early as Sunday, the forecast stated.

A similar rise is predicted in the minimum temperature as well, which is likely to reach 21°C to 23°C by April 15.

Mallesh Palawat, vice-president at SkyNet Weather, said, "The temperatures have been unusually low for April, thanks to widespread rains across the plains. We do not foresee any weather activities in the coming days, thus causing a gradual rise in temperature. Wind speed from the western Himalayas will increase, and so the temperature rise will not be steep."

Delhi's air quality index (AQI) worsened marginally on Thursday. While Wednesday's 24-hour average at 4pm was recorded at 101, it climbed to 103 on Thursday, to the "moderate" category. Wednesday was the first time in 19 days that the AQI average had remained "satisfactory".

## MCD plans 300-TPD biogas plant at dairy colony in Ghazipur

**HT Correspondent**  
[htreporters@hindustantimes.com](mailto:htreporters@hindustantimes.com)

**NEW DELHI:** The Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD) is planning to set up a 300-tonne-per-day (TPD) capacity biogas plant at the Ghazipur dairy farm, officials said, adding that the proposal will be placed before the House later this month.

According to officials, the plant will come up on five acres of land. "The tender will be issued in the next few days," an official said.

MCD oversees the 11 authorised dairy colonies in Delhi. The biogas plant will be set up as part of the MCD's action plan to stop dairy waste from reaching the Yamuna through the city's drains. Work on ten biogas plants, nine waste water treatment facilities, overhaul of sewer system in dairy colonies along with development of sedimentation chambers will be carried out, senior civic officials said.

GCD opened its first biogas plant in the next few days, an official said.

MCD oversees the 11 authorised dairy colonies in Delhi. The biogas plant will be set up as part of the MCD's action plan to stop dairy waste from reaching the Yamuna through the city's drains. Work on ten biogas plants, nine waste water treatment facilities, overhaul of sewer system in dairy colonies along with development of sedimentation chambers will be carried out, senior civic officials said.

Ten more biogas plants have been proposed in Ghazipur and Bhalawa dairy, MCD dairy and Madanpur Khadar, Sarita Vihar, Mangolpuri near Outer Ring Road, Pitampura, Sector 3 Rohini, Sagarpur and Sri Ram Colony near Khajuri Nisarga, with a cumulative capacity to process 1400TPD waste, officials added.

NEW DELHI  
FRIDAY  
APRIL 10, 2026

## Hindustan Times NEWS

07

**IT-COMMUNITY NOTES**

malise the ministry's remit over a category of content it does not currently regulate.

Earlier this year, several posts by BJP leaders and ministers on X drew community notes that the government flagged to the platform, according to people aware of the matter at the company.

These included posts by Prime Minister Narendra Modi, Union education minister Dharmendra Pradhan, and Union minister Ashwini Vaishnaw. Community notes under some of the specific posts have since been removed from the platform.

A community note beneath a February 14 video of Modi speaking at a business summit — which alleged that government policies on social justice for scheduled castes, tribes, and other backward classes violated Articles 14 and 15 of the Constitution — was removed from the platform. A note beneath a BJP national account post quoting home minister Amit Shah on deportation of infiltrators, which cited the government's own record on the issue in Assam, has intermittently appeared and disappeared.

Not all notes on official posts have been taken down. A community note beneath a January 28 post by President Droupadi Murmu — clarifying that as head of state she is constitutionally obligated to serve all citizens, not

are entirely user-generated and hosted on social media intermediaries. Industry and civil society groups who attended consultations over the proposed changes this week pushed back, with intermediaries questioning their inclusion under provisions that are subject to MIB directions.

The government told stakeholders that intermediaries' inclusion is to ensure they act as the access point to such content and can help identify users.

Policy experts warn the expansion is poorly scoped. The proposed expansion of applicability of Part III of IT rules appears wide enough to sweep in even intermediary-hosted, community-driven formats of content resembling current affairs and news," said Dhruv Gang, partner at Indian Governance & Policy Project (IGPP). "That could raise questions for spaces such as Wikipedia entries or X's Community Notes, where content is collectively generated and iteratively shaped rather than controlled by any one user or by the platform itself."

That reading directly contradicts the government's own characterisation.

IT secretary S Krishnan, speaking to the press on Tuesday after stakeholder consultations at the ministry, described the proposed changes as largely procedural. "These amendments do not in any way give us wider powers... they are only clarificatory and incidental in nature," he

Apart from X, Meta has said it plans to roll out community notes for its platforms — Facebook, Instagram, and Threads — though the feature is currently live only in the United States, with no confirmed timeline for India.

**VOTING TURNOUT**

A significant factor in the elevated percentages was the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls in Kerala and Puducherry, and the Special Revision (SR) in Assam. The total number of electors in Kerala fell 8.42% from 27.9 million, in Puducherry 11.67% from 1.2 million, and in Assam 0.97% from 25.2 million — the last also reflecting delimitation of assembly and parliamentary seats in 2023. A smaller denominator inflates the turnout percentage even when absolute voter numbers remain comparable.

Votes will be counted on May 4, along with Tamil Nadu and West Bengal.

The Election Commission said polling in the three states and the Union territory was peaceful, with sporadic incidents of violence at a few places.

**Kerala**

The high-stakes contest in Kerala is three-way: the incumbent CPDM-led Left Democratic Front, seeking a record third consecutive term, faces the Congress-led United Democratic Front, which hopes to ride anti-incumbency

have travelled the length and breadth of the state four times. I have a clear understanding of the public mood," he said.

Chandrasekhar urged voters to turn out in large numbers and vote for change. "The NDA's strong show in this election will change the political narratives in Kerala," he said.

Two people died after collapsing at polling booths in Thrissur and Kollam districts — one a voter, one a poll official — both due to natural causes. Clashes between party workers were reported at a few places.

In an election in which eight film personalities are among the candidates, several Malayalam stars turned out to vote. Mohanlal, after casting his vote in the state capital, wrote on social media: "Done my part. Your turn, Kerala go vote." Mammootty, who cast his vote with family members in Kochi, said: "Once-in-five-year opportunity, and people should come forward to cast their votes." Pritiviraj Sukumaran also voted.

**Assam**

Turnout crossed 90% in several districts including South Salmara Mankachar, Barpeta, Bongaigaon, Darrang, Dhubri and Goalpara. EC officials attributed the high participation to a campaign to reach voters through booth-level officials.

Around 30 people were injured and seven arrested in poll-related violence across the state, PTI

ately and tried to control the crowd. When they did not listen, a few rounds were fired in the air to disperse the mob," he said. Four people were arrested.

The BJP, in power since 2016 and seeking a third consecutive term, is contesting 90 seats, with allies Asom Gana Parishad (26 seats) and Bodoland People's Party (11 seats). The Congress, attempting a comeback through a six-party alliance, is contesting 99 seats: its partners are Rajnarayan Dal (13), Assam Jatiya Parishad (10), CPI(M) (3) and All Party Hill Leaders Conference (2).

"What we set out to do was not merely fight an election, but to turn it into a movement — a movement to protect our civilisation, our values, our culture, and our land," said chief minister Himanta Biswa Sarma.

State Congress president Gaurav Gogoi, speaking ahead of casting his ballot in Jorhat, said: "We are very confident that people of Assam will vote to change the atmosphere of fear and large-scale corruption and exercise their right for a state which is peaceful and developed — 'Bor Asom' (Greater Assam)."

**Puducherry**

The contesting the 30-seat assembly is between the ruling NR Congress-led NDA alliance and the Congress-led Progress Alliance. The NDA comprises NR Congress (16 seats), BJP (11), AIADMK (2) and one seat for the newly formed Latchiya Jananay-

anon as soon as possible," he said. "The negotiations will focus on disarming Hezbollah and establishing peaceful relations between Israel and Lebanon." An hour before Netanyahu's statement, Lebanese President Joseph Aoun said he was working on a diplomatic track on this matter that was starting to be seen "positively" by international actors.

A senior Lebanese official told Reuters that Lebanon had spent the last day pushing for a temporary ceasefire to allow for broader talks with Israel, describing the effort as a "separate track but the same model" as the U.S.-Iran truce. Israel was preparing to scale down its attacks in Lebanon, a senior Israeli official said on Thursday. Netanyahu's official said talks with Lebanon were expected to begin in Washington next week.

Under a November 2024 U.S.-brokered ceasefire accord that halted more than a year of fighting between Israel and Hezbollah, Lebanon agreed that only state security forces should bear arms, which means Hezbollah must be fully disarmed. But a bid the following year by the Lebanese army to disarm the group fell short, Israeli said.

U.S. Brent crude futures fell sharply after the ceasefire announcement, and dropped a further \$4 after Israel announced direct Lebanon talks.

**Israel says ceasefire does not cover Lebanon**

Washington and Israel, which

orders for areas on Beirut's outskirts to areas near Beirut airport and several displacement shelters.

Hezbollah announced at least 20 military operations on Thursday, saying it has targeted Israeli vehicles on Lebanese territory as well as firing into northern Israel.

Lebanese officials declared a day of mourning after Wednesday's attacks on heavily populated areas, which they described as a "massacre." Outside Beirut's Rafik Hariri University Hospital, a steady stream of ambulances arrived throughout Thursday afternoon full of mangled bodies recovered from the sites of Israeli strikes the previous day.

"We're picking up body parts for the most part. It's very rare that we find entire bodies intact," said a rescue worker.

**Iran and US both declare victory**

Inside Iran, where the halt to six weeks of U.S. and Iranian airstrikes has been portrayed as total victory for the clerical rulers, huge crowds turned out to commemorate 40 days of mourning for Supreme Leader Ayatollah Ali Khamenei, killed on the war's first day. Though Trump has also declared victory, Washington has not achieved the aims he announced at the war's outset: to eliminate Iran's ability to attack its neighbours, destroy its nuclear programme and make it easier for Iranians to topple their government. Iran still possesses missiles and drones that can hit its neigh-

**13-YEAR-OLD GIRL HELD CAPTIVE, GANG-RAPED BY 10 IN UP; 6 HELD**

**HT Correspondent**  
[htreporters@hindustantimes.com](mailto:htreporters@hindustantimes.com)

**GORAKHPUR:** A 13-year-old girl was allegedly held captive and gang-raped by 10 men over four months in Uttar Pradesh's Gorakhpur, police said on Thursday, adding that six of the accused have been arrested.

According to police, the victim, a Class 9 student, left home for her school in Chauri Chaura on November 5, 2025, but did not return, prompting her family to lodge a missing persons complaint on November 7.

She was eventually rescued on March 23 from a locality under Gulbargiya police station limits in Gorakhpur.

In her statement before a magistrate on April 9, the victim revealed that she left with her friend to escape studies and stayed at his relative's residence for a week.

They later moved to a hotel in Chauri Chaura where the man, along with seven others, gang-raped her over a period of 37 days. Police officials confirmed that in medical examinations, rape was confirmed. During her captivity, the victim contacted an acquaintance who also raped her and later abandoned her near Ramgarh Lake.

Later, an auto-rickshaw



a particular constituency — remains visible on the platform. In her original post, the President had stated that the government works for marginalised and vulnerable communities.

If the government decides a note is unlawful under the expanded framework, the process would follow the standard route: a takedown or blocking direction sent to the platform, requiring removal or disabling of access within a set time.

The issue involves several questions: One is of accountability, since a community note is shaped collectively by multiple contributors rather than a single author. The Meity official said: "That would have to be determined in a court based on who all have contributed. And if X has a role in curation — they also have a liability." Both users who contributed to a note and the platform could face scrutiny, depending on the case.

The other is whether MIB can regulate it. Community Notes

said.

Garg said the ministry needed to clarify its intent. "It would be important for the ministry to clarify the intended scope in the final rules, so that genuinely collaborative and community-moderated information ecosystems are not inadvertently brought within a framework meant for publishers."

X expanded Community Notes to India in April 2024, allowing users from India to join as contributors. Only notes rated helpful by people from diverse perspectives appear under posts. X says it does not moderate notes unless they break the platform's rules. That position could be tested under the proposed framework.

The last date for public and stakeholder comments on the proposed changes was April 14; this deadline is expected to be extended by two weeks following pressure from industry and other stakeholders, HT has learnt.

back to power after a decade, and the BJP-led NDA, which holds no seats in the outgoing assembly and is seeking to break the state's established political duopoly.

Chief minister Pinarayi Vijayan, contesting his third consecutive election from the party stronghold of Dharmadam, cast his vote at a polling booth at an Upper Primary school in Pinarayi village. Leader of opposition VD Satheesan voted with family members at a booth at Kesari Arts and Science College in Paravur, a constituency he has represented continuously since 2008. BJP state president Rajeev Chandrasekhar also voted in the early hours.

"Kerala is on a path to become a developed state with achievements across sectors that must continue uninterrupted. People realise that only the LDF can take the state forward," said Vijayan after voting.

Satheesan predicted a UDF sweep, claiming the alliance would win over 100 of the 140 seats. "In the last three months, I

reported.

The most serious incident was in Patharkandi constituency in Sribhumi district, where Congress candidate Kartik Sena Sinha allegedly entered the Ranganathi polling booth and broke the EVM, triggering a clash between Congress and BJP workers. Sinha is contesting directly against Assam minister Krishnendu Paul. "Around 25 people were injured, of whom two are serious. They have been sent to Karmiganj Civil Hospital for treatment," a senior police officer said. Voting was suspended for three hours before resuming after the EVM was replaced.

Other clashes between party workers were reported in Dibrugarh, Khowang and Naduar. Inspector General of Police (Law and Order) Akhilesh Kumar Singh told PTI that violence had broken out in Tamulpur and Sivassagar on Wednesday night, hours before polling opened. "Police reached the spot immedi-

aga Katchi, floated by Jose Charles Martin, son of 'Lottery King' Santiago Martin. On the opposition side, the Congress is contesting 16 seats and its ally DMK 14. Tamilaga Vettri Kizhagam is contesting all 30 seats.

(With inputs from Vijay Karthik in Chennai)

**IRAN WAR**

riens sailed through a strait that typically accommodated 140 ships a day before the war, accounting for around a fifth of the world's oil and liquefied natural gas flows.

Natanyahu, whose government rebuffed a historic offer for direct talks with Lebanon last month, said in a statement that he had given instructions to start peace talks as soon as possible, which would also include disarming Iran-aligned militant group Hezbollah. "In light of Lebanon's repeated requests to open direct negotiations with Israel, I instructed the cabinet yesterday to start direct negotiations with Leb-

invaded Lebanon last month in parallel with the war on Iran to root out Hezbollah, say Lebanon is not covered by Trump's ceasefire.

But Iran and Pakistan, which acted as mediator, say it was explicitly part of the deal. A host of countries, including Britain and France, said the truce should extend to Lebanon.

Iran's Parliament Speaker Mohammad Baqer Qalibaf, expected to head the Iranian delegation opposite US Vice President JD Vance, tweeted that Lebanon and the rest of Iran's "axis" of regional allies were inseparable parts of any ceasefire. A Pakistani source said Pakistan was working on ceasefires for Lebanon as well as Yemen, where Israel has also hit Iran-aligned forces.

**Israel says it kills Hezbollah chief's nephew**

Earlier on Thursday, Israel kept up its bombing of Beirut's southern suburbs and other parts of the country. Lebanese state media said it also expanded evacuation

bours and a stockpile of more than 400kg of uranium enriched to near weapons grade. Its rulers survived the superpower onslaught with no sign of organised opposition and demonstrated their ability to exert control of the strait.

In a meeting with NATO Secretary General Mark Rutte, Trump expressed frustration with allies for their lack of support in the war and made clear he wanted concrete commitments within the next few days for help to secure the waterway, according to two European diplomats.

Iran is pressing for even more U.S. concessions in a final deal, including the total lifting of sanctions that have crippled its economy and acknowledgment of its control over the strait, previously freely open to trade. Washington wants Iran to yield up the enriched uranium, forego further enrichment, give up its missiles and stop backing regional allies, all demands it had already made in talks it abandoned two days before the war.

driver kept her in Gorakhpur and raped her for over a month in an under-construction flat. She has accused 10 people of rape in her statement.

Chauri Chaura circle officer Ratnesh Kumar Singh said that based on the victim's statement to the magistrate and the CCTV footage retrieved from hotel in Chauri Chaura, police registered a case under relevant sections of the BNS and the PoCSO Act.

**Woman's body found with hands tied in Kakori**

The body of an unidentified woman with hands tied and multiple injury marks was recovered from an open field along the Madapur-Purana road in Lucknow on Thursday, police said.

Passersby spotted the body around 8 am near Madapur village along the Kakori police station limits and alerted police.

"The body has been sent for post-mortem examination," said DCP (West) Kamlesh Dixit.

**भारतीय विज्ञान शिक्षा एवं अनुसंधान संस्थान भोपाल**  
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**Hindustan Times**

**Hot City**

**DHURANDHAR 2 IN LEGAL TROUBLE: TRIMURTI FILMS SUES OVER USE OF 'OYE SONG'**

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  - 2.1. अल्प सेवा कमीशन (आरवीसी) कोर्स (महिला) - 15 अप्रैल 2026 से 15 मई 2026
  - 2.2. अल्प सेवा कमीशन (आरवीसी) कोर्स (पुरुष) - 17 अप्रैल 2026 से 18 मई 2026

यदि कोई पूछताछ करनी हो तो, महानिदेशालय पशुचिकित्सा सेवाएं, क्वार्टरमास्टर जनरल शाखा, एकीकृत मुख्यालय रक्षा मंत्रालय (थल सेना), पश्चिमी खण्ड-3, आर के पुरम, नई दिल्ली-110066 से लिखित अथवा ई मेल आई डी: [persvet-1779@nic.in](mailto:persvet-1779@nic.in) में संपर्क किया जा सकता है।

1. Applications are invited from male and female veterinary graduates for 95th Short Service Commission Course in Remount & Veterinary Corps of the INDIAN ARMY.
2. For Detailed notification please visit [www.joinindianarmy.nic.in](http://www.joinindianarmy.nic.in). Applications will only be accepted via online mode and will remain open as under:
  - 2.1. SSC (RVC) Course (Women) - 15 Apr 2026 to 15 May 2026
  - 2.2. SSC (RVC) Course (Men) - 17 Apr 2026 to 18 May 2026

Queries if any be sought from Dte Gen RVS, QMG Branch, IHQ of MoD (Army), West Block-3, RK Puram, New Delhi-110 066 in writing OR through E-mail ID: [persvet-1779@nic.in](mailto:persvet-1779@nic.in)

**नोट:-**

1. सेना में भर्ती पूर्णतया पारदर्शी और मुफ्त है। दलालों से सावधान रहें।
2. विस्तृत नोटिफिकेशन और जानकारी के लिए, कृपया [www.joinindianarmy.nic.in](http://www.joinindianarmy.nic.in) पर जाएं।

**Notes:-**

1. Recruitment in the Army is totally transparent and free. Beware of touts.
2. For detailed Notification, please visit [www.joinindianarmy.nic.in](http://www.joinindianarmy.nic.in).

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**Extract of the audited consolidated financial results for the year ended March 31, 2026** (₹ crore)

|                                                         | Three months ended March 31, 2026 | Year ended March 31, 2026 | Three months ended March 31, 2025 |
|---------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------|---------------------------|-----------------------------------|
| Revenue from operations                                 | 70,698                            | 2,67,021                  | 64,479                            |
| Profit before exceptional items and tax                 | 18,362                            | 70,013                    | 16,402                            |
| Profit before tax                                       | 18,362                            | 65,487                    | 16,402                            |
| Profit after tax                                        | 13,784                            | 49,454                    | 12,293                            |
| Total comprehensive income for the period               | 14,445                            | 52,204                    | 12,855                            |
| Paid up equity share capital (Face value: ₹1 per share) | 362                               | 362                       | 362                               |
| Total reserves (including non-controlling interests)*   | 1,08,116                          | 1,08,116                  | 95,409                            |
| Earnings per equity share - Basic and diluted (₹)       | 37.92                             | 136.01                    | 33.79                             |

\*Balance for three months and year ended March 31, 2026 represent balance as per the audited consolidated balance sheet for the year ended March 31, 2026 and balance for three months ended March 31, 2025, represent balance as per the audited consolidated balance sheet for the year ended March 31, 2025 as required by Securities and Exchange Board of India (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015.

**Extract of the audited standalone financial results for the year ended March 31, 2026** (₹ crore)

|                                           | Three months ended March 31, 2026 | Year ended March 31, 2026 | Three months ended March 31, 2025 |
|-------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------|---------------------------|-----------------------------------|
| Revenue from operations                   | 58,052                            | 2,20,938                  | 54,136                            |
| Profit before exceptional items and tax   | 18,464                            | 66,873                    | 14,672                            |
| Profit before tax                         | 18,464                            | 62,806                    | 14,672                            |
| Profit after tax                          | 14,526                            | 49,096                    | 11,116                            |
| Total comprehensive income for the period | 14,100                            | 48,496                    | 11,194                            |

**Notes:**

1. The audited consolidated financial results and audited standalone financial results have been reviewed by the Audit Committee and approved by the Board of Directors at its meeting held on April 9, 2026. The statutory auditors have expressed an unmodified audit opinion on these results.
2. The Board of Directors at its meeting held on April 9, 2026, has proposed a final dividend of ₹31.00 per equity share.
3. On January 14, 2026, ListEngage Midco, LLC, a wholly owned subsidiary of the Company, acquired 100% of the ownership interest of Coastal Cloud Holdings, LLC along with its subsidiaries ("Coastal Cloud") for a consideration of \$707 million (₹6,386 crore).
4. The above is an extract of the detailed format of financial results filed with the Stock Exchanges under Regulation 33 of the Securities and Exchange Board of India (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015. The full format for three months ended and year ended March 31, 2026, are available on the BSE Limited website (URL: [www.bseindia.com](http://www.bseindia.com)), the National Stock Exchange of India Limited website (URL: [www.nseindia.com](http://www.nseindia.com)) and on the Company's website (URL: [www.tcs.com/investors](http://www.tcs.com/investors)). The same can be accessed by scanning the QR code provided below.

Mumbai April 9, 2026

For and on behalf of the Board of Directors

K Krishnasen  
CEO and Managing Director  
DIN: 10106739

**08** **Hindustan Times** **MY INDIA** **NEW DELHI FRIDAY APRIL 10, 2026**

**Indian panel may visit US in May for trade deal talks**

**India steps up energy outreach amid truce**

**Rajeev Jayaswal and Rezauil H Laskar**  
letters@hindustantimes.com

**NEW DELHI:** The two-week ceasefire in West Asia has allowed New Delhi to step up its energy security outreach in the Gulf, with petroleum minister Dattatraya Hosabale

**RSS GEN SECY TO MEET STUDENTS, NIASORA IN IIC**

**FM to skip US visit to attend Parl session on women's Bill**

**Rajeev Jayaswal**  
letters@hindustantimes.com

**NEW DELHI:** An Indian delegation is expected to visit Washington



later this month to advance talks on an interim bilateral trade agreement, with New Delhi seeking preferential market access for Indian merchandise over competing countries under the new US tariff architecture, people familiar with the matter said.

The original framework, jointly announced on February 7, was thrown into uncertainty when the US Supreme Court on February 20 struck down President Donald Trump's sweeping global tariffs as exceeding his statutory authority. With the legal basis for the proposed 18% tariff on Indian goods invalidated, both sides have been working to rebuild the agreement on firmer legal ground—even as Washington launched fresh Section 301 investigations against 16 countries, including India, as part of its effort to reconstruct tariff pressure through alternative legal mechanisms.

US ambassador to India and special envoy to south and central Asia Sergio Gorr on Thursday alluded to the forthcoming visit after a meeting with US Trade Representative James Greer in Washington. "Highly productive meeting with @USTradeRep Ambassador Greer to discuss advancing @POTUS trade priorities in South and Central Asia. The United States and India have previously agreed to a trade deal, and we look forward to welcoming an Indian delegation to Washington later this month," Gorr said in a post on X.

The visit is expected to give renewed momentum to trade talks and help resolve issues including the Section 301 investigations launched by the USTR on March 11, the people said, requesting anonymity. India's foreign secretary Vikram Misri is already on a three-day visit to Washington from April 8, adding senior diplomatic heft to the engagement.



**US ambassador to India Sergio Gorr alluded to the forthcoming visit on Thursday.**

The finalisation of an interim bilateral trade agreement would, one of the people cited above said, automatically resolve several trade disputes between the two countries. India will, however, file a formal response to the USTR's Section 301 investigation—the deadline for which is April 15. A public hearing on the matter is scheduled for early May.

India is currently facing two probes under Section 301: one relating to alleged excess industrial capacity in sectors such as solar modules, and another concerning the use of forced labour. A total of 16 economies and blocs are under USTR scrutiny—China, the European Union, Singapore, Switzerland, Norway, Indonesia, Malaysia, Cambodia, Thailand, South Korea, Vietnam, Taiwan, Bangladesh, Mexico, Japan and India. According to the people cited above, the US could use Section 301 as a bargaining tool against some of these countries after the Supreme Court outlawed its reciprocal tariffs.

India is, however, better placed than most given that New Delhi and Washington had already established a framework for an interim bilateral trade agreement. The two sides had been on course to sign a "mutually beneficial" interim trade agreement in March. But before the deal—which proposed an 18% tariff on most Indian goods—could be finalised, the US Supreme Court struck down Trump's use of emergency powers to impose tariffs of his choosing. The finalisation of any deal now awaits a legally tenable tariff architecture, the people said.

**Shashank Mattoo**  
letters@hindustantimes.com

**WASHINGTON:** Union finance minister Nirmala Sitharaman will skip a planned visit to the US ahead of efforts in parliament to amend the 2023 Women's Reservation Act. HT has learnt. Sitharaman, who was expected to meet with key CEOs in New York City, will also skip the Spring meetings of the World Bank and the International Monetary Fund in Washington DC.

Sitharaman had earlier skipped the annual meetings of the World Bank and IMF in October last year amid tensions between New Delhi and Washington over trade, including the 50% tariff placed on Indian exports to the United States. On Wednesday, the Union Cabinet cleared a draft amendment bill that is expected to operationalise 33% reservation for women in Parliament and state assemblies. PM Modi called on representatives from across political parties to support the amendment in an op-ed on Thursday. The amendment bill will be discussed in Parliament on April 16. While Sitharaman was initially expected to travel to the US—where she was also slated to speak with US media outlet Newsweek—the focus on the amendment bill in Parliament led to a change in plans.

The Spring meetings of the World Bank and IMF will kick off in Washington DC on April 13, against the backdrop of rising energy prices and economic insecurity across the world due to the US-Iran conflict. Disruptions to the supply of oil, gas, fertiliser as well as crucial inputs like aluminium, methanol, sulphur and helium due to the conflict and the closure of the Strait of Hormuz has worsened the global economic outlook for 2026. The meetings this year will be focused on a new jobs agenda as the agencies focus on driving private sector-led growth, an official told HT.



**Nirmala Sitharaman**

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advantage over competing countries such as China. The Supreme Court's February 20 ruling invalidated those reciprocal tariffs. With that framework dismantled, the Trump administration invoked Section 122 of the Trade Act of 1974 to impose a fresh uniform tariff—raised to its statutory ceiling of 15% within days—on imports from all countries. That levy is valid for 150 days and is set to expire in July, creating a hard deadline that the ongoing Section 301 investigations are expected to help bridge.

**Shashank Mattoo and Smriti Kak Ramchandran**  
letters@hindustantimes.com

**WASHINGTON/NEW DELHI:** Rashtriya Swayamsevak Sangh (RSS) Sarkaryavah (general secretary) Dattatreya Hosabale is scheduled to travel to the US to interact with students and members of the Indian diaspora, people aware of the details said on Wednesday.

According to one functionary of the Sangh, the ideological fount of the ruling Bharatiya Janata Party, it is after a long time that a Sarkaryavah is travelling abroad for an outreach programme.

"There is an event planned at Boston University, where he has been invited to address students. Similar interactions are also planned with a select group of people and possibly the media as well during the stay," the functionary, speaking on condition of anonymity, said. The Sangh also distanced Hosabale's visit from any political outreach and said the report's recommendations were baseless.

The functionary quoted above said there was no "specific agenda" for the visit.

"In the past when Hosabale was the palak adhikari (caretaker) of the Sangh's vishwa vibhag, he travelled abroad on several occasions. Since assuming charge (of general secretary) he has not travelled abroad. In fact, it is after a long time that any Sarkaryavah is visiting another country," the functionary said. Hosabale travelled to the United States and the Caribbean in 2011.

Hosabale's predecessor, Suresh Bhaiyaji Joshi, did not travel abroad during his stint.

ter Hardeep Singh Puri visiting Qatar from Thursday and external affairs minister S Jaishankar heading to the United Arab Emirates on Saturday.

Beyond securing supplies of crude oil, liquefied natural gas (LNG) and liquefied petroleum gas (LPG), the high-level engagements with Gulf Cooperation Council (GCC) nations assume significance as India and the bloc negotiate a free trade agreement (FTA). Several GCC countries—the UAE, Oman, Bahrain, Kuwait, Qatar and Saudi Arabia—have also invested in India's 5.33 million tonne strategic petroleum reserves.

External affairs ministry spokesperson Randhir Jaiswal confirmed the visits at a briefing on Thursday. "We are closely following developments in West Asia and continue to engage with countries in the region," he said, adding that Jaishankar will visit the UAE on April 11-12 to review cooperation and deepen the strategic partnership.

Referring to Puri's April 9-10 visit to Qatar, Jaiswal said India is also reaching out to other GCC countries. The petroleum ministry said details of the visit would be shared after his return.

The visits come amid global energy volatility triggered by the Iran conflict since February 28. While India has maintained uninterrupted supplies through diversified sourcing from 41 countries, import costs have surged. Brent crude, at \$72.87 a barrel before the conflict, rose to \$119.5 by March

by March



**India-flagged vessel Green Asha arrived at the Jawaharlal Nehru Port Authority in Maharashtra on Thursday, carrying 15,400 tonnes of LPG after crossing the Strait of Hormuz.**

9, later easing but remaining elevated amid uncertainty around the ceasefire.

Qatar and the UAE are key energy partners for India, and the visits are expected to help secure supplies and assess the impact of the conflict on energy infrastructure, officials said. India's hydrocarbon imports from the UAE were worth \$24.74 billion in FY25, while Qatar remains the largest supplier of LNG and LPG.

Puri's visit is particularly significant as India imports around 60% of its LPG needs, with about 90% routed through the Strait of Hormuz, which has been affected by the conflict. Iran's strike on Qatar's Ras Laffan gas facilities in mid-March worsened concerns. Officials said New Delhi is working to ensure that any force majeure declarations by suppliers such as Qatar Energy do not disrupt supplies.

Indian firms including Petronet LNG, GAIL and GSPC have long-term gas supply contracts with Qatar, importing substantial volumes annually. The UAE, meanwhile, is India's second-largest gas supplier and a major crude source, and its ADNOC is the first foreign entity to invest in India's strategic reserves.

In January, Hindustan Petroleum Corporation Ltd (HPCL) and ADNOC Gas signed a 10-year LNG supply deal, while GAIL India and QatarEnergy agreed in December 2024 on LNG cargo supplies over five years.

The visits will also provide an opportunity for India to assess the broader security situation and raise issues related to the Indian diaspora—around four million in the UAE and over \$30,000 in Qatar. The GCC remains central to India's energy and trade matrix, accounting for about 35% of oil imports and 70% of gas imports, and \$178.56 billion in trade in FY25. Benchmark Brent crude price, that was at \$72.87 a barrel before the war, soared to \$119.5 by March 9, about 64% jump. Thereafter, it hovered between \$100 and \$110 a barrel to close at \$109.27 on Tuesday. While the news of truce on Wednesday saw the price dipping sharply to \$94.75, it bounced back to near \$100 again on Thursday as the fragility of the truce became apparent.

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# Rafale order plan: Govt to ensure jets can carry indigenous missiles

Shishir Gupta

letters@hindustantimes.com

**NEW DELHI:** India will ensure that indigenously developed missiles and weapons systems can be integrated into the I14 Rafale fighters it plans to buy, people familiar with the matter said.

It will do so by insisting on a so-called interface control document (ICD) in the government to government contract on the "buy and make" deal, they added, asking not to be named.

The defence ministry is expected to issue the Request For Proposal (RFP) to French jet maker Dassault next month, and contract negotiations will begin after that. The Defence

Acquisition Council (DAC) cleared the deal on February 12.

The people cited above said the plan is to "hardwire" ICD into the final contract for the Rs 3.25 lakh crore mega deal. ICD is a critical system engineering document that controls and defines all the vital protocols between a system and sub-systems. According to the proposal cleared by DAC, 18 fighters will be delivered in fly away condition from France while remaining 96 will be manufactured in India with indigenous content of over 25%.

Amidst reports that the mega deal has hit a hurdle with French Rafale manufacturer Dassault refusing to hand over "source code" of the fighter to



India plans to buy I14 Rafale jets under government to government contract.

India, top defence ministry officials confirmed to Hindustan Times that no country offers up

these proprietary software codes (which control the radar, electronic warfare suite and weapon integration) to any third country and the deal remains well on track. The "source codes" virtually control the entire fighter including avionics, target tracking, flight control, weapon launch and weapons release algorithms. The code is the intellectual property of the original equipment manufacturer, which is not shared even with the closest of allies, the officials added.

While India's long term strategic ally Russia has offered two squadrons of fifth generation Su-57 to Indian Air Forces and is involved in upgrading the existing Su-30 MKI fighter fleet

with state-owned HAL, it has never shared or offered to share source codes of either of these fighters, HT learns. The same holds true for American aircraft manufacturers with Indian transport fleet and attack helicopter fleet made up of US aerial platforms.

Even though India has not taken any decision on acquisition of fifth generation aircraft either from US or from Russia, it is focused on indigenous development of Tejas Mark 1A along with long range missiles and twin engine AMCA for the future in order to reduce dependence on foreign aerial platforms, beyond visual range air to air, and air to surface missiles.

# CB takes over investigation into ₹550cr Hry funds fraud

Hindender Rao

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**CHANDIGARH:** The Central Bureau of Investigation (CBI) has taken over the probe into the alleged misappropriation of more than ₹550 crore of Haryana government funds from IDFC First Bank and AU Small Finance Bank.

The federal agency registered a regular case (RC), equivalent to an FIR, replicating the first information report lodged by the Haryana Anti Corruption Bureau (ACB) on February 23.

"A team of CBI officers met the ACB officials on Thursday to get acquainted with the aspects of the banking scam and pick up documents of evidentiary value," a senior Haryana government official aware to the development said on condition of anonymity.

The CBI RC, which has been seen by HT, states: "The case involved serious allegations of misappropriation of government funds and a large-scale, organised, and multi-layered fraud pertaining to fraudulent banking operations and fictitious transactions allegedly undertaken in a systematic manner to siphon off government funds into the accounts of

THE AGENCY REGISTERED A REGULAR CASE, REPLICATING THE FIR LODGED BY HARYANA'S ACB

shell entities, including Swastik Desh Project, SBR Planning Gurus Pvt. Ltd., Cap Co Fintech Services, RS. Traders and other associated firms/individuals, resulting in a substantial loss to the public exchequer, estimated to exceed ₹550 crore."

Haryana officials added that a second case registered by ACB in connection with the Panchkula Municipal Corporation banking fraud may also be handed over to CBI. The ₹150-160 crore fraud involves the liquidation of the corporation's fixed deposits in Kotak Mahindra Bank using forged documents and fictitious accounts.

Kotak Mahindra Bank on March 25 said it has begun reconciling the municipal corporation's fixed deposits and linked accounts, maintaining that all processes and transactions adhered to due norms. It added

that a significant portion has already been reconciled, with the remaining process underway. In the first case, IDFC First Bank said in a February 24 statement that it has paid 100% of the principal and interest — amounting to ₹583 crore — to the relevant Haryana government departments.

All Small Finance Bank said on February 22 that there was no indication of any financial impact or fraudulent activity affecting the bank, adding that certain employees had been placed off duty to ensure a fair and transparent review.

CBI's RC comes amidst an administrative churn in the state, with the government transferring four IAS officers on Wednesday night. The officers, who had been given key postings on March 9, were moved to less significant roles within three weeks as part of a broader reshuffle involving 15 IAS officers. In a related move, two IAS officers promoted from the state civil services were placed under suspension. It wasn't immediately clear whether any of the transfers and suspensions had anything to do with the cases detailed above.

## NIA PROBES DEATH OF MANIPUR KIDS, STIR CONTINUES

Thomas Ngangom

letters@hindustantimes.com

**IMPHAL:** The Manipur government on Thursday handed over to the National Investigation Agency (NIA) the probe into the deaths of two kids in a bomb attack in the Bishnupur district on Tuesday even as Imphal and surrounding areas remained tense with protests erupting against the deaths.

Tension escalated in the Imphal Valley area with hundreds of protesters taking to the streets defying curfew restrictions demanding justice in the incident, which claimed the lives of a five-year-old boy, his six-month-old sister and injured their mother.

NIA team visited the spot for investigation on Thursday.

Three people had died in firing by security personnel on Tuesday when a large group of protesters had tried to storm a CRPF camp in Bishnupur following the bomb attack. Over two dozen others had sustained injuries.

On Thursday, protesters blocked several streets, burnt tyres, and disrupted vehicular movement at various locations in Bishnupur Imphal East, Thoubal and Kakching districts.

## FIR claims thallium poisoning in plot to murder UP businessman

Rohit Kumar Singh

letters@hindustantimes.com

**LUCKNOW:** A Varanasi-based businessman was allegedly poisoned with thallium, a rare and highly toxic substance, prompting the police to register an attempt to murder case in an incident reminiscent of the slow-poisoning plot in the recently released Hindi movie, *Dhurandhar: The Revenge*.

The victim has been identified as businessman Sandeep Singh (41), a former Samajwadi Party Chhatra Sabha national general secretary, an officer said.

"A first information report (FIR) was lodged under BNS Section 109(i) (attempt to murder) at the Kotwali police station against unknown persons in Varanasi on Wednesday night based on the complaint by Khushboo Singh, wife of Sandeep Singh," Kotwali SHO Dayashankar Singh said.

The SHO added that the police are probing whether the poison was administered during travel, hospitalisation, business meetings or through food consumed outside the home.

Singh, who runs two transport firms linked to road construction logistics, is currently undergoing

THE FAMILY GREW SUSPICIOUS AFTER DOCTORS AT A MUMBAI HOSPITAL REPORTEDLY DETECTED TRACES OF THALLIUM IN HIS BLOOD

treatment at his Lucknow residence under medical supervision, his family members said. The case has triggered concern due to the nature of the toxin, which is rare, difficult to detect and often mimics neurological disorders in its early stages.

In her complaint, the victim's wife has alleged that an unidentified person might have administered the poison with an intent to kill.

The family grew suspicious after doctors at a Mumbai hospital reportedly detected traces of thallium in his blood.

According to the FIR, Singh first fell ill in late February 2025 while in Gurugram, where he had accompanied an acquaintance undergoing treatment. Initial symptoms—fever, tingling in

the legs, body pain and vomiting—progressively worsened into a severe neurological condition.

He was first admitted to Medanta Hospital and later shifted to Max Super Speciality Hospital, where doctors reportedly suspected Guillain-Barré syndrome (GBS). As his condition deteriorated, he was airlifted to PD Hinduja Hospital in Mumbai, where toxicology tests confirmed the presence of thallium in his bloodstream, the FIR said.

Sandeep Singh's brother, Ajit Singh, said: "We first lodged a zero FIR at Mahim police station in Mumbai on March 30, 2025, soon after doctors suspected poisoning."

However, the case file was sent back to Mumbai nearly five months later, resulting in a delay in formal registration and investigation.

"The FIR was finally registered on Wednesday," he added. Medical literature describes thallium as the "poisoner's poison" because it is colourless, odourless and tasteless, making it extremely difficult to detect if mixed with food or drink.

The investigation is underway, said police.

## HC SENDS CASE OVER SONG IN DHURANDHAR-2 TO MEDIATION

Shruti Kakkar

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**NEW DELHI:** The Delhi High Court on Thursday declined to order an immediate takedown of the song *Rang De Lal - Oye Oye* from the film *Dhurandhar 2*. The track, released under music label T-Series, which holds the film's music rights, has already been made public along with the film's theatrical release.

Justice Tushar Rao Gedela refused to pass takedown order, noting that the film had already been released in theatres and that the producers did not intend to release it on any OTT platform until the mid of May.

He, however, referred the copyright infringement suit filed by Trimurti Films against filmmaker Aditya Dhar's production house, B62 Studios, and T-Series to mediation.

The suit alleges unauthorised use of the song "Tirth Topiwale" from the film *Tridev* in the track "Rang De Lal - Oye Oye".

Justice Gedela observed that the dispute appeared to be primarily financial in nature and could be resolved between the parties.

## CBSE orders immediate start of third language from Class 6

Sanjay Maurya

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**NEW DELHI:** The Central Board of Secondary Education (CBSE) on Thursday directed schools to begin teaching a third language (R3) from Class 6 "immediately", using locally available books, in line with its latest scheme of studies.

The directive comes a week after CBSE, on April 2, introduced sweeping changes to its curriculum, making a third language compulsory from Class 6 starting with the 2026-27 academic session. The current batch of Class 6 students will be the first to study a compulsory third language through to Class 10 in 2030-31.

However, the subject will not be part of the board examination; instead, it will be assessed through an internal, school-

based evaluation in 2031, according to the curriculum document. In a circular dated April 9, CBSE asked schools to finalise their choice of third language(s), inform their respective regional offices, and update the details on the Online Affiliated School Information System (OASIS) portal.

It is further informed that only those R3 languages which are introduced in Class 6 by a school will be available as options

in Classes 9 and 10 for that school," the circular signed by Dr Praggya M. Singh, professor and director (Academics) said.

Under the new curriculum, language subjects will be organised into three levels—R1, R2 and R3—as part of a structured three-language model. R1 (Language 1) will be the student's main or strongest language, studied at a higher level. R2 (Language 2) is a different language, studied at a slightly different level. The third language (R3) will be compulsory from Class 6 starting academic session 2026-27 and extended progressively to Class 10 by 2030-31.

The changes operationalise ideas first mooted as part of the National Curriculum Framework for School Education 2023 and are aligned with the National Education Policy (NEP) 2020.

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## SPOTLIGHT ELECTIONS 2026



(Clockwise from top, left) Voters take a boat across the Brahmaputra river to polling booths in Darrang district of Assam; people queue up to cast their votes in Tripura and Kerala on Thursday; and Kerala BJP leader Rajeev Chandrasekhar, chief minister Pinarayi Vijayan, Congress leader V D Satheesan, Puducherry chief minister N Rangasamy, Assam chief minister Himanta Biswa Sarma and Congress leader Gaurav Gogoi exercised their franchise in their respective states.

AGENCIES

## Murshidabad, Malda seats top WB adjudication cuts

Abhishek Jha and  
Joydeep Thakur

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**NEW DELHI/KOLKATA:** All five assembly constituencies with the highest percentage of deletion from the pre-adjudication stage to post-adjudication in West Bengal were in the Muslim-majority districts of Murshidabad and Malda, an analysis of the removals in the controversial "logical discrepancy" category in the poll-bound state showed on Thursday.

Nearly 2.71 million of the six million people flagged under the "logical discrepancy" category were removed from the rolls, the Election Commission of India (ECI) announced earlier this week. These people could appeal their exclusion in front of tribunals but most of these 19 forums weren't fully operational by the time the rolls were frozen for the second phase of the elections on Thursday. The rolls for the first phase were already frozen earlier this week.

Bengal goes to the polls in two phases on April 23 and 29. The Trinamool Congress is hoping for a fourth consecutive term by defeating the Bharatiya Janata Party, the Congress and the Left.

The seats with the highest deletions of electors from the pre-adjudication roll to the post-adjudication roll were Sanserganj (31.7%), Lalgola (23.2%), Raghunathpur (18.4%), Mothabari (18.3%), and Bhagabangola (17.4%). With the exception of Mothabari in Malda, all other seats are in Murshidabad district. The TMC led in two of these seats and Congress in three in the 2024 Lok Sabha elections, the election closest to the special intensive revision (SIR). The TMC led in 190 of 294 seats in the state in the 2024 Lok Sabha elections. This showed that deletions, not a very different result from the 2024 assembly polls, when it went 233 seats.

The seats with the lowest deletions from the pre-adjudication roll to the post-adjudication roll are Manabzar (0.03%), Onda (0.04%), Kashipur (0.1%), Jhargram (0.2%), and Chhatna (0.1%). These seats were spread across Purulia, Bankura and Jhargram districts in the western part of the state. Four of these seats were led by the TMC and one by the BJP in the 2024 Lok Sabha elections. This showed that deletions were not correlated with party-wise winners. To be sure, this is to be expected when a single party wins almost a two-

**OVER 6 MILLION VOTERS' CLAIMS WERE UNDER ADJUDICATION, AND OVER 5.98 MILLION CASES HAVE BEEN DISPOSED OF**

thirds majority.

The overall percentage of deletions in the pre-SIR to post-adjudication process was higher than the victory margin of 2024 Lok Sabha elections in 154 assembly constituencies. But the two numbers are not correlated. In other words, percentage deletions in the SIR process cannot be predicted from the AC-level victory margin in the 2024 Lok Sabha elections. This holds true even when looking at deletions only at the adjudication stage, where deletions exceeded 2024 victory margins in 48 seats.

To be sure, these rankings can vary from the deletions under the adjudication process as a share of electors put under this process. However, just looking at this number can be misleading as far as SIR's net impact on the elector strength in assembly

seats is concerned, because unlike the pre-adjudication part of SIR, adjudication was not applied uniformly across seats in the state.

A more granular data analysis showed that seats which had elected at least one Muslim MLA in 2011, 2016 or 2021 assembly election, had a much higher share in voters put under adjudication. Given the fact that there is no seat-wise demographic composition of electors, extrapolating these numbers to SIR's impact on voters of a particular community is only an indicative rather than a definite indicator.

In chief minister Mamata Banerjee's seat of Bhabanipur, at least one out of every four voters was deleted. There were 206,295 voters in the seat before SIR. While 44,470 names were dropped in the draft roll, another 2,342 names were dropped in the final roll after the hearing process. ECI data showed that another 3,893 names of voters were deleted after the adjudication, taking the total number of deletions in Bhabanipur to 50,706.

Banerjee had won the seat in a by-election with a margin of 58,832 votes. She is now facing Suvendu Adhikari of the BJP.

ECI officials said that 6,006,675 doubtful voters' claims were under adjudication, and judicial officers appointed by the Calcutta high court disposed of 5,984,512 cases. The fate of the remaining 22,163 people was still unknown at the time of going to print.

People whose names were deleted after adjudication continued to queue up at government offices in the districts to submit documents, even though the 19 appellate tribunals are yet to become fully operational. "The tribunals are yet to become functional. The infrastructure, from where the retired judges, would function is almost ready. Stenographers need to be appointed," said a senior ECI official. The official mentioned above also said that some cases referred to the tribunals by the Supreme Court have been disposed of on an urgent basis.

"One of them was Suprabudha Sen, the grandson of Nandalal Bose, who decorated the original Constitution of India with motifs and illustrations. Mohab Shelik, the Congress candidate from Murshidabad district's Farakka seat, whose name was deleted was also restored," said the official.

## Assembly bypolls in Karnataka, Nagaland, Tripura largely peaceful

Priyanka Deb Barman  
and Alice Yhoshi

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**BENGALURU/KOCHIMA/AGARTALA:** Polling for four assembly bypolls across three states — Karnataka, Nagaland and Tripura — concluded without any major untoward incident on Thursday, officials said, adding all four seats recorded high voter turnout.

In Karnataka, over 68% voter turnout was recorded till 11 pm in both constituencies that went to bypolls, according to data from ECI. Bagalkot registered 68.67% turnout, while Davanagere South recorded 68.43% — both tentative figures. The bypolls were necessitated due to the deaths of Congress MLAs Hy Met (Bagalkot) and Shamanur Shivashankarappa (Davanagere South). In Bagalkot, over 259,000 voters were eligible to vote across 319 polling stations, with nine candidates in fray. Davanagere South has over 231,000

voters and 25 candidates contesting across 284 polling booths. The Congress has fielded family members of the deceased MLAs, Umesh Meti and Samarth Mallikarjun, while the BJP has nominated Veerabhadrayya Charantimath and newcomer Srinivas T. Dasakurappa, respectively.

In Nagaland, the Koridang assembly bypoll in Mokochung district recorded a turnout of 82.2% till 11 pm with officials describing the voting process as peaceful. Polling was conducted across 30 stations and 18,400 people voted. The seat fell vacant after the death of BJP MLA Imkong L. Imchen in November 2025. The BJP has fielded his son, Daochier Imchen. Five other candidates, including nominees from the Congress and NPP, are also in the fray. Officials said minor technical glitches caused brief delays at some booths, but no untoward incidents were reported on polling day.

In Tripura, the Dharmanagar assembly constituency

recorded a voter turnout of 80.04% till 11 pm with polling proceeding largely without disruption. A total of 46,142 voters were eligible to cast their ballots across 55 polling stations.

The bypoll was necessitated by the death of assembly speaker Biswabandhu Sen in December, last year. Six candidates are contesting, including nominees from the BJP, CPI(M), and Congress. While the BJP expressed satisfaction over a "free and fair" poll, the Congress alleged that some voters were threatened on the eve of polling and that its polling agents were briefly obstructed.

BJP candidate Jahar Chakraborty said, "People support the developmental politics of the state government. We hope it will be reflected in the bypoll results."

Results of all four bypolls will be declared on May 4, along with assembly polls in Kerala, Tamil Nadu, West Bengal, Assam and Puducherry.

(With agency inputs)

## Bhabanipur, entire Bengal to walk the Nandigram way: PM

Joydeep Thakur

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**KOLKATA:** Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Thursday sharpened the Bharatiya Janata Party's (BJP) attack on the ruling Trinamool Congress (TMC), saying that the "feat" his party achieved in Nandigram in 2021 assembly elections, will be repeated in Bhabanipur and entire West Bengal, as he addressed back-to-back rallies across the poll-bound state.

In 2021, chief minister Mamata Banerjee was defeated by her former aide and now a BJP leader Suvendu Adhikari. Speaking first at Haldia in East Midnapore, PM Modi said the political shift that began in Nandigram would now extend across the state. "Nandigram had shown the path for change five years ago. Now entire Bengal is



**TMC HITS BACK AT MODI'S CLAIMS IN WB RALLY**

HTC and PTI

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**NEW DELHI:** The Trinamool Congress (TMC) on Thursday hit back at Prime Minister Narendra Modi, sharing a "fact-check" on claims made by the Prime Minister in his speech at a rally in West Bengal's Haldia earlier in the day.

In a post on X, TMC leader Derek O'Brien said, "Let's expose his (PM Modi's) 7 claims and put out a 7-point reality check." On Modi's assertion that India is progressing rapidly while the TMC is holding Bengal back, O'Brien highlighted the state's economic growth. He said West Bengal's growth rate surpassed

## poll diary

**KHERA'S PRE-ARREST BAIL PLEA: HC DEFERS HEARING**

**BENGALURU:** The Telangana High Court on Thursday adjourned the hearing to April 10 on the anticipatory bail petition filed by Congress leader Pawan Khera in a case filed against him by the Assam government over his allegations against CM Himanta Biswa Sarma's wife. Congress leader Abhishek Singhvi, who argued for Khera, alleged political vendetta in the case. Assam Advocate General Devajit Saha, who argued against Khera, dismissed the claims.

**WEST BENGAL: NIA FILES 12 FIRS IN MALDA HOSTAGE CASE**

**KOLKATA:** The National Investigation Agency (NIA), probing into the case in which seven judicial officers were held hostage by a mob in West Bengal's Malda on April 1, has registered 12 FIRs, the agency said in a statement on Thursday. While five FIRs were lodged at the Kaliachak police station, seven FIRs were lodged at Mothabari police station. On April 1, a large mob gheraoed the seven judicial officers, during a protest against the removal of names in the SIR.

**CONG VOWS TO TRANSFORM TAMIL NADU IN MANIFESTO**

**CHENNAI:** The Congress on Thursday released its manifesto aimed for the forthcoming Tamil Nadu assembly elections, with an aim to "transform" the southern state. The manifesto pledges to transform the state with major initiatives targeting employment, public safety, healthcare, and law and order. One of the highlights of the election document is the promise of Universal Basic Income (UBI). The party has pledged ₹2,000 per month for every family.

## Repoll if camera feed at West Bengal booths are disrupted, says ECI

Harsh Yadav

letters@hindustantimes.com

**NEW DELHI:** The Election Commission of India (ECI) on Thursday

alongside widespread complaints of booth-level intimidation. Despite disturbances across all eight phases, repoll was ordered in only one booth.

[ WEST BENGAL ] AT POLL CAMPS

## CAPF personnel flag poor living conditions

Prawesh Lama, Sanjeev K Jha and Harsh Yadav

letters@hindustantimes.com

**NEW DELHI:** The central armed police force (CAPF) personnel

THE CONCERNS RANGE FROM POOR VENTILATION, NON-FUNCTIONAL



walking in that direction. The same will be reported in Bhubaneswar," he said, referring to the BJP fielding Adhikari against Banerjee in her stronghold.

The PM further cornered TMC government over governance and corruption, while announcing a set of assurances for the BJP comes to power. These included restoring "trust and removing fear," ensuring accountability in administration, reopening files on alleged scams and crimes against women, acting against corruption irrespective of rank, granting rights to refugees while tackling infiltration, and implementing the 7th pay commission for state government employees.

A key theme across Modi's speeches, from Haldia to Anasol and Birbhum, was fisheries and food politics. Accusing the TMC of failing to make Bengal self-reliant in fish production despite high demand, Modi said, "Even fish has to be procured from other states. This reflects the corruption and inefficiency of the government." He credited central schemes such as the



Pradhan Mantri Matsya Sampada Yojana for boosting production nationally and in BJP-ruled states, alleging that the TMC did not implement it effectively due to political considerations.

In Anasol, the PM said Bengal was "yearning for a double-engine government" and predicted a "new era of development" after the election results. He also took aim at the TMC's foundational slogan from 2011, "Ma, Mati, Manush", claiming that "today, the mother is crying, the soil is being grabbed, and people are living in fear."

The attack turned sharper in Birbhum, where Modi made an example of the Bogtuli violence to describe TMC rule as "jungle

product has increased fivefold over the past 15 years."

On the PM's claim that factories have shut down and workers are migrating out of the state, the TMC leader said the total number of registered companies in Bengal increased from 137,000 in 2011 to 250,000 in 2025.

Challenging Modi's statement that BJP-ruled states have undergone development, he pointed out that 210 million Indians still live in "Multidimensional Poverty" as per NITI Aayog, addressing a rally in North 24 Parganas, hit back at the BJP, asserting that the TMC would retain power despite alleged large-scale deletions from electoral rolls. She also countered the BJP's claims on fisheries, highlighting her government's efforts to boost fish production, including initiatives around Hilsa conservation and reducing dependence on imports.

"First round of counting may indicate that the BJP is leading in some areas. However, the later rounds will turn results overwhelmingly in our favour," Banerjee said.

announced sweeping changes to polling procedures in West Bengal, barring state police, civic volunteers and the state's Green Police from any election-related duty, while mandating immediate polls if live camera feeds at polling booths are disrupted in 2025.

"Any disruption in live camera feed will now be treated as a serious breach of polling transparency. Polls will be ordered immediately... to ensure the sanctity of voting is fully protected," a senior ECI official said.

The ECI also mandated a complete on-ground control to the central armed police forces (CAPF), with around 240,000 personnel deployed, the highest ever for a state election. ECI has also removed the state administration's role in CAPF deployment, vesting authority entirely with Commission-appointed police officers.

The decisions, officials said, stem from past experiences of violence and surveillance failures. The 2023 West Bengal elections saw over 1,300 incidents of violence and at least 25 deaths,

An internal audit further revealed major lapses in surveillance. "The audit revealed systemic failure... a significant proportion of cameras either did not record or recorded only fragments of polling," a senior official from the state CEO office said, adding that the lack of footage hampered verification of complaints and court proceedings.

Acting on these findings, ECI has replaced its earlier vendor and will deploy around 200,000 cameras across 80,719 polling stations, monitored through a three-tier control room system. Cameras will also be installed in surveillance and flying squad vehicles with battery backup.

The directive barring civic volunteers and Green Police reiterates an earlier 2017 order that was not fully enforced.

"There will be zero tolerance for any attempt to disrupt polling... Every incident will invite immediate action, including repol," the official added.

Polling across 294 seats in the state is scheduled for April 23 and April 29.

deployed for election duty in West Bengal have flagged concerns over substandard living conditions at several camps, prompting the Election Commission of India (ECI) to invoke emergency provisions under the Model Code of Conduct (MCC) to float tenders and fast-track arrangements for basic amenities, officials aware of the matter said.

To be sure, while the arrangement is done by the district administration, they are currently reporting to the CEO, West Bengal, due to the MCC in place.

Non-functional toilets and poor ventilation to inadequate bedding and no water supply, multiple terms of CRPF complaints reported deficiencies across camps, particularly in south Bengal, pointing not just to inhumane conditions but also to security at the camps.

One CRPF officer, wishing not to be named, said, "When forces are sent to any place on polling duty, the arrangement is done by the state government. Such issues have been flagged at different camps, mostly in south Bengal... An audit of the camp security and

living conditions was also done after the issues were first pointed out by the personnel on ground."

A second official said concerns have emerged from camps in places such as Purba Bardhaman, Purba Bardhaman, Paschim Bardhaman, Birbhum, Malda and Murshidabad, underlining that the issue is not limited to one region.

"Even the absence of proper lighting outside poses a threat to the arms, ammunition, or even documents of the ECI. Such amenities such as proper lighting outside camps should have been done before. This is a violation of the standard guidelines in place."

The second official added that the concerns were highlighted due to the contrast with facilities in the same districts for the West Bengal police personnel.

A senior official in the Bengal CEO's office confirmed receiving multiple complaints from district election officers over the past few days. "After numerous complaints, directions have been issued to fix the problems."

NEW DELHI  
FRIDAY  
APRIL 10, 2026

# Nitish to take RS oath today, may get Type-8 bungalow

Sanjeev K Jha and Arun Kumar  
Letters@hindustantimes.com

**NEW DELHI/PATNA:** Bihar chief minister Nitish Kumar arrived in Delhi on Thursday, will take oath as a Rajya Sabha MP on Friday, return to Patna that very evening, and resign as chief minister soon after — paving the way for the naming of the new chief minister and formation of the new government, both of which are expected on April 14 or 15.



Nitish Kumar

Kumar is likely to be allotted a high-security Type-8 government bungalow in Lutyens' Delhi, with renovation work already underway at three houses in the Sunehri Bagh area, according to senior leaders of the Janata Dal (United).

In Patna, Kumar's successor, the new CM and the new Bihar government, are likely to be named and take shape soon after the end of Khammas — a spell of days considered inauspicious — on April 13.

Sanjeev Kumar Jha, the working president of JD(U) and also a Rajya Sabha MP, said that the process to form the next Bihar government will "start from April 14."

A senior JD(U) functionary who asked not to be named said that three Type-8 bungalows have been identified for Kumar, and their refurbishment, including painting and maintenance work, is currently in progress. "One of these

lance systems, including round-the-clock CCTV monitoring from the main gate to internal premises, are standard features.

Such houses are located in the heart of Lutyens' Delhi, the administrative nerve centre of the country that houses top political executives and senior ministers. The zone has over 3,000 government bungalows and flats, of which more than 100 fall under the Type-8 category.

Several prominent political figures currently reside in similar accommodations. Union home minister Amit Shah and defence minister Rajnath Singh are among those allotted Type-8 residences. Senior Congress leader Rahul Gandhi has also been provided a similar category of housing in the capital.

More recently, BJP national president Nalin Babu was allotted a Type-8 bungalow following his elevation within the party ranks.

Officials familiar with the process said the Directorate of Estates (DoE) follows a strict protocol for allotment based on rank, position, and entitlement. "Kumar's likely move into such a residence underscores his continued prominence in national politics, even as he transitions from Patna to a more active role in New Delhi," said a second senior JD(U) leader, who also asked not to be named.

DoE officials said that some of

the bungalows in Sunehri Bagh are being renovated, but the names of allottees have not been communicated to them as yet.

Kumar was accompanied to Delhi by Bihar minister and his close aide Vijay Kumar Choudhary, Choudhary said that Nitish would return to Patna on the evening of April 10.

Kumar is expected to meet senior BJP leaders on Friday, HT said, as the BJP has also called a meeting of senior party leaders, including the core committee members from Bihar, in Delhi. This meeting may happen soon after Kumar takes oath and is expected to see discussions on the transition and the new CM.

The shape of the new government is also expected to change with new faces, including Nitish Kumar's son Nishant Kumar. Choudhary said that Nitish Kumar would tender his resignation as CM after returning from Delhi to pave the way for the formation of the new government.

"The new government will also run on the Nitish model of development with justice. What he has done in the last 20 years in different spheres to transform Bihar is unparalleled and that is the reason his popularity has only grown with time and the new government will take his forward as Nitish legacy is NDA's strength as well as inspiration," he added.

## NIT KURUKSHETRA STUDENT FOUND DEAD IN HOSTEL

**KURUKSHETRA:** A student of National Institute of Technology (NIT) Kurukshetra, was found dead in his hostel room, with police suspecting he died by suicide, officials said on Thursday.

The exact cause behind the extreme step remains unclear, they added.

According to police, the deceased was a B.Tech student, and a resident of Haryana's Sirsa district.

Assistant sub-inspector Vinod Kumar said the victim had contacted a friend between 6:30 pm and 7 pm on Wednesday, asking him to visit his room late in the night, and said the door would be open.

However, when the friend arrived around 11:15 pm, he found the door locked from inside. Despite repeated knocks, there was no response. His post-mortem was conducted on Thursday. The officer said no suicide note has been recovered and further help is on. PTI

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## ARCHERY COACH BOOKED FOR RAPING MINOR

**HT Correspondent**  
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**DEHRADUN:** Haridwar Police is conducting raids to arrest an archery coach from Dehradun, allegedly raping a 14-year-old student of a reputed school, police said on Thursday.

Based on a complaint filed by the girl's father, police registered a case at Kankhal police station on April 7 against the coach and initiated an investigation.

Kankhal police station in charge Devendra Singh Rawat said, "The accused was providing archery training to students at a reputed school in Kankhal area. The girl was undergoing training there. It has been alleged that in October last year, he sexually assaulted and threatened her."

An FIR has been registered under the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita section related to rape and relevant sections of the PoCSO Act, the officer said.

# Vendor beheads man after dispute, lynched in Araria

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**ARARIA:** A 42-year-old pickupvan driver was beheaded allegedly by a roadside vendor, who was later beaten to death by local residents in Bihar's Araria district on Thursday, prompting additional deployment of police force as the incident involved members from different communities, senior officers said.

According to Jitendra Kumar, superintendent of police (SP), Araria district, which is headquartered in Forbesganj, the incident took place in the morning when Nahi Hussain, who drove a pickup vehicle, had a quarrel with Ravi Chauhan (30).

"Chauhan used to sell sattu (roasted gram flour) at a local market, which he picked up a quarrel with Hussain and attacked him with a dagger, which police have seized," the SP said.

Chauhan left Hussain's beheaded body on the road and fled, police said.

Local residents caught hold of Chauhan and thrashed him until he was rescued by a police party, which rushed to the spot upon hearing about the incident. Chauhan was taken to a hospital where

This incident shows the degraded state of the law-and-order situation in Bihar

TEJASHWI YADAV

he succumbed to injuries," the SP said.

The bodies of both the deceased have been sent for post-mortem examination. "Further investigations are on," the senior officer added.

Sub-divisional police officer (SDPO) Mahesh Kumar Saha said police have launched an investigation into the incident from "multiple angles, including a parking dispute." Saha added that police forces have been put on high alert and additional personnel have been deployed to avert further violence.

As the incident involves two different communities, the matter is serious," another police officer said, requesting anonymity.

The officer, citing local resi-

dents, said there was allegedly a dispute between Chauhan and Hussain over an affair and the vendor killed the driver in a fit of rage.

Meanwhile, images of Hussain's severed head, lying on the road, apparently captured by onlookers on their phones, were widely circulated on social media.

Leader of the Opposition in the Bihar assembly, Tejashwi Prasad Yadav, shared a purported image on the incident on X and slammed the state government for the "barbaric state of affairs" in Bihar and described the NDA rule as "a messed-up regime."

"A man publicly slit another man's throat right in the middle of the market and roamed around with his severed head amidst hundreds of people. Later, the family of the deceased murdered the killer in rage," the RJD leader alleged. "This incident shows the degraded state of the law-and-order situation in Bihar. While the ruling coalition leaders are ignoring the problem, the opposition is not taking any steps for the 'CM seat', incidents of drug, murder, and rape are rising every day in Bihar."

(With agency inputs)

# AI Mumbai-B'luu flight scare as engine stalls

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**NEW DELHI:** An Air India flight from Mumbai to Bengaluru returned shortly after takeoff on Thursday after one of its engines stalled, prompting the pilots to issue a "PAN PAN" emergency call, officials familiar with the matter said.



Passengers reported hearing a loud sound and seeing sparks during take-off.

The incident involved flight AI 2812, an Airbus A320neo, which was originally scheduled to depart Mumbai at 2:05 am.

The aircraft took off around 2:30 am but returned to the airport within minutes, the officials said. Passengers reported hearing a loud sound and seeing

declared PAN PAN and returned to the airport within minutes," said an official, requesting anonymity.

"It was later found that engine 2 had stalled," the official added.

An Air India spokesperson, however, termed it a precautionary return.

"Flight AI 2812 from Mumbai to Bengaluru on April 9 returned to Mumbai shortly after take-off as a precaution due to a suspected technical issue, in accordance with standard operating procedures. The aircraft landed safely and is undergoing detailed technical inspections," the spokesperson said.

An airport official said a local

standby was declared before the aircraft landed safely. The airline said passengers were provided assistance and an alternative aircraft was arranged.

"We regret the inconvenience caused to our passengers. Our Mumbai airport teams provided immediate assistance, and an alternate aircraft was arranged to operate the flight. The safety and wellbeing of our passengers and crew remain our top priority," the spokesperson added.

Officials said the aircraft, carrying 47 passengers, was grounded following the incident. "An alternate aircraft was arranged that departed around 4:45 am," an official said.

**कार्यालय अधिष्ठाता अभियन्ता**  
विद्युत विभाग, दिल्ली  
112 केडीडी उपकेंद्र इंदौर, दिल्ली-284135  
उपकेंद्राध्यक्ष कार्यालय  
अनुपम के. सक्सेना, सहायक अभियन्ता से ई-निविदा के संबंध में निम्न कार्य सम्पन्न हो चुके हैं: निविदा अधिसूचना को जारी कर: 01/04/2026 ई-निविदा के माध्यम से कार्यवाही सम्पन्न की।  
वेबसाइट: [www.ebidder.in](http://www.ebidder.in) पर उपलब्ध है।  
अधिकृत पत्राचार: 01/04/2026 के रूप में जो अधिसूचना अधिसूचित, निविदाका, जारी की गई है उस को नया संख्या अधिसूचना है। अधिसूचना के माध्यम से निविदा अधिसूचना/अधिसूचना करने का अधिकार सुरक्षित है।  
ई-निविदा से: 01/04/2026 को 12/04/2026-27 तक निविदा, जारी की गई 132 केडी उपकेंद्र से 02 नव 40 उपकेंद्रों तक 132 केडी उपकेंद्र इंदौर पर 01 नव 43 उपकेंद्रों पर निविदा को निविदा का कार्य।

## APPEAL FOR IDENTIFICATION

General public is hereby informed that an unidentified dead body of male

**Name:** Unknown **S/o:** Unknown  
**R/o:** Unknown, **Age:** approx. 25 Years, **Height:** 5'8", **Complexion:** Dark, **Face:** Round, **Built:** Normal.  
**Wearing:** Blue color Jacket & Blue colour Trouser, who was found at Road side near M.G. Marg near Shanti Van, Delhi. In this regard a DD/FIR No. 114A Dt. 17.03.2026. has been registered at P.S. Kotwali, Delhi.

Any person having any information or clue about the deceased may kindly inform to the undersigned on the following address or telephone no.

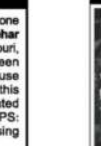


**Jasvinder Singh**  
Name: Jasvinder Singh, Father's Name: Kehar Singh, Age: 35 yrs., Height: 5'9", Built: Medium, Face: Round, Complexion: Wheatish, He is unmarried, Wearing: Blue Jacket & Black Pant & Black Sleepers in feet. Identification Mark: A 'JASIR' Name Tag on his left Fore arm and designer T-shirt on his right Upper Arms.  
If anyone having any clue/information, kindly inform the undersigned.  
E-mail: [dcib@ai.gov.in](mailto:dcib@ai.gov.in) or [dcib@ai.gov.in](mailto:dcib@ai.gov.in)

## SEARCH FOR MISSING

General Public is hereby informed that one person namely **Jasvinder Singh S/o Kehar Singh, R/o D/65, Gali No. 10, Dharmpur, Ravi Nagar Extn., Khayala, Delhi**, has been missing since 08.02.2026 from his house in the area of P.S. Khayala, Delhi. In this regard a case vide No. 47A dated 09.02.2026 has been registered at P.S. Khayala, Delhi. The description of missing person is as under:-

Name: Jasvinder Singh, Father's Name: Kehar Singh, Age: 35 yrs., Height: 5'9", Built: Medium, Face: Round, Complexion: Wheatish, He is unmarried, Wearing: Blue Jacket & Black Pant & Black Sleepers in feet. Identification Mark: A 'JASIR' Name Tag on his left Fore arm and designer T-shirt on his right Upper Arms.  
If anyone having any clue/information, kindly inform the undersigned.  
E-mail: [dcib@ai.gov.in](mailto:dcib@ai.gov.in) or [dcib@ai.gov.in](mailto:dcib@ai.gov.in)



**Sandhya**  
General Public is hereby informed that one Female (depicted in the photo) namely **Sandhya D/o Rameshwar, R/o H.No. C-43/127, Ambekar Basti, Karol Bagh, Delhi, Age-20 Yrs.**, has been reported missing since 01.04.2026, at around 8:30 PM, from her residence, vide DD No. 116A, Dated 03.04.2026, registered at Police Station Dush Bandhu Gupta Road, Central Distt., New Delhi-110005. Her physical description is as under:  
**Sex:** Female, **Height:** 5'1", **Face:** Round, **Complexion:** Fair, **Built:** Thin, **Wearing:** Purple Frock Suit, Pajama and Slipper on her Feet.  
Purpore Frock suits have been made by local police to trace out the missing female but no clue has come to light so far. If anyone have any information about this missing female please inform to the following.

## SEARCH FOR MISSING/KIDNAPPED

General Public is hereby informed that one Female (depicted in the photo) namely **Sandhya D/o Rameshwar, R/o H.No. C-43/127, Ambekar Basti, Karol Bagh, Delhi, Age-20 Yrs.**, has been reported missing since 01.04.2026, at around 8:30 PM, from her residence, vide DD No. 116A, Dated 03.04.2026, registered at Police Station Dush Bandhu Gupta Road, Central Distt., New Delhi-110005. Her physical description is as under:  
**Sex:** Female, **Height:** 5'1", **Face:** Round, **Complexion:** Fair, **Built:** Thin, **Wearing:** Purple Frock Suit, Pajama and Slipper on her Feet.  
Purpore Frock suits have been made by local police to trace out the missing female but no clue has come to light so far. If anyone have any information about this missing female please inform to the following.



[illegible]







# Act after Prez assent

HT Correspondent

letters@hindustantimes.com

**NEW DELHI:** The Centre on Thursday notified the Central Armed Police Forces (General Administration) Act, 2026, a day after receiving the President's assent. The legislative department of ministry of law and justice issued the gazette notification.

The CAPF bill was passed in Parliament on April 2. Earlier in the day, Congress leader Rahul Gandhi issued a statement on CRPF's Valour Day objecting to the new law, and promised to end the discriminatory system if the Congress-led government came to power.

The Act creates a unified legal framework for all five CAPFs and codifies the deputation of Indian Police Service (IPS) officers at senior levels. CAPF associations have long opposed the practice and

approached the Supreme Court, which on May 23, 2025, directed the government to "progressively reduce" IPS deputation.

It provides that 50% of the posts will be filled through deputation from IPS in the rank of an inspector general and a minimum of 67% of the posts through deputation in the rank of an ADG. The posts in the ranks of special director general and director general shall be filled through deputation only, it says.

Meanwhile, former CAPF personnel and their families held a silent protest at Rajghat under the banner of Alliance of All Ex Paramilitary Forces Welfare Association on Thursday afternoon. The alliance said if the government doesn't invite a delegation of former officers for talks, they will march from India Gate to Rashtrapati Bhawan on June 15.

HT

## Rise above political, personal interests, Om Birla tells MPs

**PANAJI:** Lok Sabha Speaker Om Birla on Thursday urged lawmakers to rise above personal and political interests, emphasising the importance of diligently and with integrity fulfilling the hopes and aspirations of the people they represent. Speaking on the roles and responsibilities of young lawmakers, the Lok Sabha Speaker highlighted their pivotal role in realising the vision of Viksit Bharat by 2047.

## Conng CWC meet to discuss women's bill, West Asia crisis

**NEW DELHI:** The Congress will hold a meeting of its working committee on Friday, where the party's top leadership is expected to deliberate on the government's move to amend the women's reservation law, the proposed delimitation exercise, and the West Asia conflict, party functionaries said. The crucial meeting will be held at 3pm the party's Indira Bhawan headquarters, they said.

## MAN ON DONKEY ROUTE TO KOREA STUCK IN ETHIOPIA

Mohan Rajput

letters@hindustantimes.com

**RUDRAPUR:** A 26-year-old man from Punjab, Rohit Kumar, who had come to visit his maternal uncle in Gadarpur in Uttarakhand's US Nagar district, has allegedly been confined in Ethiopia after being sent abroad through an illegal "donkey route" by agents promising him a job in South Korea, officials said.

According to police, the miscreants demanded a ransom of ₹50 lakh for his release and threatened to chop off his ears if the amount was not paid. The victim's maternal uncle, Rajkumar, approached police on Tuesday along with former BJP MLA Rajkumar Thakral and met SSP Udham Singh Nagar, Ajay Ganpati. "We have registered an FIR against an agent and four of his associates in Gadarpur after the complainant produced phone call records and photographs showing the victim's confinement," the SSP said.

According to the complaint, he came into contact with one Himanshu Sharma, a resident of Gadarpur, who promised him a job in South Korea through a Punjab-based agent and demanded ₹15 lakh as commission.

He allegedly paid ₹5.65 lakh in advance. He was taken to Bangkok on April 4 and then routed to Ethiopia via Sharjah, the complaint stated.

## BHANDARI'S PLEA AGAINST 'FUGITIVE' TAG REJECTED

Shruti Kakkur

letters@hindustantimes.com

**NEW DELHI:** The Delhi high court on Thursday dismissed UK-based arms dealer Sanjay Bhandari's petition against trial court's order declaring him a fugitive economic offender (FEO). "The appeal is dismissed," a bench of Justice Neena Bansal Krishna said while pronouncing the verdict.

The trial court on July 5, 2025, declared Bhandari as FEO in the proceedings initiated by ED. This development allows the probe agency to confiscate his properties anywhere in the world and bar him from filing or defending any civil proceedings in India.

The court had ruled that the FEO tag was another way of coercing Bhandari to come back to India, by attachment, confiscation of his properties.

In his petition before the high court, Bhandari said ED's application to declare him as FEO was "premature," as the agency had filed it without a final assessment order confirming that the alleged tax evasion exceeded ₹100 crore.

He added that ED lacked material evidence at the time of initiating the proceedings, and the only document which formed the application's basis was a letter received from the Income Tax (IT) Department in July 2019, which alleged that the proceeds of crime were more than ₹100 crore.






# Lakhpati Didi Yojana

## To make women Financially Empowered



## Target to make 5 Lakh women Lakhpati Didis in the State

### Non-Stop Haryana

### Pink Cab Yojana

Training to women to operate electric vehicles along with loan facility

### Financial Assistance

Credit guarantee support up to ₹5 lakh on loans along with interest waiver for 3 years

**So Far**

More than 4.83 lakh women from Self-Help Groups have been identified and 1,50,020 have been made Lakhpati Didis

Information, Public Relations & Languages Department, Haryana | [www.prharyana.gov.in](http://www.prharyana.gov.in) | <https://twitter.com/prharyana> | <https://www.facebook.com/prharyana> | <https://www.youtube.com/prharyana> | <https://www.instagram.com/prharyana> | <https://www.linkedin.com/company/prharyana> | <https://www.tiktok.com/prharyana> | <https://www.snapchat.com/prharyana> | <https://www.whatsapp.com/prharyana> | <https://www.telegram.me/prharyana> | <https://www.viber.com/prharyana> | <https://www.zoosk.com/prharyana> | <https://www.badoo.com/prharyana> | <https://www.tinder.com/prharyana> | <https://www.okcupid.com/prharyana> | <https://www.match.com/prharyana> | <https://www.eharmony.com/prharyana> | <https://www.bumble.com/prharyana> | <https://www.tantan.com/prharyana> | <https://www.tinder.com/prharyana> | <https://www.okcupid.com/prharyana> | <https://www.match.com/prharyana> | <https://www.eharmony.com/prharyana> | <https://www.bumble.com/prharyana> | <https://www.tantan.com/prharyana>

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## OPINION

The  
**Hindustan Times**  
ESTABLISHED IN 1924

{ OUR TAKE }

## Respect the red lines

The Election Commission of India should be careful about institutional overreach

India's thriving democracy is among the most significant and consequential achievements of the seven-decade-old republic. Despite crushing poverty and illiteracy, a young nation showed the world in 1951-52 that it could not only successfully

## In the Hormuz window, an opportunity for India

New Delhi must leverage its standing in the region and insert itself into a negotiation that will shape West Asia for a generation

When President Donald Trump announced a two-

incompatible with Washington's red lines. Trump described it as "a workable basis to negotiate", which in diplomatic language means, "we will talk, but we concede nothing yet". A particularly contentious element is the monetisation of the Strait itself. Iran proposes a transit fee of approximately \$2 million per vessel, shared with Oman and earmarked for reconstruction — effectively institutionalising financial leverage over a

a telling "I hear yes." With its own energy imports devastated by the Strait's closure, China had every reason to act. The ceasefire rehabilitates Beijing's image as a global peacemaker and advances its long-term project of positioning the yuan as the currency of Persian Gulf energy trade. Iran's insistence that Hormuz tolls be collected in rials or yuan is no coincidence; it is coordination. And then there is India...



The ceasefire rehabilitates Beijing's image as a global peacemaker and advances its long-term project of positioning the yuan as the currency of Persian Gulf energy trade.

rather than statement, that India's national vision is maximum inclusion offers India an opportunity to recalibrate and recover the full North of the

NEW DELHI  
FRIDAY  
APRIL 10, 2026



value every citizen's vote equally but also establish a distinct model of elections across an incredibly diverse landscape. At the heart of this project was the Election Commission of India (ECI), acting as a bulwark in expanding the franchise, helping people who had never imagined themselves as electors before to pick their representatives, and building a level-playing field in a country riven by inequalities and structural problems such as caste. If India's democracy has grown deep roots today, a large chunk of the credit must go to ECI.

This backdrop is why the poll watchdog's recent actions are that much more disquieting. The special intensive revision (SIR) of electoral rolls in Bengal threatens to disenfranchise millions of citizens. Caught in a confrontation between the state government and ECI, these people voted in the previous polls and have simply run out of time for the authorities to process their appeals. To add to this sorry spectacle, reports have alleged faulty translation software and a rushed process bereft of oversight. ECI has transferred more officers in Bengal than in all other states combined 20 times over. Despite this, the new officers failed to control violence in Malda, leading to seven judicial officials being held hostage. And now, the poll panel is locked in an unprecedented face-off with the TMC; its post on X reeks of political rhetoric unbecoming of a constitutional body. If ECI promises, in a "straight talk" to a political party that this election will be free of "fear," "violence," or "booth jamming," does it really expect the panel failed to secure free-and-fair elections in the past? Is it proper for a body with a storied history and international reputation to indulge in plain political polemics?

In India, the executive is responsible for selecting election commissioners. Despite some past controversies, ECI has largely managed to rise above partisan politics and ensure credible polls — especially after large-scale reforms ushered in by TN Seshan. It should not risk denting its standing with one controversy after another, no matter the provocation. Its recent actions threaten to create a perception of bias — something that has sullied a number of other institutions in this country. Instead, ECI should work to safeguard its well-earned reputation as the guardian of the world's largest democracy.

## Monetary policy in a time of war

The Monetary Policy Committee (MPC) of RBI did not change either the policy rate or its stance on Wednesday. Because there were no full year growth and inflation projections in the February MPC meeting, there are no tangible takeaways on the growth-inflation impact of the war in West Asia. That said, India's FY27 GDP growth will be significantly lower than FY26's, and inflation will be higher than last year. The MPC and the RBI governor were both unambiguous about the adverse fallout of the war for the Indian economy. There are concerns about supply-side turbulence over and above the terms of trade shock from higher crude prices. Then there is the financial and currency market turbulence that is forcing RBI to intervene beyond its usual "growth-inflation balancing" mandate.

The situation, as far as the war's economic fallout is concerned, continues to be fluid. This time, the MPC met against the backdrop of a ceasefire announcement. Whether or not the ceasefire endures remains to be seen. There is thus a lot of merit in waiting for more clarity on the dynamics of the war before committing to a policy response. RBI will have to choose its course cautiously, given the unconventional nature of the problem. For example, if inflation does rise because of supply-side disruptions, a knee-jerk interest rate hike might not help and, in fact, end up eroding demand rather than solving the problem at hand. Prudent supply-side management by the government is needed. Such an exercise could necessitate a higher than usual fiscal deficit as the government tries to procure more supplies from international markets. This might require a different kind of intervention from RBI. What is needed is a nimble policy response where the monetary and fiscal arms are in sync. It isn't business as usual for the economy. It shouldn't be for RBI.

WW... 7, 2026 — barely 90 minutes before his own military strike deadline expired — the world heaved a sigh of relief. Oil prices plunged 14-16%. Equity markets from Tokyo to Frankfurt surged. For a planet that had spent five weeks watching the world's most critical energy chokepoint become a war zone, the pause felt like oxygen returning to a suffocating room.

The deal's bare bones are this: The US and Israel suspend strikes on Iran; Iran halts "defensive operations" and guarantees commercial transit through the Strait of Hormuz — under a fee-collection arrangement jointly administered with Oman. Formal negotiations begin in Islamabad today (April 10). Both sides are claiming victory. Both domestic audiences expect irreconcilable outcomes.

Iran's 10-point proposal — demanding comprehensive sanctions relief, release of frozen assets, recognition of its uranium enrichment rights, compensation for destroyed infrastructure, and the exclusion of US and Israeli vessels from the Strait — remains

... week ceasefire with Iran on April 7, 2026 — barely 90 minutes before his own military strike deadline expired — the world heaved a sigh of relief. Oil prices plunged 14-16%. Equity markets from Tokyo to Frankfurt surged. For a planet that had spent five weeks watching the world's most critical energy chokepoint become a war zone, the pause felt like oxygen returning to a suffocating room.

The public narrative credits Pakistan as the indispensable mediator. The privately credited China as the indispensable enforcer. Pakistan provided the forum, the goodwill, and the backchannel — Army chief Asim Munir's direct rapport with Trump, foreign minister Dar's shuttle diplomacy between Washington and Tehran, Islamabad's willingness to host what no other capital would. These are genuine contributions.

But when Iran was still refusing to engage, and Islamabad's forums were being dismissed as irrelevant by Tehran, it was Beijing that made the decisive calls. China buys most of Iran's oil; its economic lifeline. China's foreign minister Wang Yi made 26 calls to parties across the conflict, and in the final critical hours, Chinese officials engaged Tehran directly, bypassing intermediaries. Trump himself, when asked whether China got Iran to the negotiating table, responded with



Asuf Sayeed

... nation with 10 million citizens in Gulf countries, roughly 50% of its crude oil transiting the Strait, a decade-long investment in Chabahar Port, and historic ties with Iran — watching one of the region's most consequential diplomatic moments unfold from the spectator's gallery.

India never sought a mediation role in this conflict. But that distinction may matter less than the perception its actions have created. New Delhi's decision to align publicly and closely with Israel — symbolised by a high-profile visit to Tel Aviv in late February, just 48 hours before US-Israeli strikes on Iran commenced, and an unambiguous declaration of solidarity — has carried a cost that will outlast this ceasefire. Whatever the intent, the effect was categorical: India has disqualified itself, in the eyes of Tehran and much of the Arab world, as a genuinely neutral player in West Asian affairs. Re-engaging Tehran meaningfully, while maintaining its Gulf partnerships, will require a calibrated and sustained effort — one that demonstrates, through action

... region's most consequential diplomatic moments unfold from the spectator's gallery.

... Pakistan's gains are context-specific and do not erase India's structural weight in the region. India's longstanding partnerships with Saudi Arabia, the UAE, and other Gulf Cooperation Council States — rooted in trade, investment, and security ties — remain intact. The question is whether New Delhi will leverage them.

With formal talks opening today, India has its most immediate opportunity to insert itself into a negotiation that will shape West Asia for a generation. New Delhi should intensify engagement with Oman to shape the Hormuz monitoring protocol and ensure transit fees do not disproportionately burden Indian commerce. India should also offer to channel post-war reconstruction financing through the Chabahar corridor — converting an infrastructure project into genuine political capital. And India must leverage its growing naval capabilities within frameworks such as the Quad to position itself visibly as a net security provider, not a passive beneficiary.

More fundamentally, this moment

... foreign policy tradition. India has always drawn strength from strategic autonomy — the ability to engage all parties, speak to all sides, and be trusted across divides. The task now is to activate it. India, with its incomparable economic, demographic, and civilisational stakes in West Asia than most other countries, is uniquely positioned to do so. The Hormuz crisis has not closed that door; it has, if anything, clarified precisely what kind of diplomatic engagement the moment demands.

The 2026 Iran crisis's opening chapter has produced a clear geopolitical scorecard: China repositioned as global peacemaker, Pakistan rehabilitated as regional mediator and Iran monetising the world's most critical waterway. For India, the ceasefire has bought two weeks. The strategic choices made within them will define its regional standing for years to come.

Asuf Sayeed is the former secretary in the ministry of external affairs and former ambassador of India to Saudi Arabia and Yemen. The views expressed are personal

### [ VITAL SIGNS ]

Ramanan Laxminarayan



## India needs a national development corps

Every recruitment cycle in India sees tens of thousands of public posts attract millions of applicants. The fact that even a posting for the position of office peon in the public sector draws tens of thousands of highly educated candidates indicates that in today's jobs environment, stable entry points into employment are scarce.

Although India is one of the youngest major economies in the world, youth unemployment, particularly in urban areas, remains elevated. According to the Periodic Labour Force Survey 2022-23, unemployment among Indians aged 15-29 remains around 10-12% nationally, with significantly higher rates in urban areas and among graduates. Degree holders are far more likely to be unemployed than those with less education, reflecting persistent skill mismatches. At the same time, hiring in the IT and business-process sector has slowed as firms adopt Artificial Intelligence tools that automate coding, testing, and back-office functions, reducing traditional entry-level opportunities. Hiring trends in western economies indicate that these opportunities may be more difficult to access going forward.

Across history and countries, sustained youth unemployment has often been associated with higher levels of social unrest and political volatility. At the same time, India faces immense unfinished work in health, education, and agriculture, which need energy, ideas and motivation. A National Development Corps may be the solution.

Every young Indian, after completing high school, would undertake a mandatory one-year national service programme. Completion would become a recognised credential, and would be a requirement for public employment, apprenticeships, university admissions or competitive examinations. Participation would be universal, and would place corps members in mixed teams drawn across caste, religion, gender, and district lines. The mission would be to strengthen health systems, improve educational outcomes, and support agricultural modernisation, all the while providing useful jobs training.

India has tried youth engagement before with limited success. The National Service Scheme mobilises college students for community service, but participation is voluntary and largely restricted to short-term camps. The National Cadet Corps builds discipline and leadership, but it is voluntary and defence-oriented. More recent initiatives, including short-term military recruitment under Agneepath, are not universal and are not structured as development programmes. None of these are mandatory, nor do they serve as a shared civic rite of passage. Most importantly, none serve as a pre-requisite for higher education or broad employment opportunities.

Other countries have used mandatory service to good effect. Singapore and Israel require military service, which has reinforced shared experience and national cohesion. India's greatest battles, however, are against poverty, preventable disease, educational disadvantage, environmental stress, and the consequences of the climate crisis. A development corps would mobilise youth

toward these priorities.

In health, the corps could assist with non-communicable disease screenings, immunisation follow-up, tuberculosis treatment adherence support, nutrition outreach, and digitisation of primary health records. In education, they could support remedial literacy and numeracy programs, after-school tutoring, and digital learning labs. In agriculture, they could assist with soil testing, watershed management, farmer-producer organisation logistics, climate-resilient practices, and reduction of post-harvest losses.

The fiscal arithmetic is manageable. At a budget of ₹40,000 per participant which would include a modest stipend for a cohort of roughly 26 million youth, the annual outlay would be about ₹5 one lakh crore, which is roughly 0.3% of GDP and just about 2% of Union government expenditure. For a programme that simultaneously addresses unemployment and strengthens human capital and national cohesion, this is a strategic investment.

Critics will argue that compulsory service amounts to social engineering, and that concern should be taken seriously. The corps must absolutely not be ideological and cannot be an instrument of any political party or cultural agenda.

Its mandate should be limited to development outcomes that require broad consensus — better health, stronger schools, resilient agriculture, climate adaptation. Governance should be statutory and non-partisan, with representation across states and political lines. Transparent district dashboards should report outputs publicly. The programme should be insulated from electoral cycles.

If every young Indian serves regardless of background, and if service tangibly improves both communities and future prospects, the programme will be seen as an investment rather than a financial burden. More importantly, a shared year of structured service would reshape social networks at a formative age. Young Indians from different regions, religions, and caste backgrounds would work together toward common goals. Collaboration reduces stereotypes more effectively than rhetoric. Economic progress depends not only on capital and technology but also on trust, which will grow through shared effort.

India's demographic dividend can well become its Achilles' heel and lead to significant unrest if not managed carefully. A young population can accelerate growth or strain institutions depending on whether credible pathways to purpose exist. Economic expansion alone cannot guarantee cohesion if employment opportunities lag behind expectations. A National Development Corps would signal that youth are central to national transformation. It would recognise that the most important war India must win is against poverty, ill health, educational disadvantage, and environmental vulnerability. It would make national service a bridge to opportunity. To be a developed India by 2047, we must first build the generation who can bring about that change.

Ramanan Laxminarayan is president, One Health Trust. The views expressed are personal

### [ GIORGIA MELONI | PRIME MINISTER, ITALY ]

What we call the West, stands on two legs — the European and the North American leg. If the two legs do not move in the same direction, the West is doomed to paralysis

On the need for US-EU cooperation in NATO



## A critique of the judiciary & a disproportionate response

It is not often that middle-school civics sparks judicial controversy. The recent banning of a civics textbook by the Supreme Court, however, has snowballed from a school lesson into a question of judicial authority and institutional temperament.

The facts are, by now, well known. The Supreme Court took suo motu cognisance of a chapter in a class VIII NCERT textbook titled *The Rule of the Judiciary in Our Society*. The chapter presents the judiciary as a pillar of democracy, situates it constitutionally and outlines its role as protector of citizens' rights. At the same time, it acknowledges widely recognised challenges — pendency of cases, shortage of judges, and possibility of corruption within the system. It is this reference to institutional challenges that drew the Supreme Court's ire.

Still, the episode would likely have passed as a minor skirmish had the Court's response been proportionate. To the extent the chapter is criticised for bias, omission or substantiation, a reasoned critique and a directive for revision would have been sufficient. Instead, the Supreme Court responded with unprecedented force. Its remarks invoked malicious intent, spoke of the judiciary "bleeding," and warned that "heads must roll." It demanded the names of authors, initiated contempt proceedings, and went so far as to direct that three academics be blacklisted from publicly funded curriculum work. A blanket ban was imposed on the textbook, and immediate seizure of all existing copies was ordered. NCERT's apology, too, was not accepted. It was an unusually muscular response to a schoolbook.

The existence of a statutory provision that permits such an exercise of power is contestable. But equally urgent is the question of what such action communicates. When courts display disproportionate fury, it creates immediate ripple effects. Even when unintended, they mirror the very executive overreach that they are meant to check. Academics, universities and citizens self-censor out of fear. Disagreement and dissent are stifled. In one instance, a law student who wrote a blog post critiquing the judiciary was asked by his university to delete it. That he did not oblige was the young man's exercise of his democratic right — and to his credit. The fact that such a request was made at all reveals the climate such interventions create.

Ironically, a careful reading of the chapter does reveal one genuinely objectionable element. But it lies elsewhere. It is in the odd and unnecessary inclusion of Hindu mythological references used to illustrate constitutional ideas.

In a plural, secular republic, weaving religious narratives into State-sanctioned education corrodes the very wall that the Constitution erects between faith and State. If anything, this is what clashes with constitutional values. Yet, curiously, this breach has barely raised an eyebrow.

Emphasis on some former judges over others, for instance, skews what ought to be an even-handed introduction to constitutional function. The side-trip into a judgment on Sanskrit education is as puzzling as is the elevation of environmental law over core foundational doctrines. These are all editorial misfires that demand serious revision.

But critique of the chapter need not come at the expense of the court's dignity, the NCERT, or the fundamental rights of its authors. Judicial authority, painstakingly built over decades of principled restraint and legal rigour, is earned not by the weight of its hand, but by the steadiness of its balance. Its exercise must be measured and aimed at correction, not intimidation.

For if even the highest court speaks the language of intimidation, as the State often does, to whom, then, shall the citizen turn? The law may be written in ink, but its weight is written in trust.

As the court now examines affidavits filed by the blacklisted academics in which they state that the chapter employed standard critical pedagogy, was a collective work with no single author, and subjected to rigorous review before finalisation, it must proceed in a way that preserves both justice and public trust.

The chapter's flaws too, must be examined in their entirety. Whether the Court can act in this way is a question for constitutional lawyers. Whether it should, is a question for everyone else.

Insiyah Vahanvay is a socio-political commentator and author of *The Fearless Judge*. Ashish Bharadwaj is co-dean at BHS Pilani and Jindal Global University. The views expressed are personal



Insiyah Vahanvay



Ashish Bharadwaj

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# Hormuz traffic at standstill as Iran controls movement

Reuters  
letters@hindustantimes.com

**LONDON/MOSCOW:** Ship traffic through the Strait of Hormuz stood at well below 10% of normal volumes on Thursday despite a US-Iran ceasefire as Tehran asserted its control by warning ships to keep to its territorial waters while doing so.

Hundreds of tankers and other ships have been stuck inside the Gulf since the Iran war began on February 28, cutting global oil supply by 20% in the world's biggest energy supply disruption.

Prices for some physical oil grades hit fresh all-time highs on Thursday as the crisis showed little signs of abating.

US Vice President JD Vance said there were signs that Hormuz is starting to reopen but the boss of the UAE's largest oil producer said Thursday it remains effectively shut.

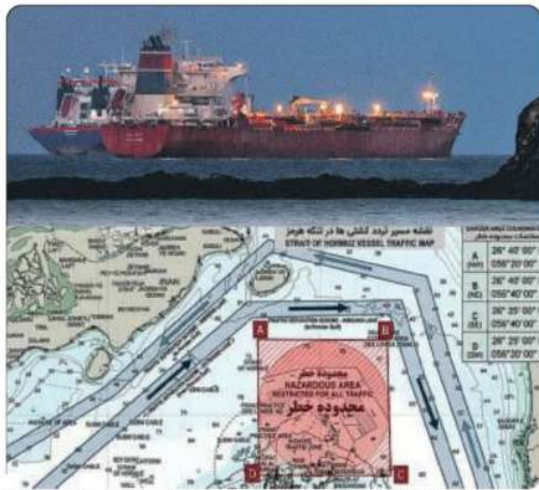
"Let's be clear: the Strait of Hormuz is not open," Sultan Al Jaber, chief executive officer of Abu Dhabi National Oil Co., said in comments on LinkedIn. "Access is being restricted, conditioned and controlled."

Just seven ships had passed through the strait in the past 24 hours versus about 140 normally, ship-tracking data showed.

They included one oil products tanker and six dry bulk carriers, data from Kpler, Lloyd's List Intelligence and Signal Ocean showed.

A chemical tanker was set to cross destined for India, ship-tracking data on the MarineTraffic and Pole Star Global platform forms showed. "Most shipping lanes are likely to remain cautious, and two weeks will not be enough to clear the backlog even if there is a marked increase in traffic," said Torbjorn Solvold at risk intelligence company Verisk Maplecroft.

Iran's Islamic Revolutionary Guard Corps (IRGC) have told vessels to sail through Iranian waters around Larak Island to avoid the risk of naval mines in the usual lanes through the strait, Iran's semi-official Tas-



Iran has issued a map announcing new routes for ships travelling through the Strait of Hormuz, citing the risk of sea mines in the main zone of the waterway.

nim news agency reported on Thursday. Vessels are to enter the strait north of Larak Island and exit just south of it until further notice in coordination with the IRGC's navy, Tasnim quoted the IRGC as saying.

Risks persist for ships not authorised by Iran, particularly those affiliated with Israel and the US, British maritime security company Ambrey said in an advisory. "Even shipping with apparent approval has been turned back in recent weeks mid-transit," it said.

## Toll payments in cryptocurrency

Media reports have suggested that Iran might want to change a toll for ships passing through, some pinning the figure at \$2 million, and ship-tracking data has shown some vessels are already taking the unusual

route around Larak Island. Indian-flagged Pine Gas LPG tanker recently took the unusual route around the Larak Island to exit the Gulf. The company did not pay Iran a toll to transit and the vessel was not boarded by IRGC, its chief officer, Sohan Lal, told Reuters.

The UN's shipping agency, the International Maritime Organization (IMO), said there was no international agreement where tolls can be introduced for transiting international straits. Any such toll will set a dangerous precedent, a spokesperson with the UN's International Maritime Organization said. IMO countries adopted the UN Convention on the Law of the Seas, or UNCLOS, which outlines the

rules that govern straits used for international navigation. "According to UNCLOS, ships enjoy the right of transit passage through international straits. States bordering straits shall not hamper that right or suspend the transit passage," the IMO spokesperson said.

Iran will demand toll payments in cryptocurrency to retain control over Hormuz during the two-week ceasefire, the Financial Times newspaper quoted Hamid Hosseini, a spokesperson for Iran's Oil, Gas and Petrochemical Products Exporters' Union, as saying on Wednesday.

Mitsui O.S.K. Lines, one of Japan's big three shipping firms, has managed to bring three tankers out of the strait in recent days. The company is awaiting guidance from the Japanese government on how to

## First non-Iranian tanker transits strait since truce, heads to India

**PARIS:** The first non-Iranian oil tanker passed through the Strait of Hormuz on Thursday since a fragile ceasefire between Iran and the United States was announced, according to the MarineTraffic monitor.

The MSG, a Gabon-flagged oil tanker passed went through the strategic waterway on Thursday loaded with around 7,000 tonnes of Emirati fuel oil, and is headed to Aegis Pipavav, India, according to MarineTraffic.

Around a fifth of global crude oil and liquefied natural gas (LNG) passes through the waterway in peacetime.

AGENCE FRANCE-PRESSE

proceed under the two-week ceasefire, its president and CEO, Jotaro Tamura, told Reuters.

India has granted waivers to allow two Iranian cargo ships aboard an older tanker and another under sanctions to enter its ports, two officials familiar said on Thursday.

They included one loaded with liquefied petroleum gas (LPG) used for cooking. India is facing its worst gas crisis in decades and has introduced rationing to ensure households are supplied.

**No more than 15 vessels a day to pass through strait**  
Iran will allow no more than 15 vessels a day to pass through the Strait of Hormuz under the ceasefire agreement it agreed with the United States, Russia's state TASS news agency quoted an unnamed senior Iranian source as saying on Thursday.

With inputs from Bloomberg

# US asks its allies to pitch plans to secure Hormuz

Bloomberg  
letters@hindustantimes.com

**WASHINGTON:** The US wants specific commitments from European allies on their pledge to help secure the Strait of Hormuz after the fighting in Iran stops, requesting that the countries present concrete plans to ensure navigation through the waterway within days, according to a senior NATO official.

The request was presented during discussions between American and NATO officials at the White House — where President Donald Trump met with North Atlantic Treaty Organization secretary general Mark Rutte — as well as at the Pentagon and State Department, according to the official.

A UK-led coalition of more than 40 countries, which includes many European nations, Japan and Canada, has pledged to help re-open the Strait of Hormuz, through which about 20% of the world's oil and natural gas flows, after active combat in the Middle East stops. The closing of the strait has sent global energy prices soaring and raised concerns about imminent fuel shortages.

Trump, Iran and Israel announced a fragile, 14-day ceasefire agreement on Tuesday, contingent upon the cessation of attacks and the reopening of the strategic waterway. About a dozen mostly European leaders issued a statement following the accord promising they would "contribute to ensuring freedom of navigation in the Strait of Hormuz."

However, strikes from Iran and Israel have continued and the Strait of Hormuz has remained effectively closed since the announcement. Tehran has said Israel's attacks on its oil infrastructure and the Iran-backed Hezbollah militia in Lebanon constituted a violation of the ceasefire agreement.

That raises questions about whether the latest request from the US will spur members of the coalition to present plans quickly and whether they consider the US timeline of a



Donald Trump

few days realistic.

Assistance from Nato members — or lack thereof — in the Iran conflict has led to acrimony between Trump and allies in recent weeks. Some member states declined to let the US use military bases to carry out strikes on Iran and refused the American president's calls to help reopen the Strait of Hormuz as long as fighting was ongoing.

Following the meeting with Rutte on Wednesday, Trump posted on social media that "NATO WASN'T THERE WHEN WE NEEDED THEM. AND THEY WON'T BE THERE IF WE NEEDED THEM AGAIN."

## 'Nato moving on from dependence on US'

Rutte said Nato was moving from Europe having an "unhealthy co-dependence" on the US towards a "transatlantic alliance grounded in true partnership" after Trump criticised the group over the Iran war.

Rutte made the comments on Thursday in an address at the Ronald Reagan Institute in Washington, on a visit designed to soothe tensions with the Trump administration after Nato allies initially resisted US promises to help out the war against Iran and reopening the Strait of Hormuz.

"I have developed an unflinching appreciation for the value of American leadership," Rutte said. "But I have also had the opportunity to reflect on what happens when America's allies take that leadership — US leadership — for granted."

# Israeli PM's graft trial set to resume on Sunday

**JERUSALEM:** Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu's long-running corruption trial will resume on Sunday, the court's spokesperson said on Thursday, hours after Israel lifted a state of emergency imposed over its war with Iran.

"With the lifting of the state of emergency and the return of the judicial system to work, hearings will resume as usual," a statement from the Israeli courts said, adding that they would take place between Sundays and Wednesdays.

Netanyahu, the first sitting Israeli prime minister to be charged with a crime, denies charges of bribery, fraud and breach of trust brought in 2019 after years of investigations. His trial, which began in 2020 and could lead to jail terms, has been repeatedly delayed due to his official commitments, with no end date in sight.

US President Donald Trump



Benjamin Netanyahu

has echoed Netanyahu's calls for Israel's President Isaac Herzog for a pardon, citing the impact of regular court appearances on his ability to carry out his duties. Herzog's office has said the justice ministry's pardons department would gather opinions to submit to the president's legal adviser, who will formulate a recommendation, as per standard practice. Pardons are not usually given mid-trial.

REUTERS

# Xi helps Trump as China assists with Iran ceasefire bid

Bloomberg  
letters@hindustantimes.com

**WASHINGTON:** As Donald Trump neared his self-imposed deadline to extinguish Iran's "entire civilisation," it became apparent one country had enough clout to convince Tehran to deescalate: America's biggest rival, China.

In the hours after a ceasefire publicly brokered by Pakistan was announced, Iranian officials reportedly credited a last-minute push by China with securing their acceptance, a claim soon after validated by Trump.

Pakistani Prime Minister Shehbaz Sharif thanked China for its support, while the White House said Beijing's role in the truce took place at the "top levels" of the US and Chinese governments.

China has not confirmed — or denied — reports of its pivotal part in brokering the detente, and President Xi Jinping still hasn't publicly commented on the fact that he's choked a fifth of global

oil supply. But the decision to step in reflects Beijing's ability to straddle strong ties with Iran, Gulf nations and Trump, and marks a departure from China's long-held preference of staying on the sidelines.

The shift came down to economics, as the conflict risked disrupting China's energy supplies and economy, said Zengyuan Zou, senior fellow for China studies at the Council on Foreign Relations. Data due next week is expected to show a slowdown in industrial output and exports in the month after the US and Israel triggered the war.

"China acted because the war in Iran was directly threatening the economic conditions it depends on for growth and political stability at home," Liu said. "Trump publicly crediting China is precisely the kind of political capital Beijing wanted ahead of a rescheduled summit."

A pause to the fighting would smooth Trump's visit to Beijing next month, with China's role



Smoke rises from the site of a US-Israeli strike on the Iranian capital Tehran on Tuesday.

leaving the US leader in debt to his Chinese counterpart. Trump is already heading to Beijing with his punitive tariffs struck down by the Supreme Court, and with the US military presence in Asia diminished by resources diverted to the Middle East.

For Beijing, however, wading into negotiations over a war with no easy resolution carries risks, even if that action is limited to behind-the-scenes pressure on a friend reliant on Beijing's support. China is Iran's largest trading

partner and the primary buyer of its oil.

Underlining the risks, Pakistani officials reportedly told the Guardian that while Islamabad acted as mediator in recent talks, China functioned as "guarantor", promising Iranian officials they wouldn't be assassinated during any future negotiations. It's unclear how Beijing would offer such an assurance, or the motivation for doing so given the repercussions should something then go wrong.

When asked about the report, Chinese foreign ministry spokesperson Mao Ning sidestepped the question at a regular briefing on Thursday, saying China "always advocates an early end to hostilities and resolve differences through diplomatic and political means to restore stability and peace in the Middle East."

For years, Xi has brushed off appeals from Western leaders to use his friendship with Vladimir Putin to help end the war in Ukraine. Instead supplying Moscow with diplomatic and economic support as he bolstered a key partner in opposing the US-led world order.

While China did burnish its credentials by presiding over a detente between Saudi Arabia and Iran in 2023, it's unclear how big Beijing's role was in reaching that deal.

Other mediation efforts have been confined to conflicts on China's doorstep, such as in Myanmar where officials have played a key role in brokering

ceasefire talks for the regime or, more recently, hosting seven days of peace talks between Afghanistan and Pakistan. That move could help calm tensions in Islamabad ahead of the first round of planned Iranian talks in the Pakistani capital on Saturday, with Vice President JD Vance leading the American delegation.

Bringing Iran to the negotiation table, however, is only the first step to end hostilities. Tehran is seeking security guarantees that won't be attacked a senior fellow at the Carnegie Endowment for International Peace. "Such commitments would run counter to its longstanding aversion to military risk — especially where confrontation with the United States is conceivable."

## CoreWeave signs \$21bn AI cloud deal with Meta

**WASHINGTON:** CoreWeave said on Thursday it has entered into an expanded agreement to provide Meta Platforms with \$21bn in cloud capacity, as the social media giant scales its infrastructure to support increasingly complex AI workloads.

**Russia returns bodies of 1,000 soldiers to Ukraine**  
**KYIV:** Moscow on Thursday handed over the remains of 1,000 soldiers to Ukraine, a source in Russia's

# Nepal PM sacks labour minister for misusing position to benefit wife

Press Trust of India  
letters@hindustantimes.com

**KATHMANDU:** Prime Minister Balendra Shah on Thursday sacked a minister for misusing the post to benefit his wife, 15 days after he took charge of the office. Minister for Labour, Employment and Social Security Dip Kumar Sah has been relieved from his post on Thursday at the recommendation from the ruling Rastriya Swatantra Party (RSP), according to the Prime Minister's secretary. RSP president Rabi Lamichhane had recommended Shah to take action against Sah for

## Arrest warrant issued against ex-PM Deuba

Nepal has issued an arrest warrant against former prime minister Sher Bahadur Deuba for alleged corruption, officials said on Thursday. Deuba, 79, is abroad for medical treatment and said that "an investigation on money laundering has been initiated against me and my family". Authorities also issued a warrant for Deuba's wife, former foreign minister Arzu Rana Deuba, court officials said. Meanwhile, ex-prime minister KP Sharma Oli and former interior minister Ramesh Lekhak have been released from

## 'KETAMINE QUEEN' JAILED FOR 15 YRS OVER MATTHEW PERRY DRUGS

**LOS ANGELES:** A British-American dealer dubbed the "Ketamine Queen" who sold the drugs that killed "Friends" star Matthew Perry, and boosted she supplied an elite circle of Hollywood VIPs, was jailed for 15 years on Wednesday. Jaseven Sangha, 42, was one of five people charged over the death of the beloved Canadian-American actor, who was found unresponsive in the hot tub of his luxury Los Angeles home in 2023. Sangha, a dual citizen of the US and Britain, ran a drugs emporium from her swanky apartment in Los Angeles, from where she dished out narcotics to wealthy customers in America's entertainment capital.

## CLIMATE CHANGE | IUCN RED LIST

# Emperor penguins now endangered as ice in Antarctica breaks up fast

Agence France-Presse  
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**PARIS:** The emperor penguin has been declared an endangered species as climate change pushes the ice of Antarctica a step closer to extinction, the global authority on threatened wildlife announced on Thursday.

Its change of status from "near threatened" to "endangered", made by the International Union for Conservation of Nature (IUCN), underscores the existential threat for ice-dependent species as global warming profoundly reshapes the frozen continent.

Emperor penguins rely on sta-



Emperor penguins and a chick at Halley Research Station on Antarctica.

population by the 2080s.

They "concluded that human-induced climate change poses the most significant threat to emperor penguins", Philip Trathan, part of the IUCN expert group who worked on the Red List assessment, said in a statement.

The Red List of Threatened Species is maintained by the IUCN and is the global reference on the extinction status of plants, animals and fungi.

There are six classifications from "least concern" to "extinct". Emperor penguins now rank two steps below "extinction in the wild" — a species surviving in captivity only, and not in nature.

## PAKISTANI CITIZEN PLEADS GUILTY IN US TERRORISM PLOT

Anirudh Bhattacharyya  
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**TORONTO:** A Pakistani citizen, who had been in Canada as a student, pleaded guilty in an American court on Wednesday for plotting to attack the US Capitol in 2021. The man, who has been the "largest attack on US soil since 9/11".

A statement released by the US justice department on Wednesday said that Muhammad Shahzeb Khan, also known as Shahzeb Jadoon, "pleaded guilty to attempting to commit acts of terrorism transcending national boundaries", and for attempting to enter the US and carry out a mass shooting with automatic weapons at a prominent Jewish center in Brooklyn, New York. Khan is scheduled to



negotiating delegation told reporters, with Kyiv returning the bodies of 41 dead Russian troops. **AFP**

misusing dignity of position by being involved in re-appointment of his wife as a member of the Health Insurance Board after her tenure had expired, it said.

custody after questioning for their alleged role in a deadly 2025 crackdown on protesters, police said on Thursday.

With inputs from AFP

"To cultivate her business, (Sangha) marketed herself as an exclusive dealer who catered to high-profile Hollywood clientele," prosecutors wrote in sentencing papers. **AFP**

the sea ice—essential platforms of frozen ocean water—to live, hunt and breed. Their numbers have plummeted as warming driven by greenhouse gas emissions has

in the year. The IUCN—a global network of scientists, governments and conservation groups—said changes in sea ice were expected to halve the emperor penguin

The Antarctic fur seal—once hunted to near extinction for their pelts—was also moved to 'endangered,' their numbers having dropped more than 50% since 1999.

be sentenced on August 12. Canadian police arrested Khan in September 2024 and extradited to the US. According to a complaint, he also discussed "coordinated attacks" in India.

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# Hindustan Times

## BUSINESS

Powered by **mint**

NEW DELHI  
FRIDAY  
APRIL 10, 2026

## TCS beats Street, but ends FY26 with first revenue fall

Weak India business drags revenue; company expects better show this fiscal

**Jan Bardia**  
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**BENGALURU:** Tata Consultancy Services (TCS) closed fiscal year 2026 (FY26) with a modest recovery in quarterly growth, but not enough to offset a broader slowdown that pushed it into its first full-year revenue decline in dollar terms since listing.

The results underscore a shifting demand environment, where macro uncertainty and the early impact of artificial intelligence (AI) are beginning to weigh on the information technology (IT) services giant's traditional growth model, even as the company expects a gradual recovery in FY27.

On Thursday, TCS reported a 0.5% decline in full-year revenue in dollar terms to \$30.08 billion, alongside a 3.5% rise in net profit. In the fourth quarter, revenue grew 1.5% sequentially to \$7.62 billion, indicating a mild pickup in momentum toward the end of the year. Much of the annual decline was driven by weakness in its India



Much of the annual decline was led by weakness in the company's India business, whose revenue fell 3.2% during the period. **MNT**

business, whose revenue fell 3.2% during the period. In rupee terms, revenue trends differed due to currency movements. Fourth quarter revenue registered a 5.4% sequential rise to ₹70,698 crore and full-year revenue rose 4.6% to ₹2,67,021 crore.

The company's management struck an optimistic note on the outlook for FY27, amid heightened macro volatility, particularly due to the West Asia conflict.

K. Krithivasan, chief executive of TCS, said during the post-earnings analyst call on Thursday that despite global uncertainty, the company continues to see strong client engagement

and long-term deal commitments, positioning it for improved performance in the coming year.

To be sure, the fall in full-year revenue was anticipated by experts, with TCS's final number beating a Bloomberg estimate of 46 analysts of \$28.55 billion.

"Results are in line with expectations; a revenue decline was baked in last year itself," said Sushovan Nayak, lead IT analyst at Anand Rath Institute of Equities.

On AI, TCS said that while customers want to accelerate adoption, clients lack AI-readiness. "We're working with our customers to address this gap

by upgrading their infrastructure to be scalable and secure, modernizing their core applications and setting up modern data foundations," said Aarth Subramanian, chief operating officer of TCS, during the company's analyst call. "A significant part of the technology spend is being invested in these areas."

A second expert said TCS's revenue decline indicates that AI is testing the IT services industry's core model.

"Clients are no longer buying effort, they are demanding output," said Phil Fersht, chief executive of HPS Research.

Net profit for the full year jumped 3.5% to \$5.94 billion. This came despite \$157 million in severance-related payments to employees who were let go and also a one-time impact from labour codes, which will raise gratuity payments to employees.

Another silver lining was the company's increase in large clients fetching upwards of \$100 million annually, which rose by two last fiscal to 66.

The increase in margins came with a decrease in headcount. TCS ended last fiscal with 584,519 employees, down by 23,460 from the year ago. Much of this can be attributed to its largest layoff drive last year.

## EVs begin to move the needle for auto industry

**Ayaan Kartik**  
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**NEW DELHI:** Aggressive electric vehicle (EV) plays by Mahindra & Mahindra (M&M) and Tata Motors Passenger Vehicles Ltd played a big role in EVs making up a fifth of the over 540,000 additional vehicles sold in fiscal year 2026 (FY26), data from the Federation of Automobile Dealers Associations (FADA) showed. That number was 8% in the previous fiscal year.

The two companies together accounted for 61% of India's electric car market in FY26, helping them power past second-placed Hyundai Motor in India's passenger vehicle (PV) pecking order (Maruti Suzuki is No. 1).

According to data from FADA, overall car retail sales grew 13% to 4.7 million units in FY26, while EV sales increased 84% to 199,923 units in the same period, contributing 4% to the overall market.

EVs have also contributed handsomely to the top carmakers' incremental growth last fiscal. FADA data showed that M&M's overall sales jumped 22% year-on-year (y-o-y) in FY26 to 631,638 units, within which EVs have grown at an outsized 407% y-o-y to 42,721 units, and contributed 30% to the company's incremental sales growth.

Meanwhile, Tata Motors PV's retail sales rose 14% y-o-y to 613,513 units in FY26, even as its EVs showed a growth rate of 36%



M&M and Tata Motors accounted for 61% of India's electric car market in FY26. **MNT**

y-o-y to 78,811 units. Significantly, EVs contributed about 26% to the company's incremental growth. Strip out EVs, and growth rates drop to 17% and 12% for M&M and Tata Motors PV, respectively.

Hyundai Motor, which ended the fiscal year below No. 2 (at No. 4) for the first time in 17 years, grew at just 3% to 578,337 units in FY26, even as its EV sales grew at a healthy 137.6% to 5,885 units. However, Hyundai's EVs contributed a lower 14% to its incremental sales, compared to the other two companies.

To be sure, EVs are not the sole driver of growth—M&M's strong SUV portfolio, for instance, continues to underpin its performance. But electrification is increasingly amplifying gains for early movers.

"Over the past six years, we have built the widest portfolio of electric vehicles across every

major body style and price point, from hatchbacks to high SUVs, enabling the democratization of EVs," Vivek Srivastava, chief commercial officer, Tata Passenger Electric Mobility Ltd, said.

"EVs contribute 14-15% to our passenger vehicle portfolio, significantly ahead of the industry average of 4%, with customers driving more, travelling farther, and increasingly choosing EVs as their primary car, reflecting growing trust in the technology," he added.

M&M, Hyundai India and Maruti Suzuki did not respond to queries seeking comment on their EV sales and plans.

Subhabrata Sengupta, a partner at Avalon Consulting, noted that EV sales act as incremental sales boosters for some manufacturers, but the decision on whether to go on the technology is a strategic choice.

"It is a growing segment. Whether you play there or not is always a strategic choice. Toyota grew around 20% without an EV," Sengupta said.

So far, Maruti and Hyundai have not yet gone big on the segment. Maruti, which sold 1.86 million cars in FY26 at a growth rate of 11.4%, started selling EVs in India only in February, with just over 1,400 units registered.

As of now, it sells just one EV, the eVitara. Hyundai on the other hand, sells two EVs in India—Creta EV and Ioniq—even as it discontinued the Kona EV last June for want of demand.

## INDIA AMONG FASTEST-GROWING IN FY27 DESPITE WAR RISKS: WB

**Subash Narayan**  
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**NEW DELHI:** India is expected to remain among the world's fastest-growing major economies in 2026-27 despite headwinds from strong macroeconomic fundamentals, said Aarelien Kruse, lead economist for India at the World Bank (WB) on Thursday.

The country has built robust buffers, including adequate foreign exchange reserves, a predominantly domestically held public debt profile, a well-capitalized banking system, low inflation and a relatively low dependence on net energy imports as a share of gross domestic product (GDP), the senior World Bank economist said.

However, risks remain tilted to the downside. An extended period of geopolitical instability could keep global oil prices elevated for longer, potentially weighing on India's growth outlook. "While India's strong macroeconomic buffers offer some protection against downside risks, the conflict underscores the importance of energy diversification, prudent fiscal management and trade diversification," Kruse said while briefing the media on the bank's latest India Development Update released on Thursday.

The World Bank's South Asia chief economist, Franziska Ohnsgaard, said that even with a moderation in growth, India's economic momentum remains strong.

"Even with our projection of lower 6.6% growth for 2026-27, the country would remain among the fastest-growing economies globally. This reflects strong buffers and policies that continue to support growth while maintaining fiscal consolidation," she said.

In its latest South Asia Economic Update released on Wednesday, the World Bank projected India's economy to grow at 6.6% in 2026-27, slower than the estimated 7.6% expansion in 2025-26. The moderation reflects the impact of global uncertainties, particularly the US-Israel and Iran war.

## Vantara launches integrated wildlife university in Gujarat

**HT Correspondent**  
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**NEW DELHI:** Vantara, a wildlife rescue and conservation organisation founded by Reliance Industries executive director Anant Ambani, has announced the launch of the "world's first integrated global university" dedicated to wildlife conservation and veterinary sciences in Gujarat's Jamnagar.

Vantara University will offer undergraduate, postgraduate, fellowship, and specialised programmes across disciplines, such as wildlife medicine and surgery, nutrition, behavioural sciences, genetics, epidemiology, one health, conservation policy, and naturalistic animal care environment design, the organisation said in a release.

"Vantara University is rooted in animal welfare, scientific advancement, and the future of wildlife conservation. The institution aims to develop future leaders in veterinary medicine, conservation, and wildlife care. Its curriculum will utilise India's enduring knowledge traditions to shape a purpose-led and future-facing model of education," it said.

The university will also offer scholarships to support students from socially and economically marginalised backgrounds, it added.

"The future of conservation will depend on how we prepare minds and institutions to serve life with compassion, knowledge, and skill. Vantara University is shaped by a deeply personal journey of witnessing ani-



Anant Ambani, founder, Vantara. **HT**

imals in distress and recognising the need for greater capability in their care," the release quoted Anant Ambani as saying.

Vantara University, inspired by the ethos of the ancient Nalanda University, seeks to nurture a new generation committed to protecting every life, said Anant Ambani, the youngest son of Reliance Industries chairman and managing director Mukesh Ambani.

The university will be supported by advanced academic and clinical infrastructure, international collaborations, and a residential campus, the release said.

"Recognising that the future of conservation will be built in classrooms, laboratories, and human conscience, as well as in forests, the university aims to advance wildlife veterinary sciences and conservation education. It will simultaneously develop knowledge resources in wildlife health, animal care environment design, and conservation, serving as a long-term platform for education, research, and innovation," the release said.

## RBI proposes lagged credit, kill switch to curb fraud

**Press Trust of India**  
feedback@livehindustan.com

**MUMBAI:** To mitigate financial fraud, the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) on Thursday proposed lagged credit for authorised push payments and a control or kill switch for digital payments. It further proposed limiting aggregate credits in an account to help counter the problem created by mule accounts, and the designation of a trusted person to authenticate high-value transactions for citizens aged 70

years and above and persons with disabilities.

The central bank proposed these norms in a discussion paper released on Thursday amid a rise in fraudulent activities targeting customers. It announced the discussion paper as part of its statement on developmental and regulatory policies during the February monetary policy meeting.

The central bank has asked for feedback and comments on the discussion paper by May 8. National Cyber Crime Report-

ing Portal (NCRP) indicate that fraud related to digital payments is on the rise, with 28 lakh frauds reported in 2025, amounting to ₹23,311 crore, higher than the 2024 figure of ₹22,848 crore in 2024. 13,111 worth ₹7,465 crore in 2023, according to the discussion paper.

In the lagged credit for authorised push payments, the central bank proposed a short delay at the payer's end for transactions above ₹10,000.

Under this approach, once a

customer initiates a transaction exceeding ₹10,000, a lag period of one hour could be applied.

The lag can be applied at the payer's end, or at the payee's end, or both. During this period, the payer's bank would provisionally debit the customer's account, and the payer would retain the option to cancel the transaction for any reason.

The high-value transactions were proposed to fall under this ambit because transactions above ₹10,000 account for approximately 45% of reported

fraud cases by volume, but about 98.5% by value.

The central bank also proposed additional authentication by a trusted person for high-value digital transactions by vulnerable sections, such as citizens aged 70 years and above and persons with disabilities, and accounts to receive credits commensurate with the nature of the relationship with banks.

Kill-switch activation at the account level will override other controls/configurations set up by the account holder.

## Sensex, Nifty tumble after rally as ceasefire-led optimism cools

**Press Trust of India**  
feedback@livehindustan.com

**MUMBAI:** Equity benchmark indices ended lower on Thursday, with the Sensex tumbling 931 points after a spectacular rally in the previous session, as renewed tensions in West Asia reduced the ceasefire-led optimism.

The ceasefire deal appeared to be at risk after Iran closed the Strait of Hormuz again in response to Israeli attacks on Lebanon. Weak trends in Asian and European markets, a jump in crude oil prices and uninterrupted foreign fund outflows also made investors jittery in the domestic market.

The 30-share BSE Sensex dropped 931.25 points or 1.20% to settle at 76,631.90. The 50-share NSE Nifty declined 222.25 points or 0.93% to end at 23,775.10. From the 30-Sensex firms,



The Sensex dropped 1.20% to settle at 76,631.90, while Nifty declined 0.93% to 23,775.10. **HT**

InterGlobe Aviation, Larsen & Toubro, Eicher, HDFC Bank, ICICI Bank and Kotak Mahindra Bank were among the major losers.

Bluechip Electronics, Power Grid, NTPC and Tata Consultancy Services were among the gainers. Brent crude, the global oil benchmark, jumped 3.27% to \$97.85 per barrel.

In Asian markets, South Korea's benchmark Kospi, Japan's Nikkei 225 index, Shanghai's SSE Composite index and Hong Kong's Hang Seng index ended lower after a sharp rally in the previous trade.

European markets were quoting in the negative territory. "Ceasefire-led optimism faded as renewed US-Iran tensions and ongoing restrictions at the Strait of Hormuz pushed crude back up, reviving concerns around India's inflation. Domestically, profit-taking, rising 10-year bond yields, and rupee weakness reduced near-term risk appetite. Financials led the decline after the previous session's sharp rally amid sustained FII selling, while broader markets held relatively steady," Vinod Nair, head of research, Geojit Investments Limited, said. Foreign Institutional Investors (FIIs) offloaded equities worth ₹2,817 crore on Wednesday, according to exchange data.

### [ THE CROSSWORDS ]

#### CRYPTIC CLUES

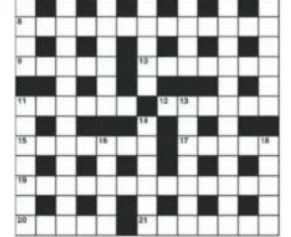
- ACROSS**
- 1 What a barbarian to trumpet a Scotsman! (7)
  - 2 Persuade casual worker to be on time (5)
  - 3 Prepare to put on a glove (3,4,2)
  - 4 Swift portrayal of a brutish fool (5)
  - 5 I earn it from doing very little (7)
  - 6 Beat back in time relatively speaking (6)
  - 7 Some islands are of Eastern origin (6)
  - 8 He's austere and sour about one point (7)
  - 9 Animal brings everything back to mother (6)
  - 10 New players in a rugby team (5-8)
  - 11 Be quiet and help with the dishwashing (3,2)
  - 12 Money fine can upset (7)

#### DOWN

- 1 He tries to score in it (5)
- 2 Drive and convey how a servant may act (5,3)
- 3 Do some evening work on board perhaps (4,3)
- 4 Doric pole used for some types of skiing (6)
- 5 Unearth a very small amount (5)
- 6 Various means are trained for the sea (13)
- 7 Is entered by shipping agent on order (7)
- 8 Made work play perhaps (7)
- 9 A new role in flight control (7)
- 10 He may not have washed the back of his neck (6)
- 11 Secure link (3-7)
- 12 A tissue of lies divides the church (5)

#### PUZZLE 17456

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#### QUICK CLUES

- ACROSS**
- 1 Mete out (7)
  - 2 Kin (5,3,5)
  - 3 Endanger (7)
  - 4 Jerk (6)
  - 5 Casapace (5)
  - 6 Actually there in person (2,5,4,4)
  - 7 Neatly (7)
  - 8 Dispute peacefully (7)
  - 9 Natural natural environment (7)
  - 10 Incline (4,2)
  - 11 Erect a wall (5)
  - 12 Easily digested (5)
- DOWN**
- 1 Put into circulation (5)
  - 2 Kin (5,3,5)
  - 3 Endanger (7)
  - 4 Jerk (6)
  - 5 Casapace (5)
  - 6 Actually there in person (2,5,4,4)
  - 7 Neatly (7)
  - 8 Dispute peacefully (7)
  - 9 Natural natural environment (7)
  - 10 Incline (4,2)
  - 11 Erect a wall (5)
  - 12 Easily digested (5)

## International aid flows saw record fall in 2025: OECD

**Sreedev Krishnakumar**  
letters@hindustantimes.com

**NEW DELHI:** International aid

Official development assistance disbursed by DAC countries

sub-Saharan Africa combined. "In recent years, members have increasingly relied on the multilateral system to support least

### YESTERDAY'S SOLUTIONS (17455)



### [ SUDOKU ]

DIFFICULTY LEVEL ★★★★★



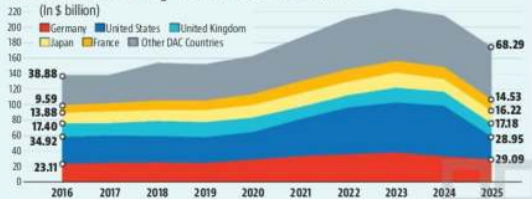
Fill in all the squares



from members and associates of the Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development's Development Assistance Committee (OECD DAC) — a grouping of major donor countries — fell 23.1% in 2025, the steepest annual decline on record in official development assistance (ODA), according to preliminary data released by the OECD on Thursday. ODA refers to concessional government aid aimed at promoting the economic development and welfare of poorer countries.

Official development assistance from DAC members and associates stood at \$174.3 billion in 2025, equivalent to 0.26% of their combined gross national income (GNI), down from \$214.6 billion, or 0.34% of GNI, in 2024. The contraction pushes ODA back to levels last seen in 2015 — the year the United Nations adopted its 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development.

## Disbursed by DAC countries



Germany became the largest provider of ODA in 2025 for the first time, disbursing \$29.1 billion and narrowly overtaking the United States at \$29 billion. The United Kingdom (\$17.2 billion), Japan (\$16.2 billion) and France (\$14.5 billion) rounded out the top five. For the first time, all five largest donors cut aid, together accounting for 95.7% of the overall decline. The

sharpest reduction came from the US, where aid fell 56.9% after Donald Trump returned to office in January 2025 and sharply curtailed foreign assistance. Meanwhile, 12 donor countries outside the DAC that reported development finance flows to the OECD increased their combined aid to \$13.3 billion in 2025, up 4.5% from 2024.

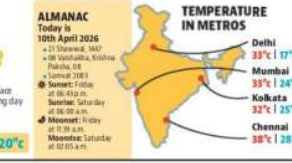
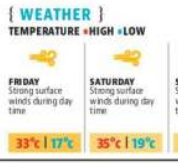
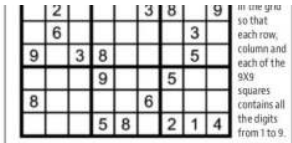
Bilateral aid flows to Ukraine fell 38.2% in 2025 to \$10.3 billion. However, including support channelled through European Union institutions, total aid to Ukraine rose 18.7% to \$44.9 billion — the highest volume of ODA ever directed to a single country. This exceeded the total bilateral aid DAC members provided either to all least developed countries or to all of

developed countries and offset cuts to bilateral aid. Final 2025 data, forthcoming in December 2026, will confirm if this trend is maintained," the OECD said in a statement.

At the same time, aid for core development programmes fell sharply. Bilateral ODA excluding in-donor refugee costs, humanitarian assistance and debt relief declined 26.3% in 2025 — the steepest drop on record — indicating that the cuts went well beyond more volatile components of aid budgets. Humanitarian aid fell 35.8%, while spending on in-donor refugee costs dropped 22.1%.

Drawing on a survey of DAC members and publicly available data, the OECD expects ODA to fall a further 5.8% in 2026 and, by 2028, to remain 6.6% below 2025 levels.

These projections do not account for the latest crisis in West Asia, which could further disrupt aid flows.



NEW DELHI  
FRIDAY  
APRIL 10, 2026

## Hindustan Times

17

**National Institute of Secondary Steel Technology (NISST)**  
GT Road, Sirhind Side, Mandi Gobindgarh  
Punjab-147301

**Ref. VACANCY NOTIFICATION NO. NISST/PA/PAERS/CON/2026-27/1**

Applications are invited for recruitment against the following position on contractual basis for a minimum period of three years (1+2) extendable by three more years. The engaged personnel will be on probation during the first year. Last date for submission of application - 15 days from the date of publication of notification in the Newspaper.

| S. No. | POST                                             | NO. OF VACANCIES | MAXIMUM REMUNERATION (Per Month) |
|--------|--------------------------------------------------|------------------|----------------------------------|
| 1.     | Technical Assistant to Director (TA to Director) | 01               | Rs. 50,000/-                     |
| 2.     | Accountant                                       | 01               | Rs. 44,000/-                     |
| 3.     | Laboratory Assistant                             | 01               | Rs. 17,000/-                     |
| 4.     | Multi-Tasking Staff (MTS)                        | 02               | Rs. 13,000/-                     |

For details refer our website [www.nisst.org](http://www.nisst.org)  
Sr. Dy. Director (F&A)/(P&A)

**HIGH COURT OF MADHYA PRADESH: JABALPUR**  
**/NOTICE INVITING E-TENDER/**

e-Tenders are invited by the High Court of Madhya Pradesh for the "Comprehensive Annual Maintenance Contract of CCTV Equipment" installed at District & Sessions Court, Ujjain & Katni in the State of Madhya Pradesh". The last date of online tender submission is **05th May, 2026 before 06.00 P.M.** (mandatory). The sealed tender complete in all respect addressed to "Registrar General, High Court of Madhya Pradesh, Jabalpur" must be submitted before **05.00 P.M. on 06th May, 2026 (mandatory)**. The technical bids of the tender shall be opened online on **07th May, 2026 at 11.30 A.M.** The detailed tender document is available in the official website of the High Court of Madhya Pradesh [www.mphc.gov.in](http://www.mphc.gov.in) and Government e-procurement portal [www.mptenders.gov.in](http://www.mptenders.gov.in).

G-11257/26 REGISTRAR GENERAL

**RAJENDRA INSTITUTE OF MEDICAL SCIENCES**  
(An Autonomous Institute under Govt. of Jharkhand) Ranchi-834009 (Jharkhand)  
Phone: 0651-2541533, Email: [rimsranchi@rediffmail.com](mailto:rimsranchi@rediffmail.com)

**NIT No. RIMS/Stores/ME (4)/ M.S. Office 1697 Dated 06-04-2026**  
**E-TENDER NOTICE FOR RADIO FREQUENCY ABLATOR (RFA), RIMS, RANCHI**

E-tenders are invited in two part (Technical & Financial Part) from the Competent/Eligible Agency/Manufacturer/Authorized Distributor for supply & installation of Radio Frequency Ablator (RFA) for department of Surgical Oncology at RIMS, Ranchi. The intended bidders may visit Govt. Tender Portal [www.jharkhandtenders.gov.in](http://www.jharkhandtenders.gov.in) for details.

**Bid End Date: 29-04-2026**

Sd/-  
Medical Superintendent  
Rajendra Institute of Medical Sciences  
Ranchi

PR.NO.377056 Rajendra Institute of Medical Sciences(26-27)-D

**Advertisement No. 41/2026**

**Government of India**  
**Public Enterprises Selection Board**

Invites applications for the post of  
**Director (Marketing)**  
In  
**Hindustan Petroleum Corporation Limited (HPCL)**

Last date of submission of application by the applicant is by 15:00 hours on **29/04/2026**

Last date of forwarding of applications by the Nodal officers to PESB is by 17:00 hours on **08/05/2026**

For details login to website <http://www.pesb.gov.in>

**ODISHA MINING CORPORATION LIMITED**  
OMC House, Bhubaneswar-751001, Odisha  
CIN:U13100OR1996SGC000313, [www.omcltd.in](http://www.omcltd.in)

**50001/5/2627**

**Advertisement Notice (18.04.2026 - 20th & 20th E-auction)**  
**IRON ORE CLO & FINES**

The Odisha Mining Corporation Ltd intends to sell various grades of Iron ore CLO & Fines produced at Dastar and Gandhamardan Regions (Block - A & B) and Guari, Jiling Langola, Tingrahar, Khandabandh, Banspani, Uchabasi (Manikgarh), Rouda C & Dubura, Sakachit Iron and Manganeese Mines of Baril Region in Keonjhar District and Khondabandh/Kumhar Mines under Koroa Region in Sundergarh District, Odisha through e-auction which will be conducted by MSTC Ltd. The e-auction shall be held from **11.00 A.M. to 2.00 P.M. on 18.04.2026**. "Traders shall not be allowed to participate in National e-Auction of Iron Ore CLO and Fines w.e.f. April, 2026 onwards."

For details, please visit the website of MSTC i.e. [www.mstcltd.com](http://www.mstcltd.com)

Chief General Manager (SAM)  
OIPR - 3001/13005/1/25-27/0026

**RAJENDRA INSTITUTE OF MEDICAL SCIENCES**  
(An Autonomous Institute under Govt. of Jharkhand) Ranchi-834009 (Jharkhand)  
Phone: 0651-2541533, Email: [rimsranchi@rediffmail.com](mailto:rimsranchi@rediffmail.com)

**NIT No. RIMS/Stores/ME(4)/ M.S. Office 1701 Dated 06-04-2026**  
**E-TENDER NOTICE FOR HEATER COOLER MACHINE IN CTVS DEPARTMENT, RIMS, RANCHI**

E-tenders are invited in two part (Technical & Financial Part) from the Competent/Eligible Agency/Manufacturer/Authorized Distributor for supply & installation of Heater Cooler Machine for department of CTVS at RIMS, Ranchi. The intended bidders may visit Govt. Tender Portal [www.jharkhandtenders.gov.in](http://www.jharkhandtenders.gov.in) for details.

**Bid end date: 04-05-2026**

Sd/-  
Medical Superintendent  
Rajendra Institute of Medical Sciences  
Ranchi

PR 377058 Rajendra Institute of Medical Sciences(26-27)-D

**VACANCIES**  
**ARMY PUBLIC SCHOOL**  
SHANKAR VIHAR DELHI CANT

**REQUIREMENT OF TEACHING & NON TEACHING STAFF ON ADHOC BASIS**

Army Public School, Shankar Vihar, Delhi Cantt invites applications from competent and experienced candidates for teaching & non teaching positions on adhoc basis. For details regarding vacancies, subjects, and eligibility criteria, please visit the school website: [www.apshankarvihar.ac.in](http://www.apshankarvihar.ac.in). Proficiency in English and working knowledge of computers is mandatory. Interested candidates may download the application form from the school website and submit the duly filled hard copy along with self-attested copies of all relevant certificates/testimonials by hand or by post to Army Public School, Shankar Vihar, Delhi Cantt - 110010.

The application must reach the school by **20 April 2026 (1400 hrs)** along with a Demand Draft of Rs 2500/- in favour of Army Public School, Shankar Vihar. Applications received after the due date, through email, or without the Demand Draft will not be entertained.

Only shortlisted candidates will be invited for the interview at APS Shankar Vihar. The interviews are scheduled to be held tentatively in the first week of May 2026.

The School management reserves the right to cancel the candidature of any or all applicants without assigning any reason.

For queries: 011-26153559, 011-26153559 School Management

**Office of the Director General, Medical & Health Services, Uttar Pradesh, Lucknow**  
E-mail: [ldadwasthyabhabhawani@gmail.com](mailto:ldadwasthyabhabhawani@gmail.com)

**Ref.No. 1/F/ Re-appointment/2026/692 Lucknow: Dated 06 / 04 /2026**

**PRESS NOTE**

Applications are invited from MBBS and Specialist retired doctors of PMHS cadre who have not completed 65 years for contractual appointment through reappointment in Medical & Health Services, Uttar Pradesh, along with extension for one year of MBBS and specialist doctors already working by DGMH order in previous year who have completed one year of reappointment in the month of April, 2026 and May, 2026.

For details of district wise vacancies (The number of vacancies may increase or decrease), eligibility and mode of on-line application, kindly visit the following website: <http://reappointment.dgmh.up.in>

Please note that the date for submission of on-line application is upto 30.04.2026 (Dr. Pawan Kumar Arun)  
Director General,

UP-349542, Dt. 09.04.2026  
Website : [www.upgovt.nic.in](http://www.upgovt.nic.in)

**Pharmaceuticals & Medical Devices Bureau of India (PMBI)**  
B-500, Tower-B, 5<sup>th</sup> Floor, World Trade Centre, Naurgi Nagar, New Delhi-110029  
Telephone: 011-49431800 | Website: [janaushadhi.gov.in](http://janaushadhi.gov.in)

**Extension of Last Date for Submission of Application for CEO (PMBI) POST**

In continuation of earlier notification for inviting applications to fill up the post of Chief Executive Officer (CEO) in the Pharmaceuticals and Medical Devices Bureau of India (PMBI), a Society under the aegis of Department of Pharmaceuticals, Government of India in Level-13 in the pay matrix (₹1,23,100 - 2,15,900), the last date of submission of application is hereby extended upto 25.04.2026.

Further details, including the terms and conditions of deputation and application procedure, are available on the website <https://janaushadhi.gov.in/>

Interested individuals, who are eligible, may apply through proper channel, as per the application procedure, to General Manager (F&A), Pharmaceuticals and Medical Devices Bureau of India, B-500, Tower-B, 5<sup>th</sup> Floor, World Trade Centre, Naurgi Nagar, New Delhi - 110029 and also send the same through email at [recruitment@janaushadhi.gov.in](mailto:recruitment@janaushadhi.gov.in)

General Manager (F&A)

**GOVERNMENT INSTITUTE OF MEDICAL SCIENCES**  
Greater Noida, Gautam Budh Nagar, UP-201316  
(An Autonomous Institute under Govt. of U.P.)  
Website: [www.gimsa.ac.in](http://www.gimsa.ac.in) | Email: [gimsa.helpdesk@gmail.com](mailto:gimsa.helpdesk@gmail.com)  
Phone: 0120-2341726, Helpline No. 91 989640811

**Adv. No. GIMS/2026/Manpower/NT-06 Date: 10.04.2026**

**Direct Recruitment:**

**Notification for Recruitment of Allied & Healthcare Professionals**

Online applications are invited from eligible Indian Nationals for filling up under non-tenured/contractual posts on regular basis at Government Institute of Medical Sciences (GIMS), Greater Noida to be conducted as Computer Based Test (CBT).

The online link for filling up the application form will be displayed on the Institute's website [www.gimsa.ac.in](http://www.gimsa.ac.in) under the 'Recruitment' section. Candidates are advised to visit the website regularly for detailed information regarding eligibility criteria, age limit, and selection process.

| S. No. | Category Name                  | Post Name             | Pay Scale               | UR | OB | SC | ST | EWS |
|--------|--------------------------------|-----------------------|-------------------------|----|----|----|----|-----|
| 1.     | Allied Healthcare Professional | Laboratory Technician | GP-2800 Basic Pay-29200 | 10 | 07 | 06 | 02 |     |
| 2.     | Allied Healthcare Professional | OT Technician         | GP-2800 Basic Pay-29200 | 10 | 08 | 05 | 02 |     |

**Notes:**

1. Detailed advertisement will be uploaded on the Institute's website [www.gimsa.ac.in](http://www.gimsa.ac.in).
2. Reservation: U.P. State Government reservation policy will be applicable. Horizontal reservation shall be applicable as per rules.
3. The number of vacant posts may increase or decrease at the discretion of the Institute.

**Office of The Executive Engineer**  
**M.P.P.W.D Division No. 1 Jabalpur**

**Tender Notice**

NIT NO. 45 of 2025-26/C. Jabalpur, Dated: 06.04.2026

Online percentage rate bids for the following works are invited from registered contractors and Firms of repute fulfilling registration criteria.

| S. No. | Tender no.                | Name of work                                                                                                   | Call No. | Cost of Project (PAC) (Rs. In lak) | Amount of EMD | Cost of tender form | Time                         |
|--------|---------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|------------------------------------|---------------|---------------------|------------------------------|
| 1.     | 2025_PWD/RB_492457_PACK 1 | BT Renewal work of Campus road at 1 MPWC Jip and Central jail Campus Jip                                       | 1st      | 32.40                              | 50000.00      | 5000.00             | 02 month (i.e. Rainy Season) |
| 2.     | 2025_PWD/RB_492458_PACK 1 | Maintenance of Various Road under P.W.D. On no. 1 Jabalpur                                                     | 1st      | 90.00                              | 90000.00      | 10000.00            | 06 month (i.e. Rainy Season) |
| 3.     | 2025_PWD/RB_492459_PACK 1 | Repairing of Bridge culvert shoulder repair and other repair work in Panagar Section under HQ sub dn no. 1 Jip | 1st      | 20.00                              | 40000.00      | 2000.00             | 04 month (i.e. Rainy Season) |
| 4.     | 2025_PWD/RB_492460_PACK 1 | Repairing of Bridge culvert shoulder repair and other repair work in Katangi Section under HQ sub dn no. 1 Jip | 1st      | 20.00                              | 40000.00      | 2000.00             | 04 month (i.e. Rainy Season) |
| 5.     | 2025_PWD/RB_492461_PACK 1 | Repairing of Bridge culvert shoulder repair and other repair work in Maholi Section under HQ sub dn no. 1 Jip  | 1st      | 20.00                              | 40000.00      | 2000.00             | 04 month (i.e. Rainy Season) |
| 6.     | 2025_PWD/RB_492462_PACK 1 | Repairing of Bridge culvert shoulder repair and other repair work in Panagar Section under HQ sub dn no. 1 Jip | 1st      | 20.00                              | 40000.00      | 2000.00             | 04 month (i.e. Rainy Season) |
| 7.     | 2025_PWD/RB_492464_PACK 1 | Repairing of Bridge culvert shoulder repair and other repair work in Katangi Section under HQ sub dn no. 1 Jip | 1st      | 18.50                              | 40000.00      | 2000.00             | 04 month (i.e. Rainy Season) |
| 8.     | 2025_PWD/RB_492465_PACK 1 | Repairing of Bridge culvert shoulder repair and other repair work in Maholi Section under HQ sub dn no. 1 Jip  | 1st      | 18.65                              | 40000.00      | 2000.00             | 04 month (i.e. Rainy Season) |

**यमुना एक्सप्रेसवे औद्योगिक विकास प्राधिकरण**  
प्रथम तल, कोमिशनिज कॉम्प्लेक्स, ओमगा-1 (पी-2), गेट नं. 1  
Toll Free No. 18001808296 वेबसाइट: [www.yamunaexpresswayauthority.com](http://www.yamunaexpresswayauthority.com)

पत्रांक: आई.ई.ए./मूवे/780/2026 दिनांक: 08/04/2026

**सार्वजनिक सूचना**

निम्नलिखित पुर्न यमुना एक्सप्रेसवे औद्योगिक विकास प्राधिकरण द्वारा जारी की गयी है।

**ग्राम म्याना सैक्टर-05, 11, 10 व दसमपुर सी-08, मकसुपुर-11**

| क्र.सं. | सैक्टर/ग्राम का नाम | खस्ता संख्या | खस्ता संख्या | खसरे का कुल क्षेत्रफल (हे.मै.) | खातेदार का नाम व पता                                                           | तहसील से प्राप्त रिपोर्ट के आधार पर कारकाकार का हिसा (हे.मै.) | कारकाकार का हिसा (हे.मै.) |
|---------|---------------------|--------------|--------------|--------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------|
| 1.      | म्याना सैक्टर-05    | 115          | 89           | 1.5100                         | नीलम पुत्र रामचरण सिंह नि. ग्राम कानपुर                                        | 0.2517                                                        | 0.3403                    |
| 2.      | म्याना सैक्टर-05    | 26           | 125          | 0.0380                         | मुकेश कुमार, मुकेश, राजेश कुमार, राजकुमार पुत्र रामचरण सिंह नि. ग्राम कानपुर   | 0.0086                                                        | 0.0086                    |
| 3.      | म्याना सैक्टर-05    | 280          | 124          | 0.1520                         | नरेश कुमार, मुकेश कुमार, विजय कुमार, राजदेवी कपूर/पुत्र रामचरण सिंह नि. कानपुर | 0.0095                                                        | 0.0095                    |
| 4.      | म्याना सैक्टर-11    | 213          | 69           | 0.8390                         | अनिल कुमार पुत्र अमरकाश नि. ग्राम कानपुर                                       | 0.1520                                                        | 0.1520                    |
| 5.      | म्याना सैक्टर-05    | 95           | 43           | 2.0080                         | अमित कुमार पुत्र किरण पास सिंह नि.                                             | 0.0999                                                        | 0.0999                    |
| 6.      | म्याना सैक्टर-05    | 134          | 82           | 4.3810                         | सोहन कुमार पुत्र लखवी नि. ग्राम कानपुर                                         | 0.2008                                                        | 0.3971                    |
| 7.      | म्याना सैक्टर-05    | 102          | 18700        | 1.0630                         | कलीचन्द पुत्र लखवी नि. ग्राम कानपुर                                            | 0.1963                                                        | 1.4677                    |
| 8.      | म्याना सैक्टर-05    | 134          | 82           | 4.3810                         | कलीचन्द पुत्र लखवी नि. ग्राम कानपुर                                            | 1.0962                                                        | 1.4677                    |
| 9.      | म्याना सैक्टर-05    | 102          | 18700        | 1.0630                         | कलीचन्द पुत्र लखवी नि. ग्राम कानपुर                                            | 0.3725                                                        | 0.0850                    |
| 10.     | म्याना सैक्टर-05    | 134          | 102          | 1.8700                         | विजय कुमार पुत्र दीपक अशोक नि. ग्राम कानपुर                                    | 0.0850                                                        | 0.0850                    |
| 11.     | म्याना सैक्टर-05    | 308          | 62           | 0.7540                         | सुरेश कुमार पुत्र लखवी सिंह नि. ग्राम नौरा                                     | 0.0950                                                        | 0.0950                    |
| 12.     | म्याना सैक्टर-11    | 173          | 238          | 0.4300                         | सतीश कपूर पुत्र लखवी नि. जिला नौरा                                             | 0.0838                                                        | 0.0838                    |
| 13.     | म्याना सैक्टर-11    | 173          | 238          | 0.4300                         | परीक्षित सिंह पुत्र राम सिंह                                                   | 0.0072                                                        | 0.0072                    |



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**Hindustan Times**  
**GOGLY QUIZ**

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Q. Which player has the nickname "The Hitman"?

A. Virat Kohli      B. Shikhar Dhawan  
C. Rohit Sharma      D. Hardik Pandya

Scan to play

8th April Winners  
1. Aashish (Karnal) 2. Mazhar Hussain (Varanasi)  
3. Manoj Kumar (Indore)

\*All images shown are for illustration purpose only

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is invited by Chief Engineer (Civil) Garden Reach, Kolkata-700043, S.E. Railway for and on behalf of the President of India for the following work. Following tender has been uploaded on website [www.bids.gov.in](http://www.bids.gov.in). The tender will be closed at 12.00 hrs. on due date. Brief Description of Works: Composite work for Execution of earthwork in Formation & Cutting, Construction of Minor Bridges, New Platform, Extension of Foot Over Bridge, P/Way Track Lining Works, supply of Ballast, E/I Building, other service Buildings, Approach Road, side drains, Protection works, shifting of ARTI/ARME location etc. complete in connection with the Yard Remodelling works at Bokaro Steel City station yard including electrical works as per the approved ESP & SIP in Adra Division of S.E. Railway. Approx. Cost: ₹ 37.07 Crore. Bid Security: ₹ 74.14, 800/- Completion period: 12 months. Closing Date: 08.05.2026. Interested tenderers may visit website [www.bids.gov.in](http://www.bids.gov.in) for full details/description/specification of the tenders and submit their bids online. In no case manual tenders for these items will be accepted. N.B.: Prospective Bidders may regularly visit [www.bids.gov.in](http://www.bids.gov.in) to participate in all other tenders. (P/R-28)

## Have fun with facts on Sundays

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NEW DELHI  
FRIDAY  
APRIL 10, 2026

## Hindustan Times SPORT

19

### How Payal became the first quadruple amputee champion

Ritesh Mishra and Shahid Judge

[sportsdesk@hindustantimes.com](mailto:sportsdesk@hindustantimes.com)

**RAIPUR/MUMBAI:** By now, Sheetal Devi is familiar with the drill. Soon after receiving their medal — silver — podium finishers turn toward the flag for the national anthem of the gold-medal winner. For a few fleeting moments, however, at the Bangkok Archery Centre last Saturday, she strayed from the protocol.

Instead, she walked to the gold-medallist, Payal Nag, to help her turn her wheelchair 180 degrees.

Since Sheetal announced her bid on the world stage by becoming the first armless woman archer to win a World Championship medal in 2023, she has conquered almost everything her sport has to offer. But at the inaugural World Archery Para Series, Payal, the first and only quadruple amputee international archer, beat the player she idolises. "Earlier, it felt like I was alone here winning medals, but now it is great that (Payal) is here and India will get even more medals," Sheetal said on Thursday during a virtual interaction organised by SAL. "It feels very good. Defeats happen in the game, but I'm not taking this negatively. I am happy that more archers are coming and doing so well."

By no means, though, was this defeat a flash in the pan. Though Sheetal has been the best in her class in the world for a few years



Payal (R) with sister Barsha.

had no means to support her treatment. "IAS officer Santosh Mishra told HT, Mishra and his wife, IPS officer Sonali Mishra, read about the accident and took it upon themselves to help Payal's treatment."

The family had to sell their land in Balangir district of Odisha to pay for the treatment, and were forced to place her in an orphanage since they did not have the means to support her.

Payal, though, remained determined to prove her worth. She eventually got in touch with Kuldeep Vedwan, who was Sheetal's first coach. "The first time I spoke to her was over a video call," Sheetal recalled her first interaction with Payal. "She said 'did I also want to do archery,' and I told her 'aajao.' Initially, I wondered how she would do it because she doesn't have arms and legs. But then (Vedwan) sir made a special device for her, and I felt she could do it. I was very happy when she shot her first arrow. I felt she would become a star in the world."

### Candidates: Vaishali takes sole lead but Pragm loses

Zhu's loss sees the 24-year-old Indian move to top spot in Women's Candidates even as Sindarov got another win in the Open section

Susan Ninan

[susan.ninan@hindustantimes.com](mailto:susan.ninan@hindustantimes.com)

**BENGALURU:** India's brightest hope at the Candidates tournament, is now Vaishali Rameshbabu. The 24-year-old Indian has now jumped into sole lead at the Women's Candidates.

Unlike in the Open section, the women's standings have witnessed meltdowns and mayhem with no player dominating the field. Vaishali's remarkable play in recent rounds — winning three of her last five games — now places her at the top of the standings, with just four rounds remaining.

With her aggressive play and fiery sacrifices, Vaishali has made a timely bid for first place. In the last Candidates, she won five games in a row in the latter half. This time, she decided to get going just in time.

In Round 10 on Thursday, she

**ROUND 9 RESULTS**

**OPEN**

Javokhir Sindarov beat R Praggnanandhaa  
Anish Giri drew with Hikaru Nakamura  
Andrey Esipenko drew with Matthias Bluebaum  
Wei Yi drew with Fabiano Caruana

**WOMEN**

Anna Muzychuk drew with R Vaishali  
Bibisara Assaubayeva beat Zhu Jiner

**STANDINGS**

**OPEN**

6 Javokhir Sindarov; 6 Anish Giri;  
5 Fabiano Caruana; 4.5 Hikaru Nakamura,  
Wei Yi, Matthias Bluebaum;  
4 R Praggnanandhaa; 3.5 Andrey Esipenko

**WOMEN**

6 R Vaishali; 5.5 Zhu Jiner, Anna Muzychuk;  
5 Aleksandra Goryachkina, Bibisara Assaubayeva, Kateryna Lagno;

through his moves early on, falling slightly behind on the clock. It's been such a rare sight in Sindarov's case in this tournament that it made commentators wonder aloud if he was already struggling to recall his preparation.

Though the evaluation bar suggested the position was pretty much equal, Black's position seemed increasingly perilous. Black's King was exposed, and White's pawns were on the march. Sindarov doubled his rooks on the d-file and Praggnanandhaa blundered with 22.Bd7.

The Uzbek, not wanting to rush like he did during the Bluebaum game, spotted the move he needed to play, bobbed in his chair, buried his face in his hands before pushing his rook to the f7 square and dispatching his Queen to chase Black's king. Black eventually ran out of safe squares for its King.

This defeat — his second to Sindarov in this tournament — now leaves Praggnanandhaa on just four points. Pre-tournament favourite Fabiano Caruana finds himself three points behind Sindarov while Bluebaum is fashioning a sweep of his own with nine draws in 10 rounds.

Asked about both him and Sindarov taking the most walks around the chess hall, he



#### Hansika, Neha clinch bronze

**BISHKEK:** Hansika Lamba and Neha won a bronze medal each in women's 55kg and 59kg while two-time national champion Meenakshi Goyat beat South Korean Seoyoung Park to reach the 53kg final at the Asian Wrestling Championships here.

#### Shetty enters quarter-finals

**NINGBO:** India's Ayush Shetty entered the men's singles quarter-finals of the Badminton Asia Championships with a 21-16, 21-12 win over world No.20 Chi Yu Jen of Chinese Taipei. He will next face third seed Jonathan Christie of Indonesia. However, PV Sindhu, HS Prannoy, Unnati Hooda lost in the second round here.

#### SPORT TODAY

##### FOOTBALL

**Indian Super League**  
● NorthEast United vs Delhi (5pm)  
● Goa vs Odisha (7:30pm)

##### Premier League

West Ham vs Wolverhampton (12:30am, Saturday)

##### TENNIS

Billie Jean King Cup



Payal had beaten her at the Nationals in January 2025. Since then, the 19-year-old from Odisha has only grown in strength, leaving behind the disaster that forced doctors to amputate her arms and legs. In 2015, eight-year-old Payal was playing on the terrace of an under-construction building in Raipur, where her migrant parents had moved for work, when she stepped onto a puddle of water that had been in contact with a live wire. (Payal) was in a very bad shape and her parents

but she would be able to do it. She is doing it very well now." The accident may define who she is but she has not let that restrict her. "At one phase we lost all hope, but she fought her battles," Payal's father Vijay told HT. Payal, though, has set her sights on bigger targets. "It has been a long and difficult journey for me. From Raipur to winning the gold in Bangkok," she said. "I am now focusing on the 2026 Asian Games and 2028 Paralympics."

against Anna Muzychuk, protecting her lead. Zhi Jiner, her co-leader going into the day's play will perhaps rue rejecting a draw by repetition only to the advantage of Bibisara Assaubayeva. In the Open section, as things stand, the next World Championship could be played between two 20-year-olds. Over the past fortnight, Javokhir Sindarov has been on an astonishing run, making the rest of the field look inconsequential. In Round 10 on Thurs-

Divya Deshmukh lost to Aleksandra Goryachkina 4.5 Divya Deshmukh; 3.5 Tan Zhongyi  
Katerina Lagno drew with Tan Zhongyi

day, the 20-year-old Uzbek defeated India's R Praggnanandhaa for his record-breaking sixth win in this Candidates tournament. It's the highest number of wins by a player in a Candidates tournament since the current format was introduced in 2013. Sindarov leads the field by two points, with four rounds remaining. "I'm very happy. Yesterday I didn't win a

winning game but today I played a very good game. When I'm not worried about the result, I'm playing very, very good chess." Anish Giri, who is second in the standings, has no delusions, though, about how things look. "Let's not give me too much credit by calling it a two-horse race...It's a one-horse race with a couple of losers in the back...OK maybe I'm a bit ahead of the losers," he said earlier.

With the White pieces against Praggnanandhaa, Sindarov chose the Queen's Pawn opening and it looked like a sharp tactical duel in the Queen's Gambit set-up, at the very outset. Perhaps still shaken from drawing his game against Matthias Bluebaum from a winning position on Wednesday, Sindarov took time to think

India vs Mongolia (3pm)  
**BADMINTON**  
Asia Championships  
Quarter-finals (8:30am)  
**WRESTLING**  
Asian Championships  
Women's & freestyle (10:30am)  
**BOXING**  
Asian Championships  
Finals (9:30am)

**ADVERTISEMENT NO. 01/2026**  
**FILLING UP THE POST OF EXECUTIVE ENGINEER & ASSISTANT DIRECTOR (OFFICIAL LANGUAGE) THROUGH TRANSFER ON DEPUTATION IN KENDRIYA VIDYALAYA SANGATHAN**  
Kendriya Vidyalaya Sangathan (KVS) an autonomous body under Ministry of Education intends to fill the 01 (One) post of Executive Engineer in Pay Level-11 and 01 (One) post of Assistant Director (Official Language) in Pay Level-10, through transfer on Deputation. For more details i.e. the eligibility criteria, qualification and terms & conditions visit website [www.kvsangathan.nic.in](http://www.kvsangathan.nic.in) of Kendriya Vidyalaya Sangathan & Edition dated 4th April, 2026 of Employment News.  
Additional Commissioner (Admin.)  
CBC 21106/12/0001/2627

**NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY**  
E-Procurement Tender Notice No. 102026 Date: 07.04.2026  
**E-PROCUREMENT TENDER NOTICE**  
On behalf of President of India, Sr. Divisional Materials Manager, North Central Railway, Prayagraj invites the E-Procurement tenders:-  
Tender No.: 19285740 E.M.D. (Rs.): ₹ 3,72,100/-  
Description: SUPPLY, INSTALLATION AND COMMISSIONING OF IOT BASED WATERLEVEL INDICATOR SYSTEM  
Qty: 500 Set Tender Opening Date: 30.04.2026  
Notes: (1) The complete information of above E-Procurement Tender is available on REPS website i.e. <http://www.reps.gov.in>. (2) Bids other than in the form of E-Bids shall not be accepted against Above Tender, for this purpose, Vendors are required to get themselves registered with REPS website along with Class II Digital Signature Certificate issued by CCA under IT Act-2000. (3) Rates entered into financial rate page and duly signed digitally shall only be considered. Rates and any other financial entry in any other form/letterhead if attached by vendor shall be straight away ignored and shall not be considered. (4) Documents being attached should be signed on their body. The above tender notice has been on uploaded <http://www.mcr.indianrailways.gov.in>. In case of any difficulty/helpdesk available on the REPS website may be approached. 77526(A)  
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University of Agricultural Sciences & Technology of Jammu  
Estates Division, Main Campus Chatha, Jammu (J&K)-180 009  
e-NIT No. AU/Estates/2026-27/01 Dated: 02-04-2026  
**Notice Inviting e-Tender**  
For and on behalf of SKUAST-J, tenders are invited by e-tendering mode from the reputed Architects who are registered with Council of Architect, New Delhi, having dealt at least two Campuses for institution of higher learning (University) for the below mentioned work for a period of 02 years.  
Name of work Earnest Money (in Rs.) Cost of Tender Document (in Rs.)  
Providing Architectural Consultancy for various buildings at different Stations of SKUAST-Jammu. 1,00,000/- 3,000/-  
Note: Further details can be seen from the website <http://kntenders.gov.in>. Vendors will be uploaded only on <http://kntenders.gov.in> and contractors registered on this website will be able to submit their bid online. The department reserves the right to reject any or all tenders without assigning any reason (s). The tenderer should read terms and conditions instruction carefully before filing the price bids (BOC). E-tendering without Digital Signature Certificate (DSC) will not be accepted by electronic tendering system.  
No. AU/Estates/26-27/1842-46 Dated: 06-04-2026 Sd/-  
GIP-J-126-P-26 Estates Officer, SKUAST-Jammu

**Office Of The Superintending Engineer**  
9th Circle Public Work Department Dehradun  
Website: <http://pwd.uk.gov.in>, E-mail: [sepwdddun09@gmail.com](mailto:sepwdddun09@gmail.com)  
Letter No.: 2159/1C-9/2026 Dated: 09/04/2026  
**NATIONAL COMPETITIVE BIDDING**  
E-tender Notice  
The Superintending Engineer 9th Circle, Public Works Department, Dehradun on behalf of "Governor of Uttarakhand" invites tender in two bid system for the following work. Information regarding tender shall be available on <https://www.uktenders.gov.in> from date 13.04.2026

| Sl. No. | Name of Work                                                                                                                                                             | Earnest Money (Rs. in Lacs) | Cost of Tender Document (In Rs.) | Validity of Tender (In days) | Period of Completion (In Month) | Contractor Category of Registration                                                                  |
|---------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------|----------------------------------|------------------------------|---------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1       | Reconstruction and Improvement of Naraya-Lorli-Ashad-Mangroli-Chakrata motor road (from Km 15.250 to Km 20.250) under TSP in Chakrata Constituency of Dehradun District. | 4.70                        | 5000.00+ 18% GST                 | 90                           | 12                              | Registered in 'C' & above category in Road works in Central Govt./ State Govt./any Govt. Undertaking |

**CSIR- INDIAN INSTITUTE OF PETROLEUM**  
(Council of Scientific & Industrial Research)  
P.O. IIR, Mohanpur, Haridwar Road, Dehradun-248006  
Recruitment Advt. No. 02/2026  
Walk-in-Interview for the temporary Positions of "Project Scientist (PS-II), Senior Project Associate (Senior PAT)", "Project Associate (PAT-II)", "Project Associate (PAT-I) & "Project Assistant-II (PA-II)"

| Position & Eligibility                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | Maximum Age (As on the date of walk-in-Interview) | No. of Positions | Date of Walk-in-Interview |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------|------------------|---------------------------|
| (A) Project Scientist (PS-II) [Stipend Rs. 67,000/- per month plus HRA]*<br>(i) Essential Qualification: Master's/Integrated Master's in EEE/Power Electronics/EV from a recognized University with 5 years of relevant work experience in Research and Development in Industrial and Academic Institutions or Science and Technology Organizations and Scientific activities and services.                                                                   | 40 Years                                          | 01               | 23.04.2026                |
| (ii) Essential Qualification: Master's/Integrated Master's in Metallurgical and Material Engg./Manufacturing Technology/Mechanical Engg. from a recognized University with 5 years of relevant work experience in Research and Development in Industrial and Academic Institutions or Science and Technology Organizations and Scientific activities and services.                                                                                            | 40 Years                                          | 01               | 22.04.2026                |
| (B) Senior Project Associate (Senior PAT) [Stipend Rs. 42,000/- per month plus HRA]*<br>(i) Essential Qualification: Doctoral Degree in Chemistry from a recognized University with 2 years of relevant work experience in Research and Development in Industrial and Academic Institutions or Science and Technology Organizations and Scientific activities and services.                                                                                   | 40 Years                                          | 01               | 28.04.2026                |
| (ii) Essential Qualification: Doctoral Degree in Metallurgical & Materials Science/Energy Science from a recognized University AND 2 years of relevant work experience in Research and Development in Industrial and Academic Institutions or Science and Technology Organizations and Scientific activities and services.                                                                                                                                    | 40 Years                                          | 01               | 22.04.2026                |
| (C) Project Associate (PAT-II) [Stipend Rs. 28,000/35,000/- per month plus HRA]*<br>(i) Essential Qualification: Bachelor's Degree in Chemical Engg. from a recognized University with 2 years of relevant work experience in Research and Development in Industrial and Academic Institutions or Science and Technology Organizations and Scientific activities and services OR Master's/Integrated Master's in Chemical Engg. from a recognized University. | 35 Years                                          | 06               | 27.04.2026                |
| (ii) Essential Qualification: Bachelor's degree in Mechanical Engg. from a recognized University with 2 years of relevant work experience in research and development in industrial and academic institutions or Science and Technology organizations and scientific activities and service OR Master's/Integrated Master's in Mechanical Engg. from a recognized University.                                                                                 | 35 Years                                          | 01               | 22.04.2026                |
| (iii) Essential Qualification: Bachelor's degree in Biotechnology/Microbiology from a recognized University with 2 years of relevant work experience in research and development in industrial and academic institutions or Science and Technology organizations and scientific activities and service.                                                                                                                                                       | 35 Years                                          | 01               | 29.04.2026                |
| (iv) Essential Qualification: Master's/Integrated Master's degree in Chemistry from a recognized University with 2 years of relevant work experience in research and development in industrial and academic institutions or Science and Technology organizations and scientific activities and service.                                                                                                                                                       | 35 Years                                          | 03               | 28.04.2026                |
| (D) Project Associate (PAT-I) [Stipend Rs. 25,000/31,000/- per month plus HRA]*<br>(i) Essential Qualification: Master's/Integrated Master's degree in Chemistry from a recognized University.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | 35 Years                                          | 20               | 24.04.2026                |
| (ii) Essential Qualification: Master's/Integrated Master's degree in Microbiology/Biotechnology from a recognized University.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | 35 Years                                          | 02               | 29.04.2026                |
| (iii) Essential Qualification: Bachelor's degree in Computer Science & Engg. from a recognized University.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | 35 Years                                          | 01               | 30.04.2026                |
| (iv) Essential Qualification: Bachelor's degree in Chemical Engg. from a recognized University.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | 35 Years                                          | 11               | 27.04.2026                |
| (v) Essential Qualification: Bachelor's degree in Chemical Engineering/Biotechnology/Mechanical Engineering/ Energy Technology/Rural Science and Technology/ Computer Science/Software Engg. From a recognized University.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | 35 Years                                          | 02               | 23.04.2026                |
| (E) Project Assistant-II (PA-II) [Stipend Rs. 20,000/- per month plus HRA]*<br>(i) Essential Qualification: B.Sc. in Computer Science/IT OR 3 years Diploma in Computer Science & Engg. from a recognized University.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | 35 Years                                          | 02               | 30.04.2026                |
| (ii) Essential Qualification: B.Sc. in Microbiology/Biotechnology/Agriculture from a recognized University.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | 35 Years                                          | 01               | 29.04.2026                |

All the interested candidates may visit Institute website <https://www.iip.res.in> for detailed advertisement and application proforma (available in Latest News Section) and eligible candidates may appear for Walk-in-Interview on the above-mentioned dates. The positions are purely on temporary basis and are co-terminus with the project. Number of positions may vary.  
Sr. Controller of Administration

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# Newcomer Mukul scripts a miracle for Super Giants

Pant's team looked lost before the rookie smashed a 27-ball 54 to win them the game

**Somshuvra Laha**  
[somshuvra.laha@htlive.com](mailto:somshuvra.laha@htlive.com)

**KOLKATA:** Mukul Choudhary pulled a rabbit out of the hat, hitting seven sixes and two fours to help Lucknow Super Giants stave off a sensational three-wicket win against Kolkata Knight Riders at Eden Gardens on Thursday.

Coming in at 125/6 with the game nearly done, Choudhary scored a 27-ball 54. His 16-run assault against Cameron Green

catch to leave LSG staring at an asking rate of over nine. In Nicholas Pooran and Ayush Badoni, LSG had the ammunition to chase the target, especially with dew coming into effect. But by giving them no pace on the ball to work with, Narine was making life difficult. Navdeep Saini followed it up with an over of clever cutters and slower balls, and suddenly the asking rate pushed up beyond 10. Soon enough, Tyagi weighed in with—unsurprisingly—another short ball that got big on Pooran. Badoni, though, kept the chase alive when all had seemed lost for LSG.

The match was definitely lost in the last three overs but also in the second half of KKR's innings.



# Titans leggie Rashid looks for that missing rhythm

**Samreen Razzaqui**  
[samreen.razzaqui@hindustantimes.com](mailto:samreen.razzaqui@hindustantimes.com)

**NEW DELHI:** For years, you have been the bowler every T20 team wants. From India to Australia to England, franchises are vying for you. Suddenly, your rhythm goes missing, and you no longer come across as threatening. There were questions: Has he lost his magic? Has he been found out? Has he been exposed?

Rashid Khan battled those questions and some more, even in his own head. But if his 3/17 with a stunning economy rate of 4.2 for GT against DC is a marker, he seems to be on his back.

Last IPL, the Afghan picked up 9 wickets in 15 matches (ER 9.35). In 2024, he took 10 wickets in 12 matches (ER 8.4)—a major drop from his overall IPL standard between 2017 and 2023 of 139 wickets in 109 matches (avg



Gujarat Titans leg-spinner Rashid Khan.

felt it was the whole rhythm, from start to finish. What was holding me back was a bit of lingering pain and the fear of what might happen if I pushed it said. He also hinted at the possibility of missing the upcoming Test against India in June. "The doctor told me, if you want to keep playing for Afghanistan,



in the run over proved to be the turning point in LSG's innings.

Set a target of 182, LSG got off to a quick start but KKR's fast bowlers were smart in deploying a short-ball trap that the batters walked into. Sunil Narine and Anukul Roy then combined to concede only 45 runs in their eight overs while taking three middle and lower-order wickets, which nearly snuffed out any chance of a comeback for LSG. Badoni, however, kept LSG in the match with a 34-ball 54 before Choudhary engineered a stunning run, steering the match away from KKR despite the equation reading 30 runs needed off the last 12 balls.

An 84-run second wicket stand between Ajinkya Rahane (41 off 24 balls) and Angkrish Raghuvanshi (45 off 33) was the backbone of KKR's innings, setting up what should have been a much better finish. But KKR lost a cluster of wickets in the middle overs, allowing LSG to slide back into reckoning with clever changes of pace, before picking up the scoring rate again in the death overs.

Two wickets in three balls made Vaibhav Arora cock-a-hoop and KKR hopeful of turning a corner when everything seemed smooth sailing for LSG with a 41-run opening stand. A short ball from Arora saw Aiden Markram go for a pull but he couldn't get it past Howman Powell at deep midwicket. Mitchell Marsh's turn came a ball later, again trying to pull, he could only glove it to Raghuvanshi behind the wickets.

Something shifted with the wicket of Rishabh Pant coming from an unexpected source. Bowling for the first time this IPL, Green banged in a ball that climbed up on Pant, who, despite not being in any position to pull, went ahead with the shot anyway. Swinging in from short fine leg, Kartik Tyagi completed the

100 in succession from Aiden Markram to Mohammad Shami's outswinging deliveries, trying his best to edge but failing. An outside edge produced a relieving single but Allen was edgy as ever. Against Prince Yadav he got two boundaries but they were nearly not as convincing. Allen finally got one off the screws but Digvesh Rathi caught him at deep third man, though TV replay later seemed to suggest that he could have touched the stiring.

Not giving Shami a third over despite extracting multiple false shots for just 11 runs probably went against the momentum LSG had built up. First Rahane came down the track to lift M Siddharth over extra cover for a six, followed by a couple of boundaries off Rathi. Raghuvanshi then joined the party, upper cutting Avesh Khan for a four before flicking a straying down delivery for a six over deep extra cover. Khan returned, only to be carted for two more sixes by Raghuvanshi, boosting KKR's score to 98/1 at the halfway mark.

This is where KKR started to wobble. First, Rahane pulled a half-tracker from Rathi to Shami at midwicket. Next over, Raghuvanshi too departed after picking Aiden Markram in the deep, leaving KKR with two new batters in the space of eight balls. The innings slowed down as a result, with Shami's five-run over acting as the trigger. The pressure got to Binu Singh, who tried to steer Khan late but got bowled instead. Roman Powell joined Cameron Green but the next 10 balls yielded just four runs. The recovery was decent as KKR scored 65 runs in the last five overs but in the end it wasn't enough to check LSG.

**Brief scores:** KKR 181/4 in 20 overs (A Raghuvanshi 45; D Rathi 1/25) lost to LSG 182/7 in 20 overs (M Choudhary 54; A Badoni 54; A Roy 2/32) by 3 wickets.



An elated Mukul Choudhary after helping LSG beat KKR in Kolkata on Wednesday.

SAMIR JANA/HT



| Team    | P | W | L | NRR    | Pts |
|---------|---|---|---|--------|-----|
| 1 RR    | 3 | 3 | 0 | 2.408  | 6   |
| 2 POKS* | 3 | 2 | 0 | 0.637  | 5   |
| 3 RCB   | 2 | 2 | 0 | 2.501  | 4   |
| 4 DC    | 3 | 2 | 1 | 0.871  | 4   |
| 5 LSG   | 3 | 2 | 1 | -0.359 | 4   |
| 6 SRH   | 1 | 2 | 0 | 0.275  | 2   |
| 7 GT    | 3 | 1 | 2 | -0.270 | 2   |
| 8 MI    | 3 | 1 | 2 | -0.705 | 2   |
| 9 KKR*  | 4 | 0 | 3 | -1.315 | 1   |
| 10 CSK  | 3 | 0 | 3 | -2.510 | 0   |

\*Tied at 100 runs



Preeti Pawar won the gold medal on Thursday.

ASIAN BOXING

## Preeti, Minakshi win gold medals

Press Trust of India

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**ULANBAATAR:** Reigning world champion Minakshi Hooda and Preeti Pawar led the gold rush for India with two other compatriots also registering victories in the finals to be crowned Asian boxing champions here on Thursday.

Joining Minakshi (48kg) and Asian Games bronze medalist Preeti (54kg) in the top were Priya Ghanghas (60kg) and World Boxing Cup gold medalist Arundhati Choudhary (70kg). The biggest setback for India came in the 57kg final, where reigning world champion Jaismine Lamboria suffered a 0-5 defeat to Thailand's two-time World Championships silver medalist Punrawee Ruengro, formerly known as Jutamas Jitpong.

India also secured another silver with Aliya Pathan (80-kg) finishing runner-up. She went down 0-5 to Kazakh Dina Islambekova in her lone bout of the championships.

The Indian women's team finished with an impressive haul of

10 medals — four gold, two silver and four bronze.

However, with limited participation in certain weight categories, including fields of just three boxers, the likes of Lovlina Borgohain (75kg), Pooja Pami (80kg) and Aliya essentially received medals for just participating.

Minakshi set the tone by securing India's first gold of the day with a commanding 5-0 win over Mongolia's Nomundari Enkh-Amgalan.

Preeti extended her fine run with yet another dominant display. She out-punched three-time world champion and Tokyo Olympics bronze medalist Buang Hsiao-wen of Chinese Taipei with a unanimous 5-0 verdict.

Priya then added to the tally with a clinical 3-0 win over North Korea's Won Gyeong, while Arundhati impressed with a 4-1 victory against Kazakh Sedidish in her final.

Earlier in the week, two-time world champion Nihat Zareen (54kg), Ankushita Boro (65kg), Lovlina (75kg) and Pooja (80kg) had settled for bronze after semi-final exits.

## Simeone fetches Atletico 1st win at Camp Nou in 20 years

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**KOLKATA:** Juergen Klopp was once caught by surprise, mildly offended even, but everyone in Spain knows that Diego Simeone does not stay for after-match formalities. No disrespect, I just don't like it, he has said. So, cameras caught Simeone on the stairs waiting for the final whistle. And sprinting through the tunnel after it.

This was the first time that Atletico Madrid had beaten Barcelona at Camp Nou on his watch. And Atletico Madrid have been on his watch since 2011. In that time, Simeone, 55, has won two La Liga titles, two Europa League trophies, a Copa del Rey and a Spanish Super Cup and played in two Champions League finals.

The 2-0 win on Wednesday, courtesy a delectable free kick from Julian Alvarez and an opportunistic finish from Alexander Sorloth, against 10-man Barcelona was also a first since February 2006 for Atletico. Not even a result this momentous got Simeone to go against the grain.

Maybe because it is only half-time in this Champions League quarter-final. Yes, they beat Barcelona in 2014 and 2016 but the visiting team are capable of resurrection. Paris St Germain and Liverpool know that. Atletico beat Barcelona in the Copa del Rey but lost in La Liga at the weekend. It could be close next Tuesday.

Earlier this season, Atletico had given Real Madrid a roundhouse whack. Alvarez had scored from a free kick then. So, it is not as if they do not know how to play. It is just that they usually play a different way. One that was evident on Wednesday.

Robin le Normand's challenge on Marcus Rashford, Nicolas Gonzalez chasing down and dispossessing Gavi, Juan Musso's save off Lamine Yamal, Atletico becoming a back five typified the kind of defensive steel Simeone's Atletico are known for.

There were fouls from Alex Baena (Atletico won that metric 18-7) and Koke, who could have been booked for body-checking Gavi and was for a foul on Dani Olmo, that disrupted Barcelona's momentum. It was why despite 20 attempts, four times more than Atletico, Barcelona could not make their domination count.

Pep Guardiola once said Atletico's low block style was prehistoric. Simeone did not react. Instead he said they try to do



**QUARTER-FINALS (FIRST LEG)**

|                                   |     |                                            |
|-----------------------------------|-----|--------------------------------------------|
| BARCELONA                         | 0-2 | ATLETICO MADRID (Alvarez 45', Sorloth 70') |
| PSG (Doue 11', Kvaratskhelia 65') | 2-0 | LIVERPOOL                                  |

their best with the "characteristics" of the players they have. And that they have found a way. One where the counter-attack and choosing the moment to launch one is crucial. It led to Pau Cubarsi's foul on Giuliano Simeone and a red card in the 44th minute after Alvarez found him in space. This was Cubarsi's second red card in the Champions League and Barcelona's 12th in the past 10 seasons, which is the most in the competition.

Alvarez curled the 45th minute free kick over a leaping Robert Lewandowski and got it down to beat Juan Garcia. It was his 15th goal in 18 matches in Europe. Sorloth's goal too came against the run of play, the big striker showing why there will be

107 wickets a season, R.K. / AFP).

Rashid believes the loss of rhythm can be attributed to the back injury he sustained in 2023. For a while, he played with chronic pain from the injury, which his bowling action caused. He underwent a spinal decompression surgery that year to relieve nerve pressure but the rhythm eluded him until recently. "When I had surgery and came back, I was very careful. That affected my action and release. I was trying to be careful, but I missed a little bit of my rhythm," he said. "I was bowling slow for 3-4 months, and my body just took that shape. It wasn't the same as before the surgery. After having a bad season, I thought about what was wrong and what I was missing. I

again, so, I worked on my core to make it as strong as possible to go on with the tournament."

Despite his doctor's instruction to avoid longer spells, he proceeded with playing red-ball cricket. In his most recent Test against Zimbabwe, he returned 11 wickets, bowling nearly 55 overs.

Red-ball cricket is a little difficult because that was the first thing my doctor told me: "Stay away from red-ball cricket. I still went ahead and played. After the surgery, I played a game against Zimbabwe and bowled 55 overs, which was crazy. The doctor told me, 'If you don't want to play cricket, you can keep playing red-ball cricket. He said it's not going to help me and that I won't be able to play for long,' he

you can't play red-ball cricket. Red-ball (cricket) is difficult to maintain. I might take one Test a year, but I don't think I can do more than that."

Currently, Rashid is focusing on what's working and tapping into what made him so fearsome in this format. He is not looking to add more variations and is confident that his existing ones — the googly, the flipper and the leg break are enough to keep the batters guessing. "In the last two games, I bowled well, but where I conceded runs, it was just the length I missed. If I hit the right area, the right thing will happen. If I bowl badly, anybody can hit me. As a bowler, you must always think: 'What is the toughest ball I can bowl on this wicket to make it hard for the batter?'"

| CD GOPINATH | 1930-2026

## The last survivor from India's first Test-winning team in 1952 no more

Press Trust of India

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**CHENNAI:** India's oldest living Test cricketer CD Gopinath died at the age of 96 here on Thursday, ending the last human link to the nation's first Test-winning team.

Gopinath, who was the second oldest cricketer in the world after Australian legend Neil Harvey (97), is survived by his wife, children and grandchildren.

Following his demise, Mumbai's 95-year-old Chandrakant Patankar has become the country's oldest cricketer. He played one Test, against New Zealand in 1955.



CD Gopinath.

HT ARCHIVE

In the death of Gopinath, India has lost not just its oldest living Test cricketer but also the last personal link to a glorious chapter in the country's rich cricketing history.

Four years back, Gopinath had a twinkle in his eye while

recounting India's first-ever Test triumph, an innings and eight-run win over England at Cheltenham in 1952.

"See! That's the benefit of a long life. You can keep adding and rewriting the story. Everyone will give me the age's benefit, but you know, the benefit of doubt always goes to the batsman, doesn't it?" he had quipped.

Even at 92 then, Gopinath remained a brilliant raconteur, who would narrate amusing stories about his bright Test stint in India whites.

Of course, the brightest of them would be about those four glorious days in erstwhile Madras, now Chennai.

## BJK Cup: India's playoff chances fade after defeat

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**NEW DELHI:** Vaishnavi Adkar held all the cards in India's tough tie against Indonesia in the Billie Jean King Cup (Asia Oceania Group I) at the DLTA courts here. With world No. 41 Janice Tjen set to play the second singles against Sahaja Yamalapalli and also return for the doubles, Vaishnavi's match against Priska Madelyn Nugroho was decisive. The 2-year-old Vaishnavi has just broken into the top 400, backed by some remarkable showings in the ITF circuit at home, but she is still on a learning curve.

In the heat of the battle, Vaishnavi lost to Priska 7-6 (3), 6-7 (3), 3-6 after a draining, three-hour duel. Sahaja, ranked 385th in the world, had a herculean task against Janice, a player from the Grand Slam league. The Indonesian swiftly ended the match with a clinical 6-2, 6-1 win in an hour.

The doubles pair of Ankit Raina and Rutuja Bhosale stretched the formidable Indonesian combination of Janice and the seasoned Aldila Sutjiadi, a Grand Slam regular, but lost 3-6, 7-6 (4). The Indian pair came back strong after losing the first set but lost six set points. They eventually saved three match points before losing. "It was the day of missed chances. We had many chances in the first singles and even in the doubles. Something to learn is that when you get your chances you need to convert them," said captain Vishal Uppal.

The 3-0 loss against Indonesia means it is highly unlikely that India will progress to the playoffs. Korea and Indonesia have won all three ties so far and are top two. India have Korea and Mongolia to



Vaishnavi Adkar.

PH

face next.

Things could have been different had Vaishnavi won the first singles and put Indonesia under pressure. She had the opportunity as well. When she took the first set in a tie-break, the Indian bench thrilled with excitement. But then she just couldn't deliver on the promise.

A stubborn Priska bounced back to draw level, even though she struggled with an injury on her right leg midway through the second set and took a medical timeout. That perhaps was the moment Vaishnavi would regret not capitalising on. Up and running in the decider, Priska broke Vaishnavi in the fifth game, then held her serve for a 4-2 lead. Serving to save the match in the ninth game, Vaishnavi saved a match point with a brilliant forehand cross-court winner before her backhand sailed long, dashing all hopes.

Sahaja did play some bold shots, going for the line and then getting a break in the second game of the first set. But match Janice in speed and strokes was always going to be tough. With her strong service, Janice finished games quickly and struck winners from difficult positions on the court that kept Sahaja stranded.